

Maximus Weberus

Public Administration optional • the keyword chain

914 blocks • 19 sections • 317 marked **T0**, the core to own if there is time for nothing else • CSE 2026

How to read it. Each line is one examiner-ready idea reduced to the terms that carry it. **Bold** is a term to reproduce; *italic* is the link that carries the logic between two terms; · is a break in the argument. Numbering is **section.group.block**, so **4.2.7** is the seventh idea of the second group of section four. A **T0** line is in the last-48-hours set.

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Where the discipline came from and what it now claims to be. The dichotomy, the paradigm chain — NPA to NPM to New Public Service to New Public Governance — public choice, good governance, and the state-market-civil society triangle.

1.1 WHAT THE SUBJECT IS

1.1.1 Wilson's founding claim — Woodrow Wilson (1887), 'The Study of Administration' · constitution · 'government in action' · field of business
THINKER · TO

1.1.2 L.D. White and Marshall Dimock — White (1926) · first textbook · management of men and materials · Dimock · what and the how · the concern of all
THINKER · TO

1.1.3 Waldo's Administrative State — Dwight Waldo (1948) · value choice so public administration is a form of political theory · preference about who gets what
THINKER

1.1.4 Public versus private administration — Appleby's three differences · scope, impact and consideration · public accountability · political character · Sir Josiah Stamp · uniformity, external financial control, ministerial responsibility · marginal-utility
CONCEPT

1.1.5 Sayre's Law — Wallace Sayre · alike in all unimportant respects · technique · purpose, publicness and the impossibility of exit
QUOTE

1.1.6 The publicness test in India — LIC · CAG audits NHAI · Passport issuance · sovereign monopoly with no exit · service standards must be imposed, not competed for
EXAMPLE

1.1.7 Is public administration a science? — Simon · value-free science · Waldo · normative · social science with a professional purpose · work in a specific ecology
CONCEPT

1.1.8 Why the discipline keeps reinventing itself — contextual · welfare state → market state → regulatory state → digital state · Henry's five paradigms · legitimacy crisis
CONCEPT

1.2 THE POLITICS-ADMINISTRATION DICHOTOMY

1.2.1 The politics-administration dichotomy — ends · means · Wilson and Frank Goodnow (Politics and Administration, 1900) · merit · spoils system · Pendleton Act, 1883 · reform slogan
CONCEPT · TO

1.2.2 Why the dichotomy collapsed — Appleby (Policy and Administration, 1949) — Public administration is policy making · discretion · Waldo · political theory
CRITIQUE · TO

1.2.3 The dichotomy in Indian practice — Secretary is principal policy adviser · Allocation of Business Rules, 1961 · Cabinet Notes · NITI Aayog · operating convention · neutrality · Article 311
LINKAGE · TO

1.2.4 The dichotomy is not dead — it is normative — description · norm · politicisation of transfers · written dissent · Election Commission
CRITIQUE · TO

1.3 THE PARADIGMS — THE SPINE OF EVERY 'EVOLUTION' ANSWER

1.3.1 Nicholas Henry's five paradigms — (1) Politics administration dichotomy 1900-26 · (2) Principles of administration 1927-37 · (3) Public administration as political science · (4) as management · (5) as public administration
CONCEPT · TO

1.3.2 The golden age of principles — Willoughby (1927) claimed there are fundamental principles of administration as in the physical sciences; Gulick and Urwick (1937) codified them. This is the discipline's high point of confidence — and the target Simon destroyed nine years later.
CONCEPT

1.3.3 Simon's 'Proverbs of Administration' — Simon (1946) · proverbs · mutually contradictory pairs · unity of command · narrow the span of control · flat
CRITIQUE · TO

1.3.4 Robert Dahl's three problems — Dahl (1947) · values · human behaviour and cross-cultural transferability · Comparative Public Administration · Waldo
CRITIQUE

1.3.5 The identity crisis — Waldo (1968) · profession, a science, or a branch of political science? · eclecticism · object · public
CONCEPT

1.3.6 Minnowbrook I, II, III — I (1968, Syracuse, convened by Waldo) · social equity · II (1988) · III (2008) — globalisation, networked governance, collaborative public management
CONCEPT

1.3.7 Minnowbrook III's actual consensus — Its finding: theory must be empirically tested and regionally tailored — a single Western canon cannot travel. Administration is a socially embedded process of relationship, dialogue and action, not a toolkit.
CONCEPT

1.3.8 The paradigm ladder in one line — The chain runs PA (rule) → NPA (equity) → NPM (market) → NPS (citizenship) → NPG (network) → DEG (platform). Each corrects the previous one's blind spot; none replaces the Weberian core underneath.
CONCEPT · TO

1.3.9 The Indian discipline's own milestones — IIPA, 1954 · Appleby's · O&M Division · Department of Administrative Reforms, 1964 · ARC-I, 1966 · Indian Journal of Public Administration · reform practice
INSTITUTION

1.3.10 Public administration and the citizen — subject (colonial) · beneficiary (welfare) · customer (NPM) · citizen and co-producer (NPS) · subject · customer · Passport Seva Kendra · co-producer · Gram Sabha social audit
CONCEPT

1.4 NEW PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION — EQUITY AS THE THIRD PILLAR

1.4.1 NPA's four anchors — Frederickson's 4 Rs — Relevance, Values, Equity, Change. · economy and efficiency · social equity · third pillar · efficient for whom?
CONCEPT · T0

1.4.2 Frederickson on why equity is not optional — fails to work for changes · eventually used to repress those minorities · reproduces the inequality · “A public administration which fails to work for changes which try to redress the deprivation of minorities will likely be eventually used to repress those minorities.”
QUOTE

1.4.3 The proactive administrator — neutral instrument · change agent · client focus · disadvantaged · committed versus neutral bureaucracy
CONCEPT

1.4.4 Social equity, Indian constitutional form — Article 46 (DPSP, promotion of educational and economic interests of weaker sections), Articles 15(4), 16(4) and 335 — India wrote Frederickson's third pillar into the Constitution eighteen years before Minnowbrook.
PROVISION · T0

1.4.5 Equity as an administrative programme — Aspirational Districts Programme (2018) · Aspirational Blocks Programme (2023) · delta ranking · improvement, not level · converge, collaborate, compete
EXAMPLE

1.4.6 Equity in the budget line — Development Action Plan for SCs (DAPSC) and for STs (DAPST) · Scheduled Caste Sub-Plan / Tribal Sub-Plan · Gender Budget Statement 13 · auditable
SCHEME

1.4.7 Golembiewski's verdict on NPA — Radicalism in words, status quo in skills · moral vocabulary · method · administratively indeterminate
CRITIQUE

1.4.8 Where NPA still bites in 2026 — Every algorithmic allocation decision — DBT exclusion for a failed Aadhaar authentication, an AI-scored beneficiary list — is an equity question wearing an efficiency costume. NPA's question, 'efficient for whom?', is the sharpest closing line available on digital governance.
CRITIQUE

1.5 PUBLIC CHOICE — THE MARKET CRITIQUE OF BUREAUCRACY

1.5.1 Public choice in one sentence — economic method to non-market decision-making · methodological individualism · rational utility maximisation · their own · public interest
CONCEPT · T0

1.5.2 Vincent Ostrom's attack — The Intellectual Crisis in American Public Administration (1973) · monocentric bureaucracy · democratic administration · polycentricity · fragmented authority
THINKER

1.5.3 Niskanen's budget-maximising bureaucrat — Niskanen (1971) — the bureau is a bilateral monopoly facing a sponsor who cannot observe its true cost, so it secures a budget up to twice the efficient level.
THINKER · T0

1.5.4 Answering Niskanen today — half-right · fiscal rules · FRBM · outcome budgets · Treasury Single Account · PFMS · discretion and turf
CRITIQUE

1.5.5 Downs' bureaucratic personalities — Inside Bureaucracy (1967) · (1) climbers (power and income) · (2) conservers (security) · (3) zealots (one narrow policy) · (4) advocates (their whole bureau) · (5) statesmen (society at large) · motivation or leadership
CONCEPT

1.5.6 Buchanan, Tullock and rent-seeking — The Calculus of Consent (1962) · Tullock's · capturing · pure social waste · licence-permit raj
THINKER

1.5.7 Elinor Ostrom's answer to the commons — Governing the Commons (1990), Nobel 2009 · eight design principles · (1) clear boundaries (2) congruent rules (3) collective choice (4) monitoring · (5) graduated sanctions · (6) cheap conflict resolution (7) recognised right to organise (8) nested enterprises
THINKER

1.5.8 Ostrom's principles working in India — Van Panchayats · Pani Panchayats · Vilasrao Salunkhe · Joint Forest Management (1990 circular) · Water User Associations · AP Farmers' Management of Irrigation Systems Act, 1997 · state and market
EXAMPLE

1.5.9 Competitive federalism as public choice — NITI Aayog's indices — SDG India Index, Fiscal Health Index, Composite Water Management Index, Export Preparedness · DPIIT's Business Reforms Action Plan · quasi-market among states · reputational competition
SCHEME

1.5.10 The limits of exit and voice — Hirschman's exit-voice-loyalty is the hinge. Public choice assumes exit; Ranson and Stewart reply that citizens are not consumers. In India the poor cannot exit the PDS, the government school or the primary health centre — so voice, not choice, is the only lever.
CRITIQUE

1.6 NEW PUBLIC MANAGEMENT — THE MARKET DECADE

1.6.1 Hood's seven doctrines — Christopher Hood (1991), 'A Public Management for All Seasons?' · (1) hands-on professional management · (2) explicit standards and measures · (3) output controls · (4) disaggregation · (5) greater competition · (6) private-sector styles · (7) discipline and parsimony
CONCEPT · T0

1.6.2 Osborne and Gaebler's slogan — Reinventing Government (1992) · 'steering, not rowing' · (1) catalytic (2) community-owned (3) competitive (4) mission-driven · (5) results-oriented · (6) customer-driven (7) enterprising (8) anticipatory (9) decentralised (10) market-oriented
QUOTE · T0

1.6.3 The three Es and the missing fourth — economy, efficiency, effectiveness · NPA's equity is the fourth E · fifth · ethics · 2nd ARC's fourth report
CONCEPT

1.6.4 India's most explicit NPM import — Results Framework Document (RFD) · 2009-10 to 2014 · Performance Management Division · Prajapati Trivedi · scored · discontinued in 2014 · adopted rhetorically, not structurally
EXAMPLE · T0

1.6.5 Outcome budgeting, the survivor — Outcome Budget from 2005-06 · Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework (OOMF) · NITI Aayog · Ministry of Finance · output and outcome indicators
SCHEME

1.6.6 Citizen's Charters and Sevottam — 1997 Conference of Chief Ministers · Sevottam (2005, DARPG) · Charter, Grievance Redress, Service Delivery Capability · remedy
SCHEME

1.6.7 A charter without a remedy — statement of intent · Right to Public Services Acts — Madhya Pradesh first (2010) · Bihar (2011) · designated officer · Karnataka's Sakala · Right of Citizens for Time Bound Delivery Bill, 2011 lapsed
CRITIQUE

1.6.8 Disinvestment as NPM in India — New Public Sector Enterprise Policy, 2021 — four strategic sectors · National Monetisation Pipeline (2021) and NMP 2.0
SCHEME

1.6.9 Hood and Peters on NPM's paradox — 'The Middle Aging of New Public Management: Into the Age of Paradox' (2004) · unintended reversals · more auditors · more coordination units · more contract lawyers
CRITIQUE

1.6.10 The NPM paradox in Indian numbers — smaller state yet Union expenditure is ₹53.5 lakh crore (Budget 2026-27) · substitutes for · rowing · larger crew to steer
DATA

1.6.11 Goodhart's Law as the NPM disease — When a measure becomes a target, it ceases to be a good measure. · ODF declarations · learning outcomes · grievance 'disposal' · resolution · CPGRAMS
QUOTE

1.6.12 Has NPM failed democracy? — customer · speed and choice · citizen · standing · participates · transactions · deliberation
CRITIQUE

1.7 AFTER NPM — NPS, NEW PUBLIC GOVERNANCE, NEO-WEBERIAN, DIGITAL

1.7.1 New Public Service — the seven maxims — Denhardt and Denhardt (2000) · (1) serve citizens, not customers · (2) seek the public interest · (3) value citizenship over entrepreneurship · (4) think strategically, act democratically · (5) recognise accountability is not simple · (6) serve rather than steer · (7) value people, not just productivity
CONCEPT · T0

1.7.2 NPS's Indian instruments — RTI Act, 2005 · social audit under MGNREGA Section 17 · Gram Sabha · Jan Sunwai · MKSS in Rajasthan · before the theory reached the syllabus
INSTITUTION

1.7.3 New Public Governance — Stephen Osborne (2006) · plural (many actors deliver) and pluralist (many processes shape policy) · inter-organisational network · trust and relational contract
CONCEPT · T0

1.7.4 NPG against NPM in one line — NPM asks *who can deliver this cheapest?* NPG asks *who must be at the table for this to work at all?* The first is a **procurement** question, the second a **legitimacy** question.
CONCEPT

1.7.5 Rhodes on governance without government — "Governance refers to self-organising, inter-organisational networks characterised by interdependence, resource exchange, rules of the game and significant autonomy from the state."
QUOTE

1.7.6 The hollow state and third-party government — Rhodes' 'hollowing out' · Milward and Provan's hollow state · Salamon's third-party government · funds and regulates
CONCEPT

1.7.7 India's hollow state, named — National Health Mission · NGOs and empanelled private hospitals under PM-JAY · mid-day meals · Akshaya Patra · skilling through PPP under NSDC · SPVs under NHAI · Collector · convenes · commands
EXAMPLE

1.7.8 The Neo-Weberian State — Pollitt and Bouckaert — Europe's answer to NPM: **keep** the Weberian core (law, career service, distinct public ethos) and **add** citizen orientation, results and professionalism. "Neo" modernises; "Weberian" refuses to dismantle.
CONCEPT

1.7.9 India as a Neo-Weberian case — steel frame stayed — Articles 309-311 · AIS · e-governance, outcome frameworks and Mission Karmayogi · NPM phase · Weberian to Neo-Weberian-digital
LINKAGE

1.7.10 Digital Era Governance — Patrick Dunleavy (2006) — NPM is dead — long live digital era governance · reverse · reintegration · needs-based holism · digitisation
THINKER · T0

1.7.11 DEG proved in India — India Stack — Aadhaar (identity) · UPI · DigiLocker · Account Aggregator · ONDC · Bhashini · Reintegration · Jan Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile · Needs-based holism · UMANG · life event
EXAMPLE · TO

1.7.12 The public value frame — Mark Moore's strategic triangle · public value · authorising environment and operational capacity · capacity without authorisation or authorisation without capacity
CONCEPT

1.8 GOOD GOVERNANCE, AND THE STATE-MARKET-CIVIL SOCIETY TRIANGLE

1.8.1 The World Bank's origin of the term — Governance and Development (1992) — governance is "the manner in which power is exercised in the management of a country's economic and social resources for development." Four pillars: public sector management, accountability, a legal framework for development, information and transparency.
CONCEPT

1.8.2 UNESCAP's eight characteristics — (1) Participatory (2) consensus-oriented (3) accountable (4) transparent (5) responsive (6) effective and efficient (7) equitable and inclusive (8) following the rule of law
CONCEPT

1.8.3 Worldwide Governance Indicators — Kaufmann and Kraay's six dimensions · (1) voice and accountability (2) political stability (3) government effectiveness (4) regulatory quality (5) rule of law (6) control of corruption
It lets you say which
DATA

1.8.4 Good governance adds a normative layer — process · good · evaluates · assessable against declared standards · donor conditionality
CRITIQUE

1.8.5 Kautilya indigenises the idea — happiness of his subjects · welfare · 1992 World Bank import — Arthashastra · yogakshema · audit, espionage against corrupt officials and famine relief · "In the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare, his welfare."
QUOTE

1.8.6 India's good-governance instruments — RTI Act, 2005 — Section 4 · Section 8 · Section 19 · Section 20 · ₹25,000 · Good Governance Index (DARPG, 2019 and 2021) — 10 sectors, 58 indicators · PRAGATI (2015)
PROVISION

1.8.7 The state-market-civil society triad — UNDP (1997) · economic, political and administrative authority · balance · state failure (rigidity) · market failure (externalities, public goods) · civil society failure
CONCEPT

1.8.8 Why government must supply some goods — Non-rivalry and non-excludability (defence, street lighting) · externalities (vaccination, education) · natural monopoly (transmission, water networks) · information asymmetry (drug safety) and equity · purchasing power
CONCEPT

1.8.9 Civil society's double edge — information, mobilisation and reach — MKSS · SEWA · unrepresentative, donor-driven and obstructive · FCRA amendments (2020) · receptive
CRITIQUE

1.8.10 The regulatory state replaces the producer state — Majone's 'regulatory state' · owning · rule-making · SEBI (1992), TRAI (1997), CERC (Electricity Act, 2003), IRDAI, CCI (2002, amended 2023), IBBI (2016), Data Protection Board (DPDP Act 2023, Rules 2025)
INSTITUTION

1.8.11 Regulatory capture and the missing common law — Stigler's capture theory · Rhodes' agencification · 2nd ARC's 13th Report · FSLRC (Justice B.N. Srikrishna, 2013) · overlap, weak accountability and the absence of a common regulatory statute · Indian Financial Code
CRITIQUE

1.8.12 Globalisation and the administrative state — national policy agenda becomes international · WTO, BEPS Pillar Two, Basel III, ICAO, IHR 2005, Paris NDCs · treaty-compliance function · regulator becomes the point of contact
CONCEPT

The thinkers, in the order the discipline met them: scientific management, the classical school, Weber and his critics, Follett, human relations, Barnard, Simon, and the participative school.

2.1 SCIENTIFIC MANAGEMENT — TAYLOR AND THE SHOP FLOOR

2.1.1 Taylor's four principles — Develop a science · scientifically select and train · heartily cooperate · near-equal division of work and responsibility · The Principles of Scientific Management, 1911
CONCEPT · TO

2.1.2 Taylor's techniques — Time and motion study · functional foremanship · differential piece-rate · standardisation · exception principle
CONCEPT

2.1.3 The mental revolution — Taylor's own defence before the 1912 House Committee: scientific management requires "a complete mental revolution" on both sides — labour must stop soldiering, management must stop guessing. The surplus from science makes the wage-profit fight unnecessary.
QUOTE

2.1.4 'The system must be first' — "In the past the man has been first; in the future the system must be first." One sentence that carries both Taylor's achievement — method over intuition — and his indictment: the worker as an appendage to method.
QUOTE

2.1.5 Taylor's associates — Henry Gantt · Gantt chart · task-and-bonus · Frank and Lillian Gilbreth — therbligs · 'first lady of management' · Harrington Emerson — twelve principles of efficiency · Morris Cooke · municipal administration
CONCEPT

2.1.6 Analysis versus action — principles of analysis (how to study work scientifically) from principles of action · empirical method · managerial prescription
CRITIQUE

2.1.7 Who decides what work is worth doing? — Taylor optimised means and never asked about ends. Scientific management can make an unnecessary procedure efficient — the standing critique of process reform that leaves the process itself unexamined. Government Process Re-engineering exists precisely to ask this question first.
CRITIQUE

2.1.8 The standard critiques of Taylor — Drucker · separated planning from doing · Hoxie Report (1915) · anti-union · Oliver Sheldon · philosophy · machine model of man
CRITIQUE

2.1.9 Taylorism inside Indian administration — O&M Division (1954) · Appleby's · Department of Administrative Reforms (1964) · DARPG · Staff Inspection Unit (1964) · staffing norms by work measurement · Industrial Engineering
LINKAGE · TO

2.1.10 Taylorism's human cost, in a live Indian example — MGNREGA Schedule of Rates are built on time-and-motion measurement of earthwork. Where the norms are set unattainably high, a full day's labour earns below the notified minimum wage — Taylor's exact failure, reproduced in a rights-based statute.

EXAMPLE

2.1.11 Taylorism's contemporary form — e-Office · Special Campaign for Disposal of Pending Matters (SCDPM, DARPG) · algorithmic work allocation · faceless assessment · moved into software
LINKAGE

2.2 THE CLASSICAL SCHOOL — FAYOL, GULICK, URWICK

2.2.1 Fayol's five elements — POCCC — Planning, Organising, Commanding, Coordinating, Controlling · Administration Industrielle et Générale (1916) · from the top down · from the shop floor up
CONCEPT · TO

2.2.2 The fourteen principles worth naming — (1) unity of command one boss (2) unity of direction one plan (3) scalar chain · gangplank · (4) centralisation as a question of degree (5) esprit de corps (6) stability of tenure (7) equity Name three that fit the question not all fourteen
CONCEPT

2.2.3 Fayol's gangplank — A lateral bridge across the scalar chain, permitted when superiors authorise it, so a matter need not climb and descend the whole hierarchy. India's institutional version is the desk officer system and, in the field, the Incident Response System under the DM Act, 2005.
LINKAGE

2.2.4 POSDCORB — Gulick and Urwick (1937) — Planning, Organising, Staffing, Directing, COordinating, Reporting, Budgeting. It answers *what the chief executive does*; Simon's objection is that it never says *what government is for*.
CONCEPT · TO

2.2.5 The four Ps of departmentalisation — Purpose, Process, Persons (clientele), Place. Indian examples in one line: Purpose — Ministry of Health; Process — CPWD and the Directorate of Printing; Persons — Ministries of Tribal Affairs, Minority Affairs, WCD; Place — Ministry of DoNER, the Andaman and Nicobar Administration.
LINKAGE · TO

2.2.6 Gulick on work division — "Work division is the foundation of organization; indeed, the reason for organization." And his efficiency axiom: "efficiency is axiom number one in the value scale of administration" — the sentence Waldo spent a book demolishing.
QUOTE

2.2.7 Span of control — Graicunas · geometrically · Urwick · five or six · narrow span · tall hierarchy · wide span · flat one
CONCEPT

2.2.8 India's span-of-control problem — Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary → Director → Joint Secretary → Additional Secretary → Secretary · 2nd ARC's 13th Report · three levels · desk officer system · ARC-I in 1968

CRITIQUE · T0

2.2.9 Mooney and Reiley — Onward Industry (1931) · coordinative principle · scalar process · functional effect · coordination is the first principle

THINKER

2.2.10 Classical theory in Indian rules — POSDCORB is written into Indian law · Government of India (Allocation of Business) Rules, 1961 · Transaction of Business Rules, 1961 · Secretariat-executive agency · policy-versus-implementation

LINKAGE

2.2.11 The scientific-management versus human-relations contrast — efficiency · method, measurement and money · attention, group norms and belonging · Herzberg · hygiene and motivators

CONCEPT

2.3 WEBER — THE BUREAUCRATIC MODEL

2.3.1 Weber's three types of authority — Traditional · charismatic (devotion to an exceptional person) · legal-rational · Bureaucracy is the administrative apparatus of legal-rational authority.

CONCEPT · T0

2.3.2 The characteristics of the ideal type — (1) Fixed jurisdictional areas (2) hierarchy of offices (3) management by written documents (4) expert training (5) the official's full working capacity (6) stable exhaustive rules (7) impersonality (8) a career (9) office separated from the person

CONCEPT · T0

2.3.3 Weber's own claim for it — capable of attaining the highest degree of efficiency · formally the most rational · authority over human beings · formally · procedural

QUOTE

2.3.4 The iron cage — Stahlhartes Gehäuse — rationalisation traps its makers: "specialists without spirit, sensualists without heart." And the political warning: "the ruled cannot dispense with or replace the bureaucratic apparatus of authority once it exists."

QUOTE · T0

2.3.5 The ideal type is a yardstick, not a portrait — methodological construct · exaggeration of essential features · measure deviation · misses what an ideal type is for

CONCEPT · T0

2.3.6 Routinisation of charisma — inherently unstable · routinised · movement-led scheme · rules, cadre and a budget line

CONCEPT

2.3.7 Weber's model in Indian constitutional form — Article 309 (recruitment and conditions) · Article 310 (pleasure doctrine) · Article 311 · CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 and CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 · steel frame · career service with tenure

PROVISION · T0

2.3.8 Why India cannot simply de-Weberise — ascriptive hierarchy · impersonality is emancipatory · flexibility and discretion · restores the very particularism

LINKAGE · T0

2.3.9 Marx on bureaucracy — imaginary state · spiritualism of the state · instrument of the dominant class · own interest · general interest

CRITIQUE

2.3.10 Weber and the algorithm — The 2026 frontier. Algorithmic decision-making is legal-rational authority automated: fixed jurisdiction, written rule, impersonality, no discretion. It perfects the iron cage — and removes the human official who could be argued with, appealed to, or held accountable.

LINKAGE

2.4 THE CRITICS AND POST-WEBERIAN DEVELOPMENTS

2.4.1 Merton — trained incapacity — 'Bureaucratic Structure and Personality' (1940) · reliability · overconformity · incapacity · means displace the ends · bureaucratic virtuoso

CRITIQUE · T0

2.4.2 Goal displacement, seen in India — The RTI reply that answers the question asked and not the one meant; grievance 'disposal' rates on CPGRAMS counted as redress; a scheme measured by funds utilised rather than outcomes. Merton's mechanism is the single most usable critique in Indian answers.

EXAMPLE · T0

2.4.3 Selznick — co-optation — TVA and the Grass Roots (1949) · hostile external elements into its leadership · changed by them · Formal · informal · sub-goal formation · unanticipated consequences of purposive social action

CRITIQUE · T0

2.4.4 Co-optation in Indian institutions — Elite capture of Water User Associations and forest committees; the Community Development Programme's absorption by dominant rural castes — the failure Balwantrai Mehta diagnosed in 1957; sarpanch pati substituting for the elected woman representative.

EXAMPLE

2.4.5 Gouldner — three bureaucratic patterns — Patterns of Industrial Bureaucracy (1954) — mock bureaucracy · representative bureaucracy · punishment-centred bureaucracy · indulgency pattern

CRITIQUE

2.4.6 Crozier — the vicious circle — The Bureaucratic Phenomenon (1964) · an organisation that cannot correct its behaviour by learning from its errors · zones of uncertainty · power resources · more rules

CRITIQUE · T0

2.4.7 Michels — the iron law of oligarchy — Who says organisation says oligarchy. · specialised leadership · own continuance · political parties, trade unions and cooperatives · panchayat federations

CRITIQUE

2.4.8 Bureau-pathology — The cluster of dysfunctions — **red tape**, buck-passing, rule-worship, empire-building, over-caution, secrecy. Its damage is that it **penalises the competent**: the officer who decides is exposed, the one who circulates the file is safe.

CONCEPT

2.4.9 Post-bureaucratic organisational forms — Warren Bennis · death of bureaucracy · organic-adaptive, temporary task systems — adhocracy · Toffler · Mintzberg

CONCEPT

2.4.10 Why bureaucracy did not die — Missions, SPVs, societies and task forces · around · NHM societies, Smart City SPVs, NDMA's Incident Response System · Secretariat, the cadre and the file survived intact · layer · replacement

LINKAGE

2.5 FOLLETT — DYNAMIC ADMINISTRATION

2.5.1 The law of the situation — Follett's · depersonalise the order · both take their orders from the situation · facts of the case · position of the speaker · power-with **not** power-over

CONCEPT · T0

2.5.2 Integration over domination and compromise — domination (one side wins) · compromise (both give up something) · integration · neither side sacrifices anything · real underlying demands · constructive · creative

CONCEPT

2.5.3 Follett on either-or — "We should never allow ourselves to be bullied by an 'either-or'." And on authority: "Authority should go with knowledge and experience... no matter whether it is up the line or down." Two quotations that fit any conflict, leadership or expertise question.

QUOTE

2.5.4 Her other contributions — Circular response · the group principle · through · coordination as a continuous process · direct contact · earliest stage **through** reciprocal relating

CONCEPT

2.5.5 Why she is called the prophet of management — Drucker · 1920s · human relations (before Hawthorne) · participative management · conflict as constructive · matrix authority **and** stakeholder thinking · political science and social work

THINKER

2.5.6 Follett bridges classical and behavioural — She accepted the classical concern with **coordination and authority** but relocated both in **psychology and group process** — making her the **hinge** between Taylor's mechanics and Mayo's sociology.

CONCEPT

2.5.7 Follett in Indian institutions — GST Council · Article 279A · consensus · PRAGATI · direct contact at the earliest stage · Incident Response System · law of the situation

LINKAGE · T0

2.5.8 The limit of integration — discoverable common interest · distributive — river water between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu · land acquisition · who loses · adjudication and politics

CRITIQUE

2.6 HUMAN RELATIONS — MAYO AND HAWTHORNE

2.6.1 The Hawthorne studies — Western Electric, 1924-32 · illumination experiments (output rose whatever the lighting) · relay assembly test room · mass interviewing programme (20,000 interviews) · bank wiring observation room · Elton Mayo, Roethlisberger and Dickson

CONCEPT · T0

2.6.2 What Hawthorne actually found — social relations · informal group · production norms · rate-buster · chiseller · Non-economic rewards

CONCEPT

2.6.3 The Hawthorne effect — Behaviour changes because subjects know they are **being observed**. Its administrative use is double-edged: **attention itself** improves performance — which explains why **PRAGATI review** and **inspection work**, and why their effect **decays** once attention moves elsewhere.

CONCEPT

2.6.4 Mayo's rabble hypothesis — Mayo rejected the 'rabble hypothesis' — the classical assumption that society is a horde of unorganised individuals each acting from self-interest. Man is a **social animal** seeking **belonging**; industrial society's disease is **anomie**, and the workplace group is the remedy.

THINKER

2.6.5 Formal organisations are made of informal groups — not a defect · condition of its working · speed · information (the grapevine) **and** social control · slows and hardens

CONCEPT

2.6.6 The standard critiques of human relations — Pro-management bias · No place for conflict · Clark Kerr's · cow sociology · Methodologically weak · Carey's

CRITIQUE

2.6.7 Is Mayo still relevant? — Hybrid and platform work · team belonging · deliberately designed · batch, the cadre and the mess · cohesion **and** cadre parochialism

CRITIQUE

2.6.8 Human relations inside Indian administration — Joint Consultative Machinery (1966) · National, Departmental and Office Councils **with** compulsory arbitration · service associations · behavioural competencies · Mission Karmayogi's FRAC

LINKAGE

2.7 BARNARD — FUNCTIONS OF THE EXECUTIVE

2.7.1 Barnard's definition of organisation — consciously coordinated activities or forces of two or more persons · activities, not people · cooperative system · willingly renewed

CONCEPT

2.7.2 The three executive functions — Maintain a system of communication · secure essential services from individuals · formulate and define purpose · communication first · reach one another

CONCEPT

2.7.3 Acceptance theory of authority — Authority resides in the subordinate, not the office. · understands · consistent with organisational purpose · personal interest · mentally and physically able · The one who obeys confers the authority.

CONCEPT · T0

2.7.4 The zone of indifference — without conscious question · width · inducements, fairness and legitimacy · arbitrary or unlawful · illegal transfer order

CONCEPT · T0

2.7.5 Efficiency versus effectiveness, Barnard's sense — Effectiveness · organisation's purpose · Efficiency · individual's motives · effective inducements in sufficient quantity · equilibrium

CONCEPT

2.7.6 Economy of incentives — weak · non-material · prestige, participation, ideal benefaction, associational attractiveness · persuasion · want · get

CONCEPT

2.7.7 The executive as moral creator — The executive's distinctive task is "the creation of moral codes for others" — resolving conflicts between codes (legal, professional, personal, organisational) by inventing a higher one. This is Barnard's answer to "I was only obeying orders", and the reason he belongs in an ethics answer.

QUOTE

2.7.8 Barnard applied to the Indian officer — CCS (Conduct) Rule 3(3)(iii) · confirmed in writing · narrowing the zone of indifference · T.S.R. Subramanian v. Union of India (2013) · Civil Services Board and minimum tenure

LINKAGE

2.8 SIMON — THE DECISION-MAKING SCHOOL

2.8.1 Administrative Behavior's central claim — Simon (1947) — decision-making is the heart of administration · task · decision premise · supply the premises

CONCEPT · T0

2.8.2 Fact and value premises — Every decision mixes a factual premise (testable — will this work?) and a value premise (not testable — should it be done?). Administration can be scientific about facts; values come from politics. This is Simon's reconstruction of the dichotomy on a defensible footing.

CONCEPT

2.8.3 Bounded rationality — Human rationality is bounded by incomplete knowledge of alternatives, inability to foresee all consequences, and limited computational capacity. The decision-maker constructs a simplified model of the situation and behaves rationally with respect to that model.

CONCEPT · T0

2.8.4 Satisficing — maximise · aspiration level · first alternative that is good enough · Administrative man satisfices; economic man maximises. · psychological · rational

CONCEPT · T0

2.8.5 Programmed and non-programmed decisions — Programmed · habit, standard operating procedure and rules · software · Non-programmed · judgement, intuition and heuristics · traditional and modern

CONCEPT

2.8.6 Decision-making as narrowing choice — "the process of decisions... is largely a technique of narrowing choices." Organisation narrows by hierarchy, rules, training, communication channels and the vocabulary of the file — long before the officer consciously deliberates.

CONCEPT

2.8.7 Simon's phases of decision — Intelligence (finding occasions for decision) → Design (developing alternatives) → Choice (selecting one) → Review · funnel narrowing under bounded rationality

CONCEPT

2.8.8 Criticisms of Simon — Chris Argyris · suppresses emotion and self-actualisation · Waldo · Others · how · whose interests

CRITIQUE

2.8.9 Simon inside the Indian file — Cabinet Note · premise-supplying device · Incremental budgeting · previous year's base · Economic Survey's nudge chapter

LINKAGE

2.9 PARTICIPATIVE MANAGEMENT — MCGREGOR, LIKERT, ARGYRIS

2.9.1 Theory X and Theory Y — McGregor (The Human Side of Enterprise, 1960) — X · dislike work · coercion and control · Y · self-direction

CONCEPT · T0

2.9.2 Why Theory X is self-fulfilling — multiple countersignatures, no delegation, punishment for error · stop taking decisions · file culture · Theory X system · risk-averse bureaucracy

CRITIQUE

2.9.3 Likert's four systems — System 1 exploitative-authoritative · 2 benevolent-authoritative · 3 consultative · 4 participative group · System 4 · linking pin · member of two groups · upward

CONCEPT

2.9.4 Argyris's immaturity-maturity continuum — passivity to activity · dependence to independence · shallow to deep interests · short to long time perspective · subordinate to equal position · low to high self-awareness · demands the immature end · apathy, defensiveness and exit

CONCEPT

2.9.5 Argyris on organisational learning — Single-loop learning corrects the error; double-loop learning questions the governing rule that produced it. Bureaucracies excel at the first and avoid the second — which is Crozier's vicious circle stated in learning terms.

CONCEPT

2.9.6 The common thread — All three argue that structure shapes personality, not the reverse. The apathetic official is a product of the organisation's design. Therefore the reform lever is job design, delegation and participation, not exhortation or training alone.

CONCEPT

2.9.7 Participation in Indian administration — Joint Consultative Machinery · Gram Sabha and ward committees · Mission Karmayogi's · rule-based to role-based · 360-degree · System 3 consultative · System 4

LINKAGE

2.9.8 The limits of participative management in government — statutory duties that cannot be delegated · hierarchical answerability to Parliament · coercive effect on third parties · how · whether

CRITIQUE

How administrators actually decide, are moved to act, lead, communicate and fall out. Decision models beyond Simon, the content and process theories of motivation, leadership, communication, morale and conflict.

3.1 DECISION-MAKING BEYOND SIMON

3.1.1 The rational-comprehensive model — Define the problem, rank **all** goals, list **all** alternatives, cost **all** consequences, choose the **optimum**. It is the standard against which every other model is a **retreat** — and it is impossible for exactly the reasons **Simon** gave.

CONCEPT

3.1.2 Lindblom's incrementalism — 'The Science of Muddling Through' (1959) — successive limited comparisons · marginally different from the status quo · together · agreement

CONCEPT · T0

3.1.3 Partisan mutual adjustment — Lindblom's answer to the charge of drift: **coordination without a coordinator**. Many partisans, each watching a **different** value, adjust to one another; the resulting policy attends to **more** interests than any central planner could hold in mind.

CONCEPT

3.1.4 Etzioni's mixed scanning — Two lenses. A **broad-angle** scan for **fundamental** decisions (direction, at low detail) and a **zoom** for **incremental** ones inside that frame. It rescues incrementalism from **conservatism** and rationalism from **paralysis** — the practical Indian model.

CONCEPT · T0

3.1.5 Mixed scanning, Indian illustration — Viksit Bharat @2047 · broad scan · annual budget · incremental zoom · National Education Policy 2020 · curricular and regulatory orders

EXAMPLE

3.1.6 Dror's normative-optimum model — Yehezkel Dror · pro-inertia · no past · meta-policymaking · how to decide · extra-rational · judgement, creativity, intuition

CONCEPT

3.1.7 The garbage can model — Cohen, March and Olsen (1972) · organised anarchy · problems, solutions, participants and choice opportunities · timing, not logic · precede

CONCEPT · T0

3.1.8 Where the garbage can fits India — A pre-existing scheme design attaching itself to a **new crisis**; a **ready technology** searching for a mandate. **Aadhaar** began as a **solution** and successively found problems — subsidy leakage, banking, KYC, welfare targeting — over a decade.

EXAMPLE

3.1.9 Behavioural insights and the nudge — Kahneman and Tversky's · Thaler and Sunstein's · libertarian paternalism · Default rules · Ujjwala's · Give-It-Up · Swachh Bharat's · Economic Survey 2018-19

CONCEPT

3.1.10 The decision models compared, in one line — Rational — what we should do; **incremental** — what we can agree on; **mixed scanning** — how to do both at two altitudes; **garbage can** — what actually happens when nobody is in charge.

CONCEPT · T0

3.2 MOTIVATION — THE CONTENT THEORIES

3.2.1 Maslow's hierarchy — Physiological → safety → social → esteem → self-actualisation · prepotent · satisfied need ceases to motivate · safety (transfer insecurity) · esteem

CONCEPT · T0

3.2.2 Alderfer's ERG — Existence, Relatedness, Growth · more than one need can operate at once · frustration-regression · growth · existence · pay and allowances

CONCEPT

3.2.3 Herzberg's two-factor theory — Hygiene factors · dissatisfaction · Motivators · satisfaction · not opposite ends of one scale

CONCEPT · T0

3.2.4 Herzberg applied to Indian services — Pay Commissions · hygiene · 8th CPC · 3 November 2025 · Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai · 50 lakh employees and 69 lakh pensioners · Job enrichment

LINKAGE

3.2.5 McClelland's three needs — Achievement (nAch) · Affiliation (nAff) · Power (nPow) · personalised power (dominance) versus socialised power

CONCEPT · T0

3.2.6 Public service motivation — Perry and Wise · rational (policy-making attraction) · norm-based (duty, public interest) and affective (compassion) · hardship postings

CONCEPT

3.2.7 The crowding-out warning — Frey's motivation crowding theory — extrinsic rewards can **destroy** intrinsic ones. Pay a citizen to do what she did from duty and she stops doing it for free. This is the strongest argument against **crude performance pay** in the public service.

CRITIQUE

3.2.8 Money is the weakest lever in Indian government — fixed by grade · seniority · hard · posting, empanelment, recognition, and a superior who will back a decision

CRITIQUE

3.2.9 Content versus process theories — Same object — the energising of behaviour; different **question**. **Content** asks **what** motivates (Maslow, Herzberg, McClelland, Alderfer); **process** asks **how** motivation is formed and sustained (Vroom, Adams, Locke, Skinner).

CONCEPT · T0

3.3 MOTIVATION — THE PROCESS THEORIES

3.3.1 Vroom's expectancy theory — Motivation = Expectancy × Instrumentality × Valence. Effort must be believed to produce **performance**; performance to produce a **reward**; the reward must be **wanted**. Any term at zero makes the product zero — the cleanest diagnostic in the whole motivation literature.

CONCEPT · T0

3.3.2 Expectancy failure in Indian government — Instrumentality is near zero · promotion follows seniority · cluster at 'outstanding' · Surinder Nath (2003) and Hota (2004)

LINKAGE

3.3.3 Porter and Lawler's extension — They add that performance causes satisfaction — not the reverse — and only when the reward is seen as equitable. They also insert abilities and role perception: an officer who misreads the role produces effort that yields no performance.

CONCEPT

3.3.4 Adams's equity theory — People compare their outcome-to-input ratio with a referent other. Perceived inequity produces tension resolved by reducing effort, inflating perceived inputs, changing the referent, or leaving. Explains cadre grievances over pay parity and empanelment better than any absolute measure.

CONCEPT · T0

3.3.5 Locke's goal-setting theory — Specific and difficult · accepted · feedback and commitment · outcome budgeting · RFD · Aspirational Districts

CONCEPT

3.3.6 Reinforcement and behaviour modification — Skinner · consequences · Positive reinforcement · negative reinforcement · punishment · extinction · schedules · punishment and extinction · suppress initiative

CONCEPT

3.3.7 Self-determination theory — Deci and Ryan · autonomy, competence and relatedness · Mission Karmayogi's · minimum tenure · all three

CONCEPT

3.4 LEADERSHIP

3.4.1 The trait to behaviour to contingency progression — Traits (great men) → behaviour (what leaders do) → contingency (what works, when) → transformational

CONCEPT

3.4.2 The Ohio and Michigan studies — Ohio State · initiating structure and consideration · Michigan · production-centred versus employee-centred · opposite ends of one scale

CONCEPT

3.4.3 Blake and Mouton's managerial grid — Concern for production against concern for people · 1,1 impoverished; 9,1 task; 1,9 country club; 5,5 middle-of-the-road; 9,9 team · 9,9 is universally best

CONCEPT

3.4.4 Reddin's 3-D theory — third dimension — effectiveness · effective or ineffective depending on the situation · benevolent autocrat or autocrat · executive or compromiser

CONCEPT

3.4.5 Fiedler's contingency model — fixed · Least Preferred Co-worker · situation · leader-member relations, task structure, position power · Task-oriented · very favourable and very unfavourable · relationship-oriented · middle

CONCEPT

3.4.6 Hersey and Blanchard's situational leadership — Style follows follower readiness: telling → selling → participating → delegating. Directly usable on cadre management — a probationer needs telling, a Collector of ten years' standing needs delegating, and reversing the two destroys both.

CONCEPT

3.4.7 Transactional versus transformational — James MacGregor Burns (1978) · Bass · Transactional · Transformational — idealised influence, inspirational motivation, intellectual stimulation, individualised consideration · raise one another to higher levels of motivation and morality

CONCEPT · T0

3.4.8 Servant leadership — Robert Greenleaf · servant first · do those served grow as persons? · Gandhi's talisman · weakest citizen · “The best test is: do those served grow as persons?”

QUOTE

3.4.9 Strategic leadership — leadership · anticipatory · authorising environment · capacity for the next problem · Mark Moore's

CONCEPT

3.4.10 Leadership and accountability for failure — ownership of failure · recording reasons · audit and parliamentary scrutiny · blame-shifting down the hierarchy

CRITIQUE

3.4.11 Leadership migrating to the aggressive — In conflict, assertiveness is mistaken for competence and the emotionally mature are read as weak. The correction is structural, not exhortatory — chairing rules, minuted dissent, written orders — so that the loudest voice does not become the decision.

CRITIQUE

3.4.12 Named Indian administrative leadership — E. Sreedharan at DMRC — deadlines, delegation, resignation offered for a single accident. T.N. Seshan — statutory power used to its constitutional edge. Armstrong Pame, the 'people's IAS officer', built a road by crowdfunding. One named instance beats a paragraph of adjectives.

EXAMPLE

3.5 COMMUNICATION

3.5.1 Communication as the first executive function — Barnard · is · Deutsch · steering system and information is the steering · cannot correct itself

CONCEPT

3.5.2 Downward, upward and horizontal — Downward carries authority · distorted by dilution · Upward carries information · distorted by filtering · Horizontal carries coordination

CONCEPT · T0

3.5.3 Why upward communication fails — incentive is inverted · inspection · social audit · CPGRAMS · PMO's PRAGATI · looks at the data directly

CRITIQUE

3.5.4 The grapevine — fast, filters gaps left by formal channels, and carries morale information · carries rumour and cannot be corrected · speed · timely formal information

CONCEPT

3.5.5 Bavelas's communication networks — Wheel · low member satisfaction · Chain · Circle · All-channel · complex, non-routine · task · chain

CONCEPT

3.5.6 Barriers to communication — Semantic (jargon, language) · physical (distance, technology) · psychological (fear, selective perception) · organisational (hierarchy, span, secrecy) and cultural (status distance) · status distance and English

CONCEPT

3.5.7 Headquarters–field communication — rules and money · facts and consequences · two-way flow · substantive rather than compliance-seeking · Video conferencing collapsed distance, not status distance

LINKAGE

3.5.8 A narrow view of information — data to be stored · intelligence to be used · MIS · upward reporting · decision support at the level that acts

LINKAGE

3.5.9 Communication in Indian statutory form — RTI Section 4 · suo motu disclosure · right · Official Secrets Act, 1923 · 2nd ARC's first report · National Security Act

PROVISION

3.6 MORALE, CONFLICT AND PERSONALITY AT WORK

3.6.1 Morale and motivation distinguished — Morale is a group condition; motivation is an individual state. · attitude to the organisation · drive toward a task · contented, idle office · burnout

CONCEPT · T0

3.6.2 What determines morale — (1) Fairness of the reward system (2) security of tenure (3) quality of supervision (4) group cohesion (5) the sense that the work matters (6) the organisation's public reputation In the Indian services arbitrary transfers

CONCEPT

3.6.3 Groupthink — Irving Janis · (1) illusion of invulnerability (2) collective rationalisation (3) stereotyping of outsiders (4) self-censorship (5) illusion of unanimity (6) direct pressure on doubters (7) self-appointed mindguards Antidotes a devil's advocate · dissent · speaks last

CONCEPT · T0

3.6.4 The value of the dissenting note — noting system · structural antidote to groupthink · oral instructions · CCS Conduct Rule 3(3) (iii)

LINKAGE

3.6.5 Sources of organisational conflict — Structural — line versus staff, overlapping jurisdiction, scarce resources; interpersonal — personality, status; role-based — role ambiguity, role conflict, role overload. The type must be identified before any remedy is prescribed; each answers to a different fix.

CONCEPT

3.6.6 Thomas's five conflict-handling modes — assertiveness and cooperativeness · (1) competing (2) accommodating (3) avoiding (4) compromising (5) collaborating Collaborating · integration · avoiding

CONCEPT

3.6.7 Conflict is not always dysfunctional — interactionist · stagnation and groupthink · paralysis · managing conflict to an optimum and institutionalising · Inter-State Council · GST Council and tribunals

CONCEPT

3.6.8 Emotional intelligence — Goleman's five components · (1) self-awareness (2) self-regulation (3) motivation (4) empathy (5) social skill In administration it converts legal authority into acceptance

CONCEPT

3.6.9 Personality and administrative behaviour — Type A/B; the Big Five (openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, neuroticism — conscientiousness predicts job performance best); Rotter's locus of control — internals take initiative, externals attribute outcomes to circumstance. FRAC competencies under Mission Karmayogi try to select for these.

CONCEPT

3.6.10 The behavioural approach's own limits — observable and measurable · power, class and ideology · laboratory findings · statutory duty and coercive power · culture-bound

CRITIQUE

Organisation theory and the Indian public sector are one question — what form should an activity take, and who then answers for it. Systems and contingency theory, the departmental-corporation-company choice, regulators, PPP, and PSU autonomy.

4.1 THEORIES OF ORGANISATION

4.1.1 The three streams — Classical · Neo-classical · Modern — systems and contingency · open system with no single best design

CONCEPT

4.1.2 Systems theory — Katz and Kahn · Bertalanffy's · imports energy, throughputs, exports output · feedback · negative entropy · homeostasis and equifinality · different routes

CONCEPT · TO

4.1.3 Why 'open system' matters administratively — A closed-system view treats failure as **internal** — bad staff, poor rules. An open-system view forces the **environmental** question: the scheme failed because the **ecology** — literacy, banking density, caste structure — did not supply what the design assumed.

CONCEPT

4.1.4 The socio-technical system — Trist and Bamforth's Tavistock coal-mining studies — technical and social subsystems must be **jointly optimised**. Change the technology alone and performance falls. The direct Indian lesson: **digitising a process without redesigning the roles around it** reliably disappoints.

CONCEPT

4.1.5 Contingency theory — no one best way · environment, technology and size · Burns and Stalker — mechanistic · organic

CONCEPT · TO

4.1.6 External fit and internal fit — External fit · environment's · Internal fit · subsystems consistent with one another · Lawrence and Lorsch · differentiation · integration

CONCEPT · TO

4.1.7 Woodward and Thompson on technology — Joan Woodward · production technology (unit, mass, process) · James Thompson · interdependence · pooled (coordinate by rules) · sequential (by plans) · reciprocal (by mutual adjustment) · why

CONCEPT

4.1.8 Organisation theory is a loose set, not a theory — The field's plurality is **appropriate to its object**. A single theory of organisation would have to be **indifferent to purpose, technology, scale and culture** — and would therefore say nothing usable about any actual organisation.

CRITIQUE

4.1.9 Contingency in Indian administrative design — Mechanistic · treasury, examination, land records · Organic · disaster response under the Incident Response System · war-room COVID management · Aspirational Districts · mechanistic · organic

LINKAGE

4.1.10 The limits of contingency theory — It is **descriptive**, not **predictive** — it names the variables without ranking them; it assumes managers can **choose** structure, when in government the structure is **statutory**; and it under-weights **power**, treating design as a technical rather than a **political** choice.

CRITIQUE

4.2 STRUCTURE AND FORMS OF ORGANISATION

4.2.1 The three organisational forms compared — Department — full ministerial control, budgeted through the legislature, no separate legal personality. **Corporation** — created by a **special statute**, autonomy defined by that statute. **Company** — incorporated under the **Companies Act, 2013**, flexible, easy to create and to wind up.

CONCEPT · TO

4.2.2 Departmental undertaking — Maximum control, minimum flexibility. · Consolidated Fund · civil servants · CAG · Railways · Posts · All India Radio · ordnance factories

INSTITUTION · TO

4.2.3 Statutory corporation — special Act · as wide as the statute makes it · LIC (1956), FCI (1964), Airports Authority, Damodar Valley Corporation (1948) · amending the Act to change anything

INSTITUTION · TO

4.2.4 Government company — Section 2(45), Companies Act 2013 — not less than **51%** paid-up capital held by government. Easy to form by executive decision, flexible on staffing and pay. The critique is constitutional: it **escapes legislative scrutiny** at birth — a public enterprise created without a debate.

INSTITUTION · TO

4.2.5 Boards and commissions — board is plural-headed for deliberation and expertise · commission · plural and independent · insulation from the executive · impartiality · speed

CONCEPT · TO

4.2.6 Single versus plural headship — Single gives promptness, clear responsibility, decisiveness · executive · Plural gives deliberation, representation of interests and protection from arbitrariness · quasi-judicial, regulatory and advisory · function

CONCEPT

4.2.7 Line, staff and auxiliary agencies — Line performs the primary purpose (a district administration, a police station). **Staff** advises and plans **without command authority** (Cabinet Secretariat, planning cells). **Auxiliary** supplies common services (GeM, CPWD, Directorate of Printing). Confusing **line and staff authority** is the classic source of conflict.

CONCEPT · TO

4.2.8 Chief executive — the four distinctions — Political versus permanent · single versus plural · real versus nominal · directly elected, indirectly elected, appointed · real · Shamsher Singh v. State of Punjab (1974)

CONCEPT

4.2.9 Ad hoc and advisory bodies — Commissions of inquiry · Commissions of Inquiry Act, 1952 · task forces · committees of secretaries · standing advisory councils · speed and specialist input · decision avoidance · is

INSTITUTION

4.2.10 Matrix and project structures — Dual reporting · time-bound, multi-disciplinary · unity of command · Smart City SPVs · mission directorates · District Disaster Management Authority

CONCEPT

4.3 HEADQUARTERS AND FIELD

4.3.1 The division of labour between them — Headquarters — policy, rules, standards, resource allocation, evaluation. Field — application to the concrete case, local intelligence, delivery. The relationship fails when headquarters does **case work** and the field is left doing **reporting**.

CONCEPT

4.3.2 Deconcentration is not decentralisation — headquarters relocated · Deconcentration · offices · decentralisation · decisions

CONCEPT

4.3.3 Why field agencies are necessary — Local knowledge · speed of response · adaptation to variation · legitimacy of a visible official · 11 agro-climatic zones and 2.55 lakh gram panchayats

LINKAGE

4.3.4 The recurring HQ-field pathologies — Over-reporting · rule rigidity (no room for local variation) · resource dependence (funds released late in the year) **and** status distance

CRITIQUE

4.3.5 How India tries to fix it — Video-conferencing review (PRAGATI) · Aspirational Districts · live in the district · DISHA · e-Office · status distance did not

INSTITUTION

4.3.6 Delegation, deconcentration, decentralisation, devolution — Delegation · revocable · Deconcentration · Decentralisation · Devolution — statutory · functions, funds and functionaries · autonomous elected body · 73rd and 74th Amendments

CONCEPT · TO

4.4 REGULATORY AUTHORITIES

4.4.1 Why regulators exist — Natural monopoly (transmission, ports) · information asymmetry (drugs, insurance) · externalities (pollution) · credible commitment · rule-making **for** ownership

CONCEPT · TO

4.4.2 The Indian regulatory map — RBI · SEBI (1992) · TRAI (1997) · CERC and SERCs · Electricity Act, 2003 · IRDAI · PNGRB · CCI · Competition Act, 2002 · 2023 **with** deal-value thresholds · FSSAI · IBBI (2016) · Data Protection Board · DPDP Act, 2023 · 2025

INSTITUTION

4.4.3 The regulator's three functions in one body — makes · administers · adjudicates · efficiency · constitutional problem · appeal to a tribunal (TDSAT, APTEL, SAT, NCLAT) **and** judicial review

CRITIQUE

4.4.4 Are regulators independent? — appointments by government · policy directions · post-retirement placements · revolving door

CRITIQUE · TO

4.4.5 Regulatory capture — Stigler · acquired by the industry · concentrated interest and superior information · diffuse · Cultural capture · frame of the problem

CRITIQUE

4.4.6 The demise of the arbitrator state? — changed instruments · producing · rule-making · more · arbitrator state intensified

CRITIQUE

4.4.7 India's missing regulatory law — 2nd ARC's 13th Report · FSLRC (Justice B.N. Srikrishna, 2013) · overlap, weak accountability and no common statute · Indian Financial Code · NITI Aayog

CRITIQUE

4.4.8 TRAI as the examinable instance — tariff orders · quality-of-service regulations · mobile number portability · Do Not Disturb · mandatory public comment · licensing **are** not binding

EXAMPLE

4.5 PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP

4.5.1 What a PPP actually is — long-term contract · finances, builds and operates · user charges or annuity **with** risk allocated to whoever can bear it best · mode of delivery

CONCEPT · TO

4.5.2 Kelkar Committee's governing principle — Committee on Revisiting and Revitalising the PPP Model (Vijay Kelkar, 2015) — PPP should not be seen as a source of funding but as a mode of delivering better services · Infrastructure PPP Adjudication Tribunal · renegotiation as a normal event

COMMITTEE

4.5.3 The Indian PPP toolkit — Viability Gap Funding · Model Concession Agreements · Hybrid Annuity Model · 40% construction support, 60% annuity · PPPAC · InvITs

SCHEME

4.5.4 Where PPP fails — Optimistic traffic and demand forecasts · renegotiation · contingent liabilities · thin markets

CRITIQUE

4.5.5 The accountability question — The citizen's remedy against a concessionaire is **contractual**, not **constitutional** — no RTI as of right, no **Article 226** against a private party except where it discharges a **public function**, no **CAG** audit unless the contract provides for it.

CRITIQUE

4.5.6 PPP as a governance form — procurement technique · structure of governance · contract manager · engineering to negotiation, risk pricing and enforcement

LINKAGE

4.5.7 The 2nd ARC on PPP — transparent competitive bidding · clear risk-sharing written into the concession · independent regulator · grievance redress for users

COMMITTEE

4.5.8 PPP and the entropy of models — A **closed** model is self-contained and predictable; an **open** one exchanges with its environment and resists decay. PPP forces a **closed** bureaucratic organisation into an **open** contractual environment — importing **market energy** and also **market risk** it cannot price.

CONCEPT

4.6 THE PUBLIC SECTOR IN INDIA

4.6.1 Why India built a public sector — Industrial Policy Resolution, 1956 · Mahalanobis · capital scarcity · heavy industry · balanced regional development · employment · concentration of economic power · temples of modern India

SCHEME · T0

4.6.2 The 1956 Resolution's three schedules — Schedule A — 17 industries exclusively for the state (arms, atomic energy, railways, heavy industry). Schedule B — 12 industries progressively state-owned. Schedule C — the rest, left to the private sector. This is the architecture the 1991 policy dismantled.

PROVISION

4.6.3 The 1991 turn — New Industrial Policy, 1991 · 17 to 8 · 2 (atomic energy, railways) · licensing abolished · MRTP · BIFR · disinvestment

SCHEME

4.6.4 The current policy — New Public Sector Enterprise Policy, 2021 — four strategic sectors · bare-minimum · privatisation or closure

SCHEME

4.6.5 Maharatna, Navratna, Miniratna — graded autonomy · Maharatna · ₹5,000 crore or 15% of net worth · Navratna · ₹1,000 crore · Miniratna I · ₹500 crore · financial delegation

SCHEME

4.6.6 The MoU system — Arjun Sengupta Committee, 1987-88 · performance contract · financial and non-financial · NPM · Department of Public Enterprises

INSTITUTION

4.6.7 Performance beyond the balance sheet — A PSU carries social obligations a private firm does not — universal service, strategic supply, regional development, employment. Judge it on capacity utilisation, technology absorption, safety, energy intensity, CSR under Section 135 and social cost-benefit, not profit alone.

LINKAGE

4.6.8 The public sector's real record — capabilities no private firm would have — ISRO, BHEL, ONGC, IOCL, the DRDO chain, LIC's household savings mobilisation · chronic loss-makers · overstaffing · licence-era rent structure

CRITIQUE

4.6.9 Evans's embedded autonomy — Peter Evans (Embedded Autonomy, 1995) · autonomous · embedded · space and atomic energy · licensing system · capture

LINKAGE · T0

4.7 AUTONOMY, ACCOUNTABILITY AND DISINVESTMENT

4.7.1 Is autonomy a myth? — executive delegation, not statute · administrative ministry · board's composition · capex approval · CMD's appointment through the PESB · delegated financial power

CRITIQUE · T0

4.7.2 The autonomy–accountability paradox — The classic statement: the more autonomy an enterprise is given, the weaker the citizen's chain of accountability becomes; the tighter the accountability, the less it can behave commercially. There is no design that removes the tension — only choices about where to sit on it.

CONCEPT · T0

4.7.3 How PSUs are actually controlled — Parliament · Committee on Public Undertakings (COPU) · CAG · Section 143(5)-(6), Companies Act 2013 · supplementary audit · non-review certificate · Executive · PESB

INSTITUTION

4.7.4 Appleby's dissent on PSU audit — Appleby opposed bringing public enterprises under CAG audit · regularity · commercial risk-taking · public money without public audit

CRITIQUE

4.7.5 Disinvestment — the four routes — Minority stake sale (revenue, no control change) · strategic sale · Air India to Tata, 2022 · VSNL, BALCO, Hindustan Zinc · ETF route · CPSE ETF, Bharat 22 and asset monetisation · NMP · operation without ownership

SCHEME

4.7.6 The case for and against disinvestment — For · no comparative advantage · Against · profit-making · revenue · strategic and social obligation · employment

CRITIQUE

4.7.7 Has liberalisation improved efficiency? — did · telecom and aviation · listed CPSEs · SEBI's LODR But valuation timing · strategic sale to a thin market · absence of a post-privatisation regulator

CRITIQUE

4.7.8 PSU board governance — SEBI's LODR · independent directors · vacant · appointed by the same ministry · Independence appointed by the controlling shareholder is a contradiction in terms.

CRITIQUE

4.7.9 The disinvestment reform agenda — Disinvestment Commission (G.V. Ramakrishna, 1996) · National Investment Fund · capital not revenue · DIPAM

COMMITTEE

4.7.10 Departmental to corporate — a live instance — ordnance factories · seven Defence PSUs (2021) · corporatisation · autonomy · shareholding department

EXAMPLE

Control before the act, accountability after it. Legislative, executive and judicial control, the right to information, social audit, the citizen interface, corruption and the integrity institutions, and the values that govern discretion.

5.1 WHAT ACCOUNTABILITY IS

5.1.1 Accountability versus control versus responsibility — **Control** is **prior and continuous** — the power to direct. **Accountability** is **posterior** — the duty to render an account and face consequences. **Responsibility** is **internal** — the obligation felt. A system can be heavy on control and empty of accountability, which describes India.

CONCEPT · T0

5.1.2 The Friedrich-Finer debate — **Finer** · external and enforceable · not to decide their own course · responsible to the elected representatives · **Friedrich** · inner check

CONCEPT · T0

5.1.3 Resolving Friedrich and Finer — Neither alone works. **Finer's** external controls arrive **too late** and cannot judge technical choices; **Friedrich's** inner check is **unverifiable**. The workable answer is **Finer's institutions plus Friedrich's ethics** — codes and training to shape judgement, audit and courts to catch failure.

CONCEPT · T0

5.1.4 Koppell's five dimensions — (1) Transparency (2) liability (3) controllability (4) responsibility (5) responsiveness His warning is the useful part — multiple accountabilities disorder · paralysed or arbitrary

CONCEPT

5.1.5 Romzek and Dubnick's four types — Hierarchical (supervisory, low discretion) · legal (external, low discretion) · professional (internal, high discretion) · political (external, high discretion) · prevents the answer becoming a list

CONCEPT

5.1.6 The problem of many hands — **Dennis Thompson** — where a decision passes through many officials, **no one is individually blameworthy** and accountability dissolves. It is the standing defence in every Indian inquiry report, and the reason **recorded, attributable noting** matters more than any oversight body.

CONCEPT

5.1.7 Why technical administration resists accountability — The more specialised the decision, the fewer the people competent to review it. **Parliamentary questions cannot audit an algorithm**; a **CAG** auditor cannot second-guess a spectrum valuation model. The remedy is **procedural** — publish the method, the assumptions and the dissent — not substantive review.

CRITIQUE

5.1.8 India's accountability paradox — the signature argument — more · less · 'disposed' · RTI penalties are imposed in about 3% of disposed cases. · procedural, not consequential

CRITIQUE · T0

5.2 LEGISLATIVE CONTROL

5.2.1 The instruments, in order of bite — **Financial** · PAC, Estimates Committee and COPU · **Deliberative** · Legislative · Committee on Subordinate Legislation · **Departmental Standing Committees**

INSTITUTION · T0

5.2.2 Why legislative control is weak — Declining sitting days · anti-defection law · guillotine · ordinances · money-bill routing · not binding

CRITIQUE · T0

5.2.3 The Public Accounts Committee — 22 members (15 Lok Sabha, 7 Rajya Sabha) · Opposition · CAG's · after the money is spent · non-partisan continuity · post-facto · power to penalise

INSTITUTION

5.2.4 The three financial committees compared — PAC · past · Estimates Committee (30, Lok Sabha only) · economies · proposed · COPU (22) · public undertakings

INSTITUTION

5.2.5 Departmentally Related Standing Committees — 24 committees, 31 members each (21 Lok Sabha, 10 Rajya Sabha) · 1993 · demands for grants, bills, annual reports and long-term policy · outside the glare of the House

INSTITUTION

5.2.6 Parliamentary control over expenditure is declining — Demands actually discussed · guillotine · supplementary demands · off-budget borrowing and parastatals and fewer bills

CRITIQUE

5.2.7 The guillotine — all outstanding Demands for Grants to vote together, without discussion · timeline · scrutiny · form for substance

INSTITUTION

5.2.8 What would actually strengthen it — statutory minimum of sitting days · Budget Office · mandatory committee reference · pre-legislative consultation · 2nd ARC's · CAG's · fixed time

CRITIQUE

5.3 EXECUTIVE AND JUDICIAL CONTROL

5.3.1 Executive control mechanisms — **Budgetary** (sanction, re-appropriation, Finance Ministry concurrence); **personnel** (appointment, transfer, promotion, discipline under CCS-CCA Rules); **hierarchical** (supervision, inspection, review); **coordination** (Cabinet Secretariat, committees of secretaries); and **audit** through internal audit and the CVC-CVO chain.

INSTITUTION

5.3.2 Judicial review — the grounds — **Illegality** · **irrationality** · **Wednesbury** · procedural impropriety · **natural justice** · **proportionality** · Lord Diplock's

CONCEPT · T0

5.3.3 The writs — Habeas corpus (produce the body) · mandamus (perform the public duty) · prohibition · certiorari (quash, after) · quo warranto · Article 32 · Article 226

PROVISION · TO

5.3.4 Judicial activism as reform agency — Signature argument. · Vineet Narain (1997) · CVC · Prakash Singh (2006) · seven police reforms · T.S.R. Subramanian (2013) · Civil Services Board · minimum tenure and written orders

CASE LAW · TO

5.3.5 The limits of judicial control — only when moved · the case not the system · funds or personnel · overloaded · 4.76 crore cases pending (NJDG, 2026) · willing to comply · Prakash Singh compliance has been nominal for nineteen years

CRITIQUE

5.3.6 The judiciary mandating rather than restraining — negative (striking down) to positive (directing what must be done) · Article 141 · Vishaka (1997)

CASE LAW

5.3.7 The 2025 judicial retreat — Presidential Reference opinion (November 2025) · judicially fixed timelines on the Governor's assent under Articles 200 and 201 · State of Tamil Nadu · political and cooperative-federal remedies · Inter-State Council

CASE LAW

5.3.8 Checks and balances — separation of functions · judicial review · basic structure doctrine · independent constitutional offices (CAG, EC, UPSC) and federal division

CONCEPT

5.4 RIGHT TO INFORMATION AND TRANSPARENCY

5.4.1 The RTI architecture — Section 2(h) · Section 4 · suo motu · Section 6 · Section 7 · 48 hours · Section 8 · Section 19 · Section 20 · ₹25,000

PROVISION · TO

5.4.2 Where RTI came from — MKSS · Rajasthan · Jan Sunwais · Tamil Nadu (1997) · Freedom of Information Act, 2002 · RTI Act, 2005 · NCPRI

EXAMPLE · TO

5.4.3 RTI's measured stress — Over 4 lakh appeals and complaints pending · seven commissions non-functional · Jharkhand's defunct since May 2020 · 3% of disposed cases · four to five years

DATA · TO

5.4.4 The backlash against RTI — RTI (Amendment) Act, 2019 · tenure, salary and service conditions · statute to executive rules · Vacancies

CRITIQUE

5.4.5 The DPDP amendment to Section 8(1)(j) — live 2026 issue. · Section 44(3) of the DPDP Act, 2023 · RTI's Section 8(1)(j) · all personal information · public-interest override · beneficiary lists, muster rolls and officials' asset disclosures

CRITIQUE · TO

5.4.6 Protecting the user, not just the right — The unfinished agenda: no working protection for RTI activists, with dozens killed since 2005. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 was passed and never brought into force; its 2015 amendment bill would have narrowed it to exclude disclosures touching Section 8(1) categories.

CRITIQUE

5.4.7 The Section 4 fix — The highest-value reform is the cheapest: enforce suo motu disclosure. If budgets, beneficiary lists, works, inspection reports and file notings were published as a matter of course, most applications would not be filed, and the backlog problem would shrink at its source.

PROVISION

5.4.8 Riggs explains the RTI gap — Formalism · prescriptive · descriptive · Section 4 compliance · penalties · commissions · norm · institution

LINKAGE · TO

5.4.9 Transparency's other instruments — e-Procurement through GeM and CPP Portal · PFMS · faceless assessment · open data on data.gov.in · National Data and Analytics Platform · design · request

INSTITUTION

5.5 SOCIAL AUDIT AND THE CITIZEN INTERFACE

5.5.1 What social audit is — by the community that received it · official records read aloud in a public assembly with findings recorded and acted upon · audit trail · face-to-face account

CONCEPT · TO

5.5.2 Social audit's statutory base — Section 17 of MGNREGA · Gram Sabha · MGNREGA Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 · independent Social Audit Units · Meghalaya's Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 · general

PROVISION · TO

5.5.3 Why social audit works where audit does not — It reaches the only fact that matters — did the work happen and did the wage arrive — which no ledger can verify from a state capital. It is timely, local, and hard to capture where the assembly is genuinely open.

CONCEPT

5.5.4 Where social audit fails — SAUs are funded by the department they audit · elite capture · findings are recorded and not acted on · separate funding and trained village social auditors

CRITIQUE

5.5.5 The citizen-administration interface — applicant (a service to be obtained) as complainant (CPGRAMS) as participant (Gram Sabha, ward committee, MyGov) · co-producer

CONCEPT

5.5.6 Grievance redress as a system — CPGRAMS · AI-based grievance routing · DARPG · disposal time and quality · 'disposal' is counted rather than resolution

INSTITUTION

5.5.7 The missing grievance statute — The **Right of Citizens for Time Bound Delivery of Goods and Services and Redressal of their Grievances Bill, 2011** lapsed. Without it, a Citizen's Charter creates **no enforceable right**. The **2nd ARC's 12th Report, Citizen Centric Administration**, remains the reference design.

CRITIQUE

5.5.8 Participation as an administrative technique — Arnstein's ladder · manipulation and therapy (non-participation) through informing, consultation and placation (tokenism) to partnership, delegated power and citizen control · consultation · social audit and the Gram Sabha's approval of plans · delegated power

CONCEPT

5.6 MEDIA, INTEREST GROUPS AND CIVIL SOCIETY

5.6.1 The media's accountability function — Agenda-setting (what the public thinks about) · watchdog (exposure) and forum (deliberation) · speed and reach · episodic · spectacular · structural

CONCEPT

5.6.2 'The fourth estate is in chains' — ownership concentration · advertising dependence including government advertising · paid news and the Press Council's own findings · defamation and sedition-adjacent charges and regulatory leverage over broadcasters

CRITIQUE

5.6.3 From institutional lens to societal lens — Media once trained its attention on **institutions** — the file, the tender, the committee. It now largely reflects **society back to itself** — identity, outrage, personality. The shift matters administratively: **institutional failure goes unreported** unless it produces a **visible victim**.

CRITIQUE

5.6.4 Social media's double effect — lowered the cost of exposure · removed verification · rumour-driven law-and-order incidents · IT Rules, 2021 · state-as-arbiter · Bombay High Court · Kunal Kamra

EXAMPLE

5.6.5 Interest groups in agenda-setting — They **elevate** issues onto the agenda and, more consequentially, **deny others the opportunity** — Bachrach and Baratz's non-decision-making. In India, **organised** interests (industry associations, employee unions, farmer bodies) are heard; **unorganised** ones (informal workers, tenants) are not.

CONCEPT

5.6.6 Civil society's contribution, named — MKSS produced the RTI; SEWA organised informal women workers; Pratham's ASER created the learning-outcomes debate; AIDWA and allied groups shaped the Domestic Violence Act; Bachpan Bachao Andolan on child labour. Name organisations, not 'NGOs'.

EXAMPLE

5.6.7 When civil society restricts rather than assists — litigation delaying · unrepresentative · donor agendas · accountability of the accountability-seeker

CRITIQUE

5.6.8 The receptive-state condition — CSO effectiveness is a function of state structure: statutory entry points make CSOs productive — Gram Sabha, social audit, pre-legislative consultation, PIL, the Forest Rights Act's gram sabha consent. Where entry points are absent, CSOs are pushed to **protest and litigation**, which the state then reads as obstruction.

CONCEPT

5.7 CORRUPTION AND THE INTEGRITY INSTITUTIONS

5.7.1 Klitgaard's equation — **Corruption = Monopoly + Discretion – Accountability**. The most usable analytic frame in the syllabus: it turns 'reduce corruption' into three **operable** levers, and lets you show which lever each Indian reform pulls.

CONCEPT · TO

5.7.2 Klitgaard applied to Indian reforms — Monopoly reduced · e-auction · GeM's · Discretion reduced — faceless assessment · DBT · Accountability raised · first two carried the gains

LINKAGE · TO

5.7.3 The anti-corruption statutes — Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 · 2018 — bribe-giving criminalised · prior approval · timelines · Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 · Benami Transactions (Prohibition) Amendment Act, 2016 · Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013

PROVISION · TO

5.7.4 The 2018 amendment's double edge — It closed a real gap by criminalising the **giver** and requiring **timely trial**; it also restored a **prior-approval shield** akin to the **single directive** the Supreme Court struck down in **Vineet Narain (1997)** and again in **Subramanian Swamy (2014)**. Protection against harassment and protection from investigation are hard to separate.

CRITIQUE

5.7.5 The CVC — Santhanam Committee (1962-64) · 1964 · statutory · CVC Act, 2003 after Vineet Narain · Multi-member · PM, Home Minister and Leader of Opposition · CBI's · advisory

INSTITUTION

5.7.6 The Lokpal's record — 2013 · India Against Corruption · March 2019 · 389 complaints in 2025-26 · depends on CBI and CVC · no independent investigating machinery of scale and most States' Lokayuktas

DATA

5.7.7 UNCAC and India's compliance gap — UN Convention against Corruption in 2011 · no law on private-sector bribery · no effective whistleblower protection in force · no asset-recovery framework · no regulation of lobbying or political funding transparency

CRITIQUE

5.7.8 The 2nd ARC's ethics architecture — fourth report, Ethics in Governance · Code of Ethics · Office of Ethics Commissioner · partial funding of elections · confiscation of illegally acquired assets · integrity pacts · conflict-of-interest and cooling-off rules and serious-offence fast-tracking

COMMITTEE

5.7.9 Corruption Perceptions Index 2025 — India 91st of 182, score 39/100 · 96th in 2024 · 42 · Transparency International, 16 February 2026 · Transactional · grand and political
DATA · T0

5.8 VALUES, COALITIONS, RIGHTS AND DISASTER

5.8.1 Values in public service — Nolan's seven principles · (1) selflessness (2) integrity (3) objectivity (4) accountability (5) openness (6) honesty (7) leadership India's equivalents the AIS (Conduct) Rules, Rule 3 · integrity, devotion to duty and political neutrality · Public Services Bill
CONCEPT · T0

5.8.2 Administration under coalition regimes — portfolio allocation by party rather than fit · ministries becoming party fiefdoms · slower Cabinet decision-making · larger councils of ministers · Chief Secretary or Cabinet Secretary
CRITIQUE

5.8.3 The compensating virtues of coalitions — greater federal consultation · more legislative scrutiny · regional interests represented at the Union table · 91st Amendment · 15% of the House
CONCEPT

5.8.4 The National Human Rights Commission — Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 · former Chief Justice of India or a Supreme Court judge · 2019 amendment · three-year · inquiry, civil-court powers, visits to custodial institutions, intervention in court proceedings
INSTITUTION

5.8.5 The NHRC's structural weaknesses — recommendatory · cannot investigate armed forces · Section 19 · one-year limitation · police to investigate police and GANHRI accreditation review · pluralism and appointment process
CRITIQUE

5.8.6 Disaster management's institutional chain — Disaster Management Act, 2005 — NDMA · Prime Minister · SDMA · Chief Minister · DDMA · District Magistrate · NDRF · NIDM · NDMA guidelines · 2025 amendment
INSTITUTION

5.8.7 The shift from relief to risk reduction — Sendai Framework 2015-30 · understanding risk, strengthening governance, investing in resilience, enhancing preparedness for build back better · 16th FC's disaster corpus of ₹2,04,401 crore · heat action plans
DATA

5.8.8 AI in disaster administration — IMD's · Common Alerting Protocol · satellite and drone damage assessment · flood forecasting · Bhashini · data quality, last-mile reach and accountability for a wrong prediction
EXAMPLE

Administrative law is the theory of controlling discretion; law and order is the hardest place India applies it. Dicey, delegated legislation, tribunals, the ombudsman — then the colonial police design and the reform that has never landed.

6.1 ADMINISTRATIVE LAW — MEANING, SCOPE, DICEY

6.1.1 What administrative law governs — powers, procedures and liabilities of administrative authorities · remedies · Wade · control of governmental power · on what terms it may do it
CONCEPT · T0

6.1.2 Why it grew — The welfare and regulatory state. Legislatures cannot foresee every case, so they delegate; administration acquires **rule-making and adjudicatory** power; and the citizen needs a body of law governing that power. administrative law evolved from the need for a **system of public administration under law**.
CONCEPT

6.1.3 Dicey's denial — A.V. Dicey (1885) · no administrative law · rule of law · supremacy of regular law · equality before the ordinary law · judicial decisions
THINKER · T0

6.1.4 Why Dicey was wrong — **droit administratif** for official privilege · Conseil d'État · statutory tribunals and discretionary powers · Robson, Jennings and Wade · wherever administrative power exists
CRITIQUE

6.1.5 Dicey overtaken in India — rejects Dicey's second proposition outright · Article 361 · Article 311 · Article 300 · Article 14 · arbitrariness is itself unconstitutional
LINKAGE

6.1.6 Red light and green light theories — Red light (Dicey, Hewart) · control and restrain · Green light (Robson, Griffith) · force for good · facilitate
CONCEPT · T0

6.1.7 Amber light — the working synthesis — Harlow and Rawlings' · rights and procedure · polycentric policy judgement · Wednesbury deference · strict scrutiny
CONCEPT · T0

6.1.8 The rule of law and arbitrariness — E.P. Royappa (1974) · arbitrariness · Article 14 · Maneka Gandhi (1978) · fair, just and reasonable · unconstitutional
CASE LAW · T0

6.1.9 Natural justice — the two rules — **Nemo iudex in causa sua** — no one a judge in his own cause (bias: pecuniary, personal, official, policy). **Audi alteram partem** — hear the other side (notice, disclosure of material, opportunity to be heard, reasoned order). **A.K. Kraipak (1969)** extended both from quasi-judicial to administrative action.
CASE LAW · T0

6.1.10 Is administrative law now more constitutional than the Constitution? — Article 14 and 21 jurisprudence — Kraipak · Royappa · Maneka · constitutional · constitutional standards
CONCEPT

6.2 DELEGATED LEGISLATION

6.2.1 What it is and why it exists — executive under authority conferred by a statute · pressure on legislative time · technicality · flexibility to amend without an Act · local variation · emergency
CONCEPT

6.2.2 The constitutional limit — Essential legislative function cannot be delegated. · policy · standard · filling in of detail · In re Delhi Laws Act (1951) · Hamdard Dawakhana (1960)
CASE LAW · T0

6.2.3 The dangers — Skeleton legislation · Henry VIII clauses · sub-delegation · retrospective · inadequate publication · years after
CRITIQUE · T0

6.2.4 'A strategic tool in the hands of the executive' — The strategic use is real: the **substance** of a policy can be shifted into **rules** that never face a vote, changed by **notification**, and enforced before Parliament examines them. asked how to confine it — the answer is the three controls below.
CRITIQUE

6.2.5 Parliamentary control of delegated legislation — Laying · 30 days · Committee on Subordinate Legislation · 15 members · within the power conferred · enabling clause
INSTITUTION

6.2.6 Judicial control of delegated legislation — Rules may be struck as **substantively ultra vires** (beyond the parent Act, or the parent Act itself unconstitutional) or **procedurally ultra vires** (mandatory consultation or publication omitted). Courts also apply **unreasonableness** and, increasingly, **manifest arbitrariness** under Article 14.
CONCEPT

6.2.7 Procedural safeguards worth prescribing — Prior publication and public consultation · Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014 · 30 days · mandatory laying · time limit for framing rules and regulatory impact assessment · FSLRC
CRITIQUE

6.2.8 Subordinate legislation is also beneficial — Without it, **technical standards** (drug schedules, emission norms, spectrum), **rates** (tariffs, duties), and **crisis response** would each require an Act. The remedy for its abuse is **scrutiny**, not abolition — no modern state can legislate every detail in primary law.
CONCEPT

6.2.9 Administrative discretion and its control — Discretion is controlled at **three points**: at **conferment** (a guiding standard in the statute), at **exercise** (relevant considerations, no mala fides, no fettering by rigid rules, no non-application of mind), and **after** (reasons recorded, appeal, judicial review). **Recording reasons** is the cheapest and most effective of the three.
CONCEPT · T0

6.3 ADMINISTRATIVE TRIBUNALS

6.3.1 Why tribunals — Speed · low cost · expertise · flexible procedure · court backlog · volume and technicality

CONCEPT · T0

6.3.2 The constitutional basis for tribunals — Articles 323A and 323B · 42nd Amendment (1976) · 323A · public service matters · Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985 · CAT · 323B · specified subjects

PROVISION · T0

6.3.3 L. Chandra Kumar — L. Chandra Kumar v. Union of India (1997) — judicial review under Articles 226 and 32 is basic structure · supplemental · High Court division-bench review

CASE LAW · T0

6.3.4 The tribunalisation critique — Appointments dominated by the executive · litigant · short tenures · administrative members · vacancies · Chandra Kumar

CRITIQUE · T0

6.3.5 The reform line of cases — R.K. Jain · Chandra Kumar (1997) · Madras Bar Association (2014 and 2021) · tenure, qualification and the selection committee's composition · Rojer Mathew (2019) · National Tribunals Commission · Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021

CASE LAW

6.3.6 The reform that would work — National Tribunals Commission · 2nd ARC · uniform service conditions · fixed longer tenure · single nodal ministry

COMMITTEE

6.4 OMBUDSMAN, LOKPAL AND THE GRIEVANCE REMEDY

6.4.1 The ombudsman idea — parliamentary officer · investigate maladministration · Sweden (1809) · Denmark (1955)

CONCEPT

6.4.2 Maladministration, defined — The Crossman catalogue — "bias, neglect, inattention, delay, incompetence, ineptitude, perversity, turpitude, arbitrariness". It is broader than **illegality**: an act may be perfectly lawful and still be maladministration, which is exactly the gap courts cannot fill.

CONCEPT

6.4.3 India's route to the Lokpal — ARC-I (1966) · Lokpal (ministers and secretaries) and Lokayukta (other officials) · eight times · Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 · chairperson was appointed in March 2019

INSTITUTION

6.4.4 Why the Lokpal underperforms — no independent investigative machinery at scale · CBI and CVC · preliminary inquiry · prior sanction · corruption · maladministration

CRITIQUE

6.4.5 Lokayuktas — the uneven state record — Maharashtra first (1971); Karnataka's Lokayukta was the strongest, with its own police wing and suo motu powers, and produced consequential reports. Most others have **no investigative wing**, **no suo motu power**, and **recommendatory** findings addressed to the very government complained against.

EXAMPLE

6.4.6 The 2nd ARC's grievance design — 12th Report · local grievance redress with a designated officer and a time limit · independent · compensation for failure of service · reply · remedy

COMMITTEE

6.4.7 Sectoral ombudsmen that actually work — RBI's Integrated Ombudsman Scheme (2021) · Insurance Ombudsman · Banking Codes · funded by the sector, decide within a time limit, and their awards bind

EXAMPLE

6.5 POLICE — THE COLONIAL LEGACY AND THE STRUCTURE

6.5.1 The Police Act, 1861 — 1857 · Irish Constabulary · colonial, armed, regime-loyal · control of the population **not** service to the citizen

PROVISION · T0

6.5.2 The colonial legacy in current form — Three surviving features: **executive control** over postings and operations; the **constabulary** treated as a labour force rather than a professional cadre; and **thana-level policing** designed for order maintenance rather than investigation.

LINKAGE

6.5.3 Police as a State subject — Entry 2, List II · State · Entry 1, List II · Entry 8, List I (CBI's parent DSPE) · Article 355 (duty to protect States) · central armed police forces on request **and** advisories

PROVISION · T0

6.5.4 The police hierarchy and the dual desk — DGP → ADGP/IGP → DIG (range) → SP (district) → SDPO/DySP → SHO (police station) · SP · District Magistrate · magisterial · dual control

INSTITUTION

6.5.5 The commissionerate system — police and magisterial · Commissioner of Police · licensing, preventive orders and crowd control **with** no separate District Magistrate · concentration without a civilian check

CONCEPT

6.5.6 The measured capacity gap — 26-27 lakh · 20-21 lakh · 20-22% vacancy sustained for a decade · 152-155 per lakh · UN-referenced 222 · 12% · MHA's 33% advisory · capacity · behaviour

DATA · T0

6.5.7 The new criminal law codes — Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita · Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita **and** Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam · 1 July 2024 · mandatory forensic visit · timelines · e-FIR and zero FIR **and** videography of search and seizure

PROVISION

6.5.8 The prison end of the chain — Undertrials are about three-quarters of the prison population · 130% · NCRB · BNSS Section 479 · legal aid at first production **and** video-conferenced remand

DATA

6.6 POLICE REFORM

- 6.6.1** The National Police Commission — Dharma Vira, 1977-81, eight reports · State Security Commission · fixed tenure · separation of investigation from law and order · new Police Act · Not one State enacted the Model Bill.
COMMITTEE · TO
- 6.6.2** The committees that followed — Ribeiro (1998) · Padmanabhaiah (2000) · Malimath (2003) · Soli Sorabjee's Model Police Act (2006) · Justice K.T. Thomas (2010) · total indifference
COMMITTEE
- 6.6.3** Prakash Singh — the seven directives — Prakash Singh v. Union of India (2006) · (1) a State Security Commission · (2) DGP · UPSC panel · (3) two-year tenure for operational field officers (4) separation of investigation from law and order · (5) a Police Establishment Board · (6) Police Complaints Authorities · (7) a National Security Commission
CASE LAW · TO
- 6.6.4** Why compliance has been nominal — new Police Acts that reproduce executive control · government majorities and recommendatory · DGP selection diluted · Complaints Authorities unconstituted or without independent members · overridden
CRITIQUE · TO
- 6.6.5** Whose discretion the reform would remove — Every police reform proposal since 1979 asks the political executive to surrender control over postings and transfers. It has not been resisted for want of funds or expertise — it has been resisted because it is a transfer of power. The obstacle is interest, not capacity.
CRITIQUE · TO
- 6.6.6** Separating investigation from prosecution — For — specialist investigators freed from bandobast duty, better conviction rates, prosecutorial independence as a check on shoddy investigation. Against — coordination loss, duplication in thin State cadres, and a village station that cannot spare two wings. Most States have a partial separation in metros only.
CRITIQUE
- 6.6.7** Smart policing — S · S · M · M · A · A · R · R · T · T · CCTNS · Interoperable Criminal Justice System · e-FIR · Dial 112 ERSS and NAFIS
SCHEME
- 6.6.8** Community policing that has worked — Kerala's Janamaithri Suraksha · Rajasthan's Community Liaison Groups · Tamil Nadu's Friends of Police · Maharashtra's Mohalla committees · beat officer continuity
EXAMPLE
- 6.6.9** Police-public relations — 1861 design · vacancies and 12-14 hour shifts · VIP security diverting strength · custodial violence and social distance · representation · beat continuity · independent complaints authorities and welfare and shift reform
CRITIQUE

6.7 INVESTIGATIVE AGENCIES, INSURGENCY AND TERRORISM

- 6.7.1** The CBI's fragile foundation — no statute of its own · Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946 · State consent under Section 6 · withdrawn · Vineet Narain (1997) · two-year tenure
PROVISION
- 6.7.2** 'Caged parrot' and the autonomy debate — Guwahati High Court (2013) · caged parrot · CBI Act · collegium appointment · financial independence · separate prosecution wing · 2nd ARC and Parliamentary Standing Committee
CRITIQUE
- 6.7.3** The central agency map — NIA (NIA Act, 2008, post-26/11; amended 2019 for extraterritorial reach); ED under PMLA and FEMA; NCB for narcotics; IB for intelligence; MAC for multi-agency coordination; NATGRID for data linkage; NCTC, proposed in 2012, never created after States objected on federal grounds.
INSTITUTION
- 6.7.4** The central armed police forces — CRPF — the internal security reserve, largest; BSF, ITBP, SSB — border guarding; CISF — installations and airports; Assam Rifles — a dual-control force under MHA administratively, Army operationally. Their deployment is at State request, which is the constitutional hinge.
INSTITUTION
- 6.7.5** Counter-insurgency doctrine — Clear – hold – build · security saturation · development saturation · surrender-and-rehabilitation policy and negotiated accords · Mizo Accord (1986)
CONCEPT
- 6.7.6** AFSPA and the withdrawal question — Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958 · search, arrest and use force · disturbed area with prior sanction required to prosecute · Tripura (2015) · Meghalaya (2018) · normalisation and Jeevan Reddy Committee (2005)
PROVISION
- 6.7.7** The counter-terror legal framework — UAPA, 1967 · 2019 · individual · NIA · special courts · FATF · PMLA · preventive detention powers and conviction rates
PROVISION
- 6.7.8** Criminalisation of politics — ADR · Association for Democratic Reforms (2002) · Lily Thomas (2013) · Public Interest Foundation (2018) · 2020 contempt order · publish reasons · Fast-track courts for MPs and MLAs
CASE LAW

Why an administrative system that works in one society fails in another. The ecological approach, Riggs's prismatic model, and what makes a bureaucracy developmental rather than merely large.

7.1 CPA — ORIGIN, PURPOSE, CURRENT STATUS

7.1.1 Why CPA was born — Post-war decolonisation and US technical assistance · did not work · Comparative Administration Group (CAG, 1960-71) · Fred Riggs · Ford Foundation
CONCEPT · TO

7.1.2 Robert Dahl's founding challenge — 'The Science of Public Administration: Three Problems' (1947) · values · human behaviour · cross-national transferability · social setting
THINKER

7.1.3 Heady's three purposes — Ferrel Heady · theory building (a general theory of administration) for improved administrative technology (what transfers and what does not) · intellectual curiosity
CONCEPT

7.1.4 Riggs's three trends — CPA moved from **normative** to **empirical** (from what administration ought to be to what it is), from **ideographic** to **nomothetic** (from single-case description to generalisation), and from **non-ecological** to **ecological** (from studying administration alone to studying it inside its environment).
CONCEPT

7.1.5 Why CPA declined — elitist and west-centric orientation · typologies rather than testable theory · funding-dependent · 1971 · descriptive, not predictive
CRITIQUE · TO

7.1.6 'It started with no paradigm and developed none' — CPA produced **no paradigm** but delivered a **durable analytical vocabulary** — formalism, overlapping, heterogeneity, ecology, prismatic — that every subsequent development literature uses without acknowledgment.
CRITIQUE

7.1.7 The revival in the 1980s and 1990s — NPM diffusion and World Bank governance conditionality · quantitative and index-based — WGI, Doing Business, Government Effectiveness · bureaucracy to governance and institutional quality
CONCEPT

7.1.8 From institutional to political-economy comparison — The evolution: **institutional** description (structures) → **behavioural** comparison → **ecological** analysis → **political-economy** approaches asking who benefits and which coalition sustains the arrangement. The last has explanatory power the earlier ones lacked, but still no **general theory**.
CONCEPT

7.1.9 NPM and ICT as comparative forces — convergence pressure · donor conditionality and policy transfer · shared platforms and international standards · divergence · ecologies
CONCEPT

7.2 THE ECOLOGICAL APPROACH

7.2.1 What the ecological approach claims — Administration is **shaped by, and shapes, its environment** — economic, social, political, communication and symbolic. **John Gaus (1947)** listed the ecological factors: **people, place, physical technology, social technology, wishes and ideas, catastrophe, personality**.
CONCEPT · TO

7.2.2 Why it matters for developing countries — It explains **why a well-designed reform fails**: the design assumed a literacy level, a banking density, a caste-neutral village, a functioning land record — and the ecology did not supply it.
CONCEPT · TO

7.2.3 Riggs's Agraria and Industria — ideal-type · Agraria — ascriptive · particularistic · diffuse · Industria — achievement · universalistic · specific
CONCEPT · TO

7.2.4 Why Riggs abandoned the two-pole model — Real transitional societies were not simply 'between' the two — they showed **both simultaneously**, and the mix was **stable rather than transitional**. That failure produced the **prismatic** model, which is the reason it exists.
CONCEPT

7.2.5 Industria as a precursor to post-modern administration — Industria's features — **high differentiation, universalism, interdependence, a market-permeated society** — anticipate the **networked, contracted-out, interdependent** state that post-modern public administration describes. The interdependent economy is Industria's defining trait, not merely its technology.
CONCEPT

7.2.6 The ecology of Indian administration — **specific factors** · caste and kinship · linguistic federalism · agrarian dependence · electoral competition at four levels · judicial activism · legal-rational structure inherited before the society that would sustain it had formed
LINKAGE

7.2.7 Social and historical factors shaping administration — Three forces shape it: the **colonial inheritance** (a revenue-and-order state, generalist-led); the **freedom struggle's** normative legacy (welfare obligation, DPSPs); and the **social structure** (hierarchy, plurality, patronage) into which both were placed. Design that ignores any one of the three fails.
LINKAGE

7.2.8 The limit of ecological explanation — It can slide into **determinism** and into **excuse** — if the ecology explains everything, no administrator is responsible for anything. The corrective is that administration **also shapes** its ecology: **RTI, panchayats, DBT and universal schooling** changed the very environment that constrained them.
CRITIQUE

7.3 RIGGS'S PRISMATIC MODEL

7.3.1 The prism — Fused society = white light entering (agraria, undifferentiated). **Prismatic** = light inside the prism, **diffracting but not yet separated**. **Diffracted** = the emerging spectrum (industria, highly specialised). The **transitional** society sits **inside** the prism — and Riggs's claim is that this is a **stable condition**, not a way-station.

CONCEPT · T0

7.3.2 Formalism — The gap between the prescriptive and the descriptive — between what the law says and what actually happens. Not simple non-compliance: the **form is maintained** while the substance is absent, and everybody knows it. **India's single most usable diagnostic term**.

CONCEPT · T0

7.3.3 Formalism, proved in Indian numbers — RTI Section 4 · Citizen's Charters · State Finance Commissions · District Planning Committees · penalties imposed in about 3% of disposed RTI cases

EXAMPLE · T0

7.3.4 Heterogeneity — simultaneous presence of different systems, practices and viewpoints · software park and bonded labour · faceless tax assessment and a patwari's field book · with one set of rules

CONCEPT · T0

7.3.5 Overlapping — Formal structures exist but are dominated by informal ones. · caste or khap · recommendation letter · differentiated on paper and fused in operation

CONCEPT · T0

7.3.6 The Sala model — administrative sub-system · sala · chamber · bureau · power based on personal and family standing · nepotism and poly-communalism

CONCEPT

7.3.7 The bazaar-canteen model — economy · not fixed by the market · relationship between the parties · speed money · priority in a queue

CONCEPT

7.3.8 Poly-normativism and poly-communalism — Poly-normativism — several conflicting norms · Poly-communalism — multiple communities · dominant community

CONCEPT

7.3.9 Riggs's other prismatic traits — Attainment norms · motility (movement without change of status) · price indeterminacy · clects · strong intellectual output with weak institutional capacity

CONCEPT

7.3.10 How to draw the prism — Fused (agraria) → Prismatic → Diffracted (industria) **with** formalism, heterogeneity and overlapping · inside · Indian instance · compresses

CONCEPT

7.4 RIGGS CRITICISED, AND RIGGS TODAY

7.4.1 The standard critiques — Excessively gloomy · technically complex · ideal-typical and untestable · Western-normative · static · change

CRITIQUE · T0

7.4.2 Arora and Braibanti's objections — Ramesh K. Arora · not operationalisable · Ralph Braibanti · under-weights the positive · elections, famine prevention, green revolution and universal immunisation

CRITIQUE

7.4.3 Why Riggs remains a useful starting point — It supplies the **only vocabulary** that names the specific pathology of a state with **modern law and traditional society**; and its diagnosis is **empirically visible** in devolution indices, RTI compliance and scheme leakage. A weak theory with strong descriptive purchase.

CRITIQUE

7.4.4 Riggsian terms in new forms — Formalism · digital formalism · Overlapping as elite capture of digital access · Heterogeneity · digital divide

LINKAGE · T0

7.4.5 Bureaucracy in developing countries — weak political control combined with political interference · generalist dominance · capacity and vacancy deficits · procedural risk aversion · corruption at the interface **and** weak coordination

CONCEPT

7.4.6 What makes a bureaucracy developmental — Evans's embedded autonomy · Weberianness · meritocratic recruitment and predictable careers · pilot agency · performance discipline · space and atomic energy

LINKAGE

7.4.7 Administration and politics compared — Three contrasting configurations worth naming: **Britain** — parliamentary, generalist, ministerial responsibility, no separate administrative court. **France** — statist, **grands corps** trained at ENA/INSP, a distinct **droit administratif** under the **Conseil d'État**. **USA** — separated powers, **spoils-to-merit** history, **political appointees** to several thousand senior posts.

CONCEPT

7.4.8 The French minister and party leadership — The French Constitution does **not** bar a minister from leading a party; the **convention** that they should not exists to protect the **impartiality of the administration** they head. **Conventions**, not text alone, carry administrative neutrality.

EXAMPLE

Development theory and the panchayat are one argument — whether the poor can direct the machinery that serves them. The capability approach, the anti-development thesis, women and development, and the 73rd Amendment's fiscal hollowness.

8.1 THE CONCEPT OF DEVELOPMENT

8.1.1 Development beyond growth — Growth · development · capabilities, distribution and institutions · Dudley Seers' · poverty, unemployment and inequality
CONCEPT · T0

8.1.2 Sen's capability approach — Development can be seen as a process of expanding the real freedoms that people enjoy. · income · utility **but** capability · do and be · agency
QUOTE · T0

8.1.3 Sen operationalised in Indian policy — NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index · Alkire-Foster · Headcount fell from 29.17% (2013-14) to 11.28% (2022-23) · 24.8 crore · NFSA, RTE and PM-JAY
DATA · T0

8.1.4 Human development and the HDI — Mahbub ul Haq **with** Sen — UNDP Human Development Report, 1990 · political, not analytical · GDP
CONCEPT

8.1.5 Sustainable development — Brundtland (Our Common Future, 1987) · without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own · SDGs (2015-2030) · 17 goals and 169 targets · NITI's SDG India Index · competitive federalism
CONCEPT

8.1.6 Participatory development — Robert Chambers — putting the last first · tarmac, dry-season, project, person, diplomatic · Participatory Rural Appraisal · Gram Sabha's approval of the plan
THINKER

8.1.7 The development dilemma — The **concept** of development is inherently **participatory** — it is about people's own expansion of freedom. The **practice** has been **exclusionary** — expert-driven, displacement-generating, capital-intensive. That contradiction, not any implementation failure, is what makes it a **dilemma**.
CRITIQUE

8.1.8 SDGs depend on actors' willingness to cooperate — horizontal coordination · State list **and** local bodies · NITI's SDG index, state SDG cells, the localisation of SDGs through panchayat theme-based plans
CRITIQUE

8.2 DEVELOPMENT ADMINISTRATION

8.2.1 What development administration means — planned change · goal-oriented, change-oriented, client-oriented, innovative, temporally committed **and** participative · Weidner · progressive political, economic and social objectives
CONCEPT · T0

8.2.2 Riggs's two-sided concept — Development administration · of · administration of development · administrative development · capacity · mutually reinforcing
CONCEPT · T0

8.2.3 The dichotomy of development — flexibility, risk-taking and speed · general administration **needs** rule-adherence, uniformity and caution · same officer · innovate **and** not deviate from the GFR
LINKAGE · T0

8.2.4 Weidner on output versus system change — Change in **output** (more roads, more enrolment) is not change in the **system** that produces it. And "**growth from one point of view may be decline from another**" — an irrigation project that raises yields and destroys a commons.
THINKER

8.2.5 The changing profile — Four phases: 1950s-60s state-led, plan-driven, community development; 1970s-80s target-group programmes and poverty alleviation; 1990s market-oriented, minimal state, structural adjustment; 2000s **onwards** rights-based delivery, then **mission-based**, **digitally-mediated**, **outcome-tracked** administration.
CONCEPT

8.2.6 Rights-based to mission-based — the signature argument — RTI (2005), NREGA (2005), FRA (2006), RTE (2009), NFSA (2013) · justiciable entitlements · Missions · target and dashboard · no enforceable claim · standing fell
CRITIQUE · T0

8.2.7 Bureaucracy as an impediment to development — rule-orientation over result · generalist leadership · risk aversion · transfer instability · file · diffusing responsibility · less · differently incentivised
CRITIQUE

8.2.8 Bureaucracy as the condition of development — Evans and Rauch · meritocratic recruitment and predictable careers · election machinery, famine prevention, universal immunisation and pandemic vaccination · Capacity, not size, is the variable.
LINKAGE

8.3 THE ANTI-DEVELOPMENT THESIS AND THE STATE-MARKET DEBATE

8.3.1 The anti-development thesis — epistemological · discourse · 'underdeveloped' · Arturo Escobar, *Encountering Development* (1995)
CONCEPT · T0

8.3.2 Who makes the argument — Escobar — development as a discourse of power. Wolfgang Sachs (*The Development Dictionary*) — "the idea of development stands like a ruin in the intellectual landscape." Ivan Illich — institutionalised services **disable** the capacities they claim to serve. Vandana Shiva — 'maldevelopment' and the displacement of subsistence.
THINKER

8.3.3 It contests epistemology, not merely practice — The precise formulation the question wants. Ordinary critique says development was **badly done**; the anti-development thesis says the **category itself** is the problem — it converts **difference into deficiency** and makes the expert, not the community, the authority on what a good life is.
CRITIQUE

8.3.4 The counter to the anti-development thesis — It offers no programme. A person without clean water, immunisation or literacy is not exercising an alternative epistemology. Sen's reply is decisive: the answer to imposed development is agency and public reasoning about which capabilities matter, not the abandonment of development.

CRITIQUE

8.3.5 The Indian instances it explains — Narmada · forest dwellers criminalised · FRA, 2006 · land acquisition · RFCTLARR Act, 2013 · consent and social impact assessment

EXAMPLE

8.3.6 Strong state versus the market — The evidence points to symbiosis, not choice: every successful market economy rests on a strong state supplying contract enforcement, property rights, competition regulation, human capital and infrastructure. Weak states produce weak markets, not free ones.

CONCEPT · T0

8.3.7 The developmental state literature — Chalmers Johnson · MITI · plan-rational · Alice Amsden · conditional on export performance · disciplined · Ha-Joon Chang · kicking away the ladder

THINKER

8.3.8 Has the state's role been overemphasised? — direct production · regulatory, capability-building and risk-absorbing · under · DPI, ISRO and the vaccine programme

CRITIQUE

8.3.9 Liberalisation's effect on administration — allocating scarcity (licences, quotas, permits) to regulating competition and managing contracts · different skills · licence-era officer was retained for a market-era job

LINKAGE

8.4 WOMEN AND DEVELOPMENT

8.4.1 The WID to GAD shift — Women in Development · Ester Boserup · Women and Development · terms · Gender and Development · gendered relations of power

CONCEPT · T0

8.4.2 Moser's triple role — Caroline Moser · reproductive, productive and community-managing · intensifies their burden · practical gender needs (water, fuel, income) and strategic gender interests

CONCEPT · T0

8.4.3 Kabeer on empowerment — Naila Kabeer · expansion of the ability to make strategic life choices · resources · agency and achievements · not

THINKER · T0

8.4.4 The SHG movement — NABARD's SHG-Bank Linkage (1992) · NRLM/Aajeevika (2011) · Lakhpati Didi · Kudumbashree · formal interface with the panchayat

SCHEME · T0

8.4.5 Do SHGs play a marginal role? — Not marginal · practical needs · collective bargaining · Marginal on strategic interests · land title, inheritance or household decision-making

CRITIQUE

8.4.6 Where SHGs became administratively significant — Community resource persons · bank sakhis, pashu sakhis and krishi sakhis · mid-day meal kitchens and PDS outlets · COVID mask and relief distribution · parallel delivery cadre · unpaid or underpaid state work

EXAMPLE

8.4.7 Affirmative action has not eliminated discrimination — presence not power · sarpanch pati · capacity building, tenure security, independent staff, and social audit

CRITIQUE

8.4.8 Economic development is not sufficient — female labour force participation · unpaid domestic work and safety constraints · son preference, mobility restriction, unpaid care or asset ownership · enables · deliver

CRITIQUE

8.4.9 The Indian gender-equality architecture — Articles 14, 15(3), 16, 39(a) and (d), 42, 51A(e) · 106th Amendment (2023) · one-third · census and delimitation · Gender Budget Statement 13 · POSH Act, 2013 after Vishaka (1997) · Nirbhaya Fund · Mission Shakti

PROVISION

8.5 PANCHAYATI RAJ — FROM BALWANTRAI MEHTA TO THE 73RD AMENDMENT

8.5.1 Why the Community Development Programme failed — 2 October 1952 · National Extension Service (1953) · Balwantrai Mehta (1957) · bureaucratically driven with no popular participation · Village Level Worker · captured by dominant groups — Selznick's co-optation

CRITIQUE

8.5.2 Balwantrai Mehta's prescription — Democratic decentralisation through three tiers · panchayat samiti (the executive tier, at block level) · indirect elections · genuine transfer of resources and authority · five-year term · Nagaur, 2 October 1959

COMMITTEE · T0

8.5.3 Ashok Mehta's counter-design — 1977-78 — two tiers · mandal panchayat · open participation of political parties · compulsory taxation powers · reservation for SC/ST · social audit · Minister for Panchayati Raj

COMMITTEE · T0

8.5.4 The committees between — G.V.K. Rao (1985) · grass without roots · District Development Commissioner · L.M. Singhvi (1986) — constitutional status · Gram Sabha · Nyaya Panchayats · P.K. Thungon (1988) · district planning

COMMITTEE

8.5.5 The 73rd Amendment's mandatory core — 1992, in force 24 April 1993 · Gram Sabha (243A) · three tiers · direct election · reservation for SC/ST in proportion, and one-third for women (243D) · five-year term with elections within six months of dissolution (243E) · State Election Commission (243K) · State Finance Commission every five years

PROVISION · T0

8.5.6 What the 73rd Amendment left optional — Article 243G · 'may' endow · 29 subjects of the Eleventh Schedule · Article 243H · 'may' authorise · District Planning Committee (243ZD) · Devolution was made a State choice, and most States chose not to.

CRITIQUE · T0

8.5.7 The 3F test — Functions, Funds and Functionaries · functions on paper · funds · functionaries · Without the third F, the first two are decorative.

CONCEPT · T0

8.5.8 The Devolution Index — Devolution Index 2024 · 39.9% (2013-14) to 43.9% (2021-22) · Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh · improvement and inadequacy in the same sentence

DATA

8.5.9 The fiscal hollowness — the signature number — PRIs raise about 1% of their receipts from own taxes · 80% comes as central grants and 15% from States · own tax revenue per panchayat is about ₹21,000 a year · 2.55 lakh gram panchayats and 31 lakh+ elected representatives · 46% are women

DATA · T0

8.5.10 Competitive politics but not planning — Panchayats succeeded as political institutions — contested elections, new leadership from SC/ST and women, real local competition. They failed as planning and delivery agencies because they were given neither untied funds, nor staff, nor an activity map clear enough to plan against.

CRITIQUE

8.5.11 Gram swaraj and the Gram Sabha — Gram Sabha · direct democracy · approval of the annual plan and budget · beneficiary selection · social audit under MGNREGA Section 17 and consent under FRA and PESA · quorum, capture and the frequency of meetings

INSTITUTION

8.5.12 PESA — Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 · Fifth Schedule · Gram Sabha · consulted before land acquisition · minor forest produce and minor water bodies

PROVISION

8.5.13 Elected women representatives who cannot govern — proxy rule (sarpanch pati) · two-child and education disqualifications · no-confidence motions · rotation of reserved seats · secretariat staff who report elsewhere · longer reservation cycles, capacity building, independent panchayat staff, and legal aid

CRITIQUE

8.6 RURAL DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMMES

8.6.1 The institutional architecture — Ministry of Rural Development · Departments of Rural Development and Land Resources · Ministry of Panchayati Raj · NABARD (1982) · DRDA · NIRDPR · SIRDs · each mission builds its own society

INSTITUTION

8.6.2 The programme generations — CDP (1952) → IRDP (1978, asset-based) → JRY/EAS (wage employment) → SGSY (1999, group-based) → NREGA (2005, rights-based) → NRLM (2011, institution-based) → mission convergence (Antyodaya, Rurban). Read the sequence as a shift from assets → wages → rights → institutions → data.

CONCEPT

8.6.3 MGNREGA's design innovations — Legal guarantee · 100 days · self-selection · unemployment allowance · 15 days · Gram Sabha · one-third participation for women and social audit under Section 17 · 2020-21 with 1.75 crore new job cards

SCHEME · T0

8.6.4 The successor scheme — Viksit Bharat–Gramin Rozgar Aur Aajeevika Mission (VB-G RAM G) · 21 December 2025 · 1 July 2026 · 125 days · 60:40 · 90:10 · 9% · 60 days · ₹95,692 crore · 2026-27

DATA

8.6.5 What to watch in the successor — The examinable questions: does a 60:40 share shift the burden to fiscally weaker States that need it most? Does a seasonal pause weaken the demand-driven guarantee that made the original a right rather than a scheme? Frame it as entitlement versus mission — the shift running through all Indian welfare.

CRITIQUE

8.6.6 Mission Antyodaya — A gram-panchayat-level survey and ranking across infrastructure and service parameters, used to target the weakest panchayats and to converge schemes on them. Its value is as a diagnostic layer; its limit is that ranking is not resourcing — identification without an untied fund changes little.

SCHEME

8.6.7 Rurban — Shyama Prasad Mukherji Rurban Mission (2016) · contiguous villages · convergence of existing schemes · Critical Gap Fund · rural-urban continuum

SCHEME

8.6.8 Swachh Bharat — behaviour change at scale — all districts declared ODF by October 2019 with swachhagrahis · shame-and-pride messaging · Phase II (ODF Plus) · sustainability, solid and liquid waste

EXAMPLE

8.6.9 Land reform — the unfinished agenda — Abolition of intermediaries · tenancy reform and ceiling · benami and family partition and poor land records · records, not redistribution · SVAMITVA with 2.5 crore+ property cards and Digital India Land Records Modernisation

CRITIQUE

8.6.10 Why rural programmes underperform — Structural diagnosis, not a list. · Parallel bodies · tied funds · late releases · staff answerable to line departments and evaluation absent · DME0

CRITIQUE

Personnel theory and the Indian services are the same syllabus written twice. Recruitment, classification, training, appraisal, pay, conduct and discipline — then neutrality, activism and the political-permanent interface.

9.1 HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT AND THE PERSONNEL FUNCTION

9.1.1 Personnel administration to human resource development — Personnel administration · posts to be filled and controlled · HRD · capability to be built · establishment work · competency, career design and performance
CONCEPT

9.1.2 Why HRD matters more in government — hire and fire · pay differentially · thirty-five years · already recruited · training and career design
CONCEPT

9.1.3 The personnel machinery of the Union — Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) · PMO · IAS · UPSC · Staff Selection Commission · MHA · IPS · MoEFCC · IFoS
INSTITUTION

9.1.4 The measured vacancy position — All India Services as on 1 January 2025 — IAS sanctioned 6,877, in position 5,577, vacant 1,300 · IPS sanctioned 5,099, vacant 505 · IFoS sanctioned 3,193, vacant 1,029
DATA · TO

9.1.5 The Baswan finding on cadre strength — B.S. Baswan Committee (2016) found the shortfall structural: intake was cut in the 1990s and the gap compounds for thirty years, since a missing 1996 batch is a missing 2026 Joint Secretary. Promotee quotas cannot close a deficit at the senior levels where it bites.
COMMITTEE

9.1.6 The constitutional position of the services — Article 308-314, Part XIV · Article 309 · rules by the President or Governor · Article 310 · doctrine of pleasure · Article 311 · procedural protection · Article 312 · new All India Service · two-thirds
PROVISION · TO

9.1.7 Why India kept an All India Service — Sardar Patel's · national outlook · link that holds a federation of continental scale together · sine qua non · even more than under an authoritarian · “An efficient, disciplined and contented service... is a sine qua non of sound administration under a democratic regime even more than under an authoritarian rule.”
QUOTE · TO

9.2 RECRUITMENT

9.2.1 The principles of public recruitment — Merit (open competition) · equality of opportunity (Article 16) · representativeness · political neutrality of the recruiting body and suitability
CONCEPT

9.2.2 The UPSC's constitutional insulation — Articles 315-323 · President · misbehaviour on a Supreme Court reference · expenses charged on the Consolidated Fund · no further employment under government
PROVISION · TO

9.2.3 The limits of UPSC autonomy — appointment and tenure · which posts are referred to cadre strength · timing of requisitions · recruitment scandals and delayed appointments
CRITIQUE

9.2.4 The examination's design history — Kothari Committee (1976) · Preliminary–Main–Interview · Satish Chandra (1989) · essay · Alagh (2001) · CSAT (2011) · Baswan (2016)
COMMITTEE

9.2.5 Representative bureaucracy — Kingsley's · mirrors the society · Passive · active · reservation under Articles 16(4) and 335 · AIS insider-outsider cadre allocation
CONCEPT · TO

9.2.6 Affirmative action in recruitment — quotas (a hard floor) · US · goals and timetables after Bakke and Grutter · South Africa · employment equity plans · Malaysia's · constitutionally mandated rather than administratively adopted
CONCEPT

9.2.7 Lateral entry — Joint Secretary, Director and Deputy Secretary · 2018 · 2024 advertisement for 45 posts was withdrawn · contract appointments carried no reservation · reservation, conflict of interest and cooling-off
CRITIQUE · TO

9.2.8 The case for and against lateral entry — For · finance, energy, digital and climate · Against · bypasses reservation · career incentive · revolving-door capture
CRITIQUE

9.2.9 Merit without a fair civil service — The claim is defensible: where entry is patronage-based, the official's loyalty runs to the patron, not to the office. Northcote-Trevelyan (1854) and the Pendleton Act (1883) were both anti-corruption reforms first, and efficiency reforms second.
CONCEPT

9.3 CLASSIFICATION OF POSTS

9.3.1 Position classification — post · duties and responsibilities · post Gives equal pay for equal work · job descriptions and specialisation · United States · rigidity
CONCEPT · TO

9.3.2 Rank classification — person · rank · mobility, generalist career development and easy redeployment · Britain, France and India · pay is disconnected from the job
CONCEPT · TO

9.3.3 The Indian hybrid — rank classification · position elements · cadre posts · Pay Matrix · Non-Functional Upgradation and empanelment · rigidity of both
LINKAGE

9.3.4 The generalist–specialist debate — **Generalist** — trained mind, coordination, breadth, political sense, resistance to capture. **Specialist** — domain competence, credibility with the sector. The Indian answer since **ARC-I** has been to keep generalist leadership and add **domain specialisation** after **mid-career**, which **Hota (2004)** and **Mission Karmayogi** both pursue.
CONCEPT · T0

9.3.5 Resolving the debate honestly — judgement under political conditions (generalist) and command of the sector's evidence (specialist) · specialised career streams within a generalist service · lateral depth
CONCEPT

9.4 TRAINING AND CAPACITY BUILDING

9.4.1 What training must do — Training is not a short affair; it is a step-by-step process · skills, habits, knowledge and aptitude · induction → in-service → mid-career → specialised → leadership · behaviour
CONCEPT

9.4.2 The Indian training institutions — LBSNAA Mussoorie · SVPNPA Hyderabad (IPS) · NADT Nagpur (IRS) · IGnFA Dehradun (IFoS) · ISTM · NIRDPR · State ATIs · National Training Policy, 2012
INSTITUTION

9.4.3 Mission Karmayogi — National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building, September 2020. · rule-based to role-based · FRAC · iGOT-Karmayogi · behaviour, functional and domain
SCHEME · T0

9.4.4 The Capacity Building Commission — Established 2021 — it approves **Annual Capacity Building Plans**, harmonises training institutions, audits their quality, and builds shared learning resources. It is **recommendatory to ministries**, which is the structural limit on what it can enforce.
INSTITUTION

9.4.5 Mission Karmayogi's measured progress — 1.7 crore+ registered users (August 2026) · 10.5 lakh officials · Rashtriya Karmayogi Jan Seva · 10 February 2026 with 16,000+ master trainers · 30 States and UTs · 1.75 lakh ULB officials · Amrit Gyaan Kosh with 70+ case studies
DATA

9.4.6 The honest critique of Karmayogi — Completion is not competence · output · no link to posting or promotion · behavioural change · course-hour metric · Goodhart's law
CRITIQUE

9.4.7 Training versus capacity building — Training is individual, skill-focused, episodic and course-shaped · Capacity building is institutional · systems, data, processes, structures and organisational culture
CONCEPT · T0

9.4.8 District training in the IAS — The district phase is where an officer acquires **field judgement** — revenue, magistracy, disaster, and the habit of being personally answerable. The critique is that it has become **shorter, more ceremonial, less supervised**, and that officers reach senior posts having **never independently run a subdivision**.
CRITIQUE

9.4.9 Competency mapping and career development — FRAC competencies to postings and empanelment · instrumentality · Vroom's · gaming, subjective assessment, and a competency framework that becomes a paper exercise · externally validated
LINKAGE

9.5 APPRAISAL, PROMOTION AND PAY

9.5.1 What performance appraisal is for — development (feedback to improve) · administrative decisions (promotion, posting) · documentation (defending a decision in a tribunal) and motivation · third · first
CONCEPT

9.5.2 The Indian appraisal system — Performance Appraisal Report · SPARROW · numerical grading on a 1-10 scale · self-appraisal with targets · reporting, reviewing and accepting · communicated with a right of representation · Dev Dutt v. Union of India (2008)
INSTITUTION · T0

9.5.3 Why it does not discriminate — cluster at the top · before the year ends · cost of honesty is borne by the reporter · cannot rank · empanelment relies on the 360-degree input instead
CRITIQUE · T0

9.5.4 Appraisal must acknowledge the subjective — not fully measurable · countable targets · silently penalises the valuable · multi-source, moderated and narrative
CRITIQUE

9.5.5 Appraisal is not only for promotion — identifying training needs (feeding FRAC) · matching officers to postings · succession planning · counselling the under-performer and evidence for compulsory retirement under FR 56(j) · vertical movement
CONCEPT

9.5.6 Performance management versus performance appraisal — Appraisal · periodic, individual, backward-looking judgement · Performance management · continuous, organisational, forward-looking system · The RFD was performance management; the PAR is appraisal.
CONCEPT

9.5.7 The committees on appraisal and empanelment — Surinder Nath Committee (2003) · competency-based · domain competence · Hota (2004) — fixed tenure · compulsory retirement review at 15 and 25 years · disclosure
COMMITTEE

9.5.8 Pay determination — Central Pay Commissions · 7th CPC (2016) · Pay Matrix · minimum pay · Aykroyd formula · 8th CPC · 3 November 2025 · Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai · 18 months · 50 lakh employees and 69 lakh pensioners
DATA · T0

9.5.9 The Unified Pension Scheme — 1 April 2025 · 50% of average basic pay of the last twelve months for 25 years¹ · minimum ₹10,000 a month · 18.5% · OPS-versus-NPS · assurance without an unfunded liability
DATA · T0

9.6 CONDUCT, DISCIPLINE AND ARTICLE 311

9.6.1 The conduct rules — AIS (Conduct) Rules, 1968 and CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 · Rule 3 · absolute integrity · devotion to duty · unbecoming · political neutrality · Rule 3(3)(iii) requires oral directions to be confirmed in writing
PROVISION · T0

9.6.2 What conduct rules actually restrain — Political activity and candidature · criticism of government policy · joining associations prejudicial to sovereignty · acceptance of gifts · speculation in securities · private trade and annual immovable property returns · expression and association · performance
CONCEPT

9.6.3 Code of ethics versus code of conduct — code of conduct · list of prohibitions · code of ethics · values that guide judgement · no code of ethics · 2nd ARC's fourth report
CONCEPT · T0

9.6.4 Which is more effective? — The answer is both, in sequence. Conduct rules set an enforceable floor and catch the clear case; a code of ethics shapes discretion where rules run out — which is where most administrative harm occurs. A conduct code alone produces compliance without judgement: 'I broke no rule.'
CONCEPT

9.6.5 Article 311's two protections — 311(1) · subordinate to the appointing authority · 311(2) · reduction in rank · inquiry · reasonable opportunity of being heard
PROVISION · T0

9.6.6 The three exceptions to Article 311(2) — (a) · criminal charge · (b) · not reasonably practicable for reasons to be recorded in writing · (c) · President or Governor · interest of the security of the State · recorded, reviewable
PROVISION · T0

9.6.7 The disciplinary process — CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 — minor penalties · major penalties · charge sheet, inquiry officer, presenting officer, defence assistant, inquiry report and second-stage UPSC consultation
PROVISION

9.6.8 Why discipline fails in practice — years · criminal trials · appealable to a tribunal and then a High Court · Suspension · procedural protection designed against arbitrariness has become protection against consequence
CRITIQUE

9.6.9 Is Article 311 the problem? — refuses an unlawful order · protection · operation · time-bound inquiry, fewer stages, and independent inquiry officers · FR 56(j)
CRITIQUE

9.7 NEUTRALITY, ACTIVISM AND THE POLITICAL INTERFACE

9.7.1 What neutrality means — outcomes but impartiality between parties · government of the day · frank advice in private and executes the lawful decision in public · Whitehall · Rule 3
CONCEPT · T0

9.7.2 'Neutrality has become a myth' — The evidence for the charge: transfer as a political instrument, empanelment sensitive to preference, post-retirement appointments creating anticipatory alignment, and officers publicly identified with a regime's programmes. put it as civil servants exhibiting their political masters' values.
CRITIQUE

9.7.3 Committed versus neutral bureaucracy — Committed · constitutional and developmental commitment · Neutral · government · party · committed to the Constitution, neutral between parties
CONCEPT · T0

9.7.4 Civil service activism — publicly · law against illegality · Ashok Khemka's · T.N. Seshan's · personal preference for the elected government's mandate
CONCEPT

9.7.5 The T.S.R. Subramanian directions — T.S.R. Subramanian v. Union of India (2013) · Civil Services Board · minimum tenure · oral instructions to be recorded in writing · compliance has been partial and reversible
CASE LAW · T0

9.7.6 Transfer as the core problem — single most consequential · institutional memory · incentive to start anything · enforcement mechanism · Fix tenure and half the neutrality problem resolves itself.
CRITIQUE · T0

9.7.7 The changing political-permanent relationship — Three drivers: coalition and then single-party dominance changing the space for advice; the PMO and CMO centralising decisions and reducing the Secretary's role; and media and social media pushing officers into visibility that the neutrality convention assumed they would not have.
CRITIQUE

9.7.8 The line between direction and interference — The formulation to write. The political executive is entitled to decide policy, set priorities and demand results. It is not entitled to direct who gets a licence, who is transferred, or how a case is investigated. Every reform proposal — Civil Services Board, State Security Commission, PESB — is an attempt to draw that line institutionally.
CONCEPT

9.8 EMPLOYEE RELATIONS AND POLITICAL RIGHTS

9.8.1 Political rights of civil servants — They may vote; they may not join or assist a political party, canvass, contest, or express public political views. The justification is that the appearance of impartiality is part of the service's capital. The counter is that a blanket bar on all political expression is disproportionate to that end.
CONCEPT

9.8.2 Staff associations and the JCM — Joint Consultative Machinery (1966) — National, Departmental and Office Councils with compulsory arbitration · CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993 · Strikes are not a right — All India Bank Employees Association (1962)
INSTITUTION

9.8.3 Employer-employee relations as mutual reliance — monopoly employer · cannot strike lawfully · consultative machinery a duty, not a concession · agitation becomes the only channel
CONCEPT

9.9 ADMINISTRATIVE ETHICS

9.9.1 Why ethics and not just rules — Rules govern the **anticipated** case. Administrative discretion operates precisely where they run out — which resource-scarce claim to prefer, which enforcement to prioritise, what to record. **Ethics is what governs the space rules cannot reach**, and that space grows as administration becomes more discretionary.

CONCEPT

9.9.2 'I was only obeying orders' — person · chain · Barnard's · Nuremberg · Rule 3(3)(iii) · put the order in writing and the chain becomes attributable

LINKAGE

9.9.3 Nolan's seven principles — (1) Selflessness (2) integrity (3) objectivity (4) accountability (5) openness (6) honesty (7) leadership — from the Committee on Standards in Public Life (1995) · 2nd ARC · Code of Ethics

COMMITTEE · T0

9.9.4 The four ethical pressures on an administrator — Conflicting loyalties (law, minister, public, subordinate) · conflict of interest (personal, family, post-retirement) · information asymmetry (what to disclose, when) and the cost of dissent

CONCEPT

9.9.5 Innovative practices in administrative ethics — integrity pacts · asset and interest disclosure · cooling-off periods · e-procurement removing the discretionary interface · behavioural nudges · preventive vigilance

SCHEME

9.9.6 Named Indian exemplars — T.N. Seshan — statutory authority used to its constitutional edge. Ashok Khemka — mutation cancellation and the cost paid in transfers. Satyendra Dubey and Shanmugam Manjunath — killed for reporting corruption, and the reason whistleblower protection is not academic. S.R. Sankaran — the officer who made bonded-labour release his career.

EXAMPLE · T0

9.9.7 Ethics shaped by global practice — The channels are real: UNCAC (ratified 2011) and its conflict-of-interest obligations; OECD public integrity recommendations; FATF compliance shaping financial conduct; Nolan as the template for codes worldwide; and ISO 37001 anti-bribery certification entering Indian PSUs.

CONCEPT

9.9.8 Institutionalising ethical values — political · code of conduct for ministers · election funding transparency and asset declaration · administrative · Code of Ethics · Ethics Commissioner · whistleblower protection in force and conflict-of-interest rules with a cooling-off period

CRITIQUE

From agenda to outcome. Policy models, agenda-setting, implementation and evaluation on one side; India's planning machinery, NITI Aayog and decentralised planning on the other.

10.1 WHAT POLICY IS, AND THE MODELS

10.1.1 Dye's definition — whatever governments choose to do or not to do · non-decision is policy · Public Services Bill · grievance redress law

QUOTE · TO

10.1.2 Easton's systems model — Demands and supports enter as inputs; the political system is the **black box** where conversion occurs; **outputs** are policies; **feedback** alters the next round of inputs. **With**inputs are demands generated **inside** the system by officials themselves — the concept most useful for India.

CONCEPT · TO

10.1.3 The institutional and group models — **Institutional** — policy is whatever the institution's structure and procedure permit; change the institution and you change the policy. **Group (Bentley, Truman)** — policy is the **equilibrium** reached in the struggle between interest groups, and shifts as their relative power shifts.

CONCEPT

10.1.4 Elite theory — Mills, Mosca, Pareto · preferences of a governing elite · downward · land, capital and taxation · organised · numerous

CONCEPT

10.1.5 Rational choice and the maximum social gain — The rational model's test is **maximum social gain** — no policy should be adopted whose costs exceed its benefits, and among alternatives choose the greatest **net** benefit. It is rarely achieved because gains and costs fall on **different people**, and no politically neutral way exists to weigh them.

CONCEPT

10.1.6 Kingdon's multiple streams — Problem, policy and politics streams flow independently. A **policy window** opens when a **focusing event** or a change of government couples them, and a **policy entrepreneur** who has kept a solution ready pushes it through. This is the sharpest model for explaining **timing**.

CONCEPT · TO

10.1.7 Kingdon proved in Indian policy — GST (2016) · political window · IBC (2016) · twin balance sheet · Aadhaar · 2020 farm laws and their repeal · Nirbhaya · Criminal Law Amendment, 2013

EXAMPLE · TO

10.1.8 Punctuated equilibrium — Baumgartner and Jones · long stability punctuated by rapid change · incrementalism (most years) **with** transformation

CONCEPT

10.1.9 Wicked problems — Rittel and Webber · no definitive formulation · no stopping rule · better or worse, not true or false · no immediate test · consequential · essentially unique

CONCEPT · TO

10.1.10 Is the Indian state prepared for wicked problems? — tame problems at scale · cross-ministry authority · long time horizons beyond electoral cycles · tolerance of failure **and** adaptive, iterative delivery · annual budget, transferable officer and audit regime

CRITIQUE

10.2 AGENDA SETTING AND FORMULATION

10.2.1 Who sets the agenda — Cobb and Elder distinguish the **systemic agenda** (issues the public discusses) from the **institutional agenda** (issues government is actually acting on). Movement between the two is the political act — and most issues never make the crossing.

CONCEPT

10.2.2 Non-decision making — Bachrach and Baratz's **second face of power** — the ability to **keep an issue off the agenda** entirely, so no decision is ever taken and no conflict is ever visible. asked about groups denying others the opportunity; this is the concept it wanted.

CONCEPT · TO

10.2.3 Policy formulation in India — The chain: ministry drafts → inter-ministerial consultation → Ministry of Law and Finance concurrence → Cabinet Note → Committee of Secretaries → Cabinet or its committee → legislation or executive order. NITI Aayog enters as adviser, and the PMO increasingly as originator.

INSTITUTION

10.2.4 Pre-legislative consultation — The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014 requires draft legislation and subordinate rules to be placed in the public domain for **30 days** with an explanatory note and a summary of feedback. It is a **policy, not a statute**, and compliance is inconsistent — one of the cheapest available governance upgrades.

PROVISION

10.2.5 Evidence-based policy — NSSO/PLFS/NFHS · NITI's National Data and Analytics Platform · randomised evaluations · DMEQ · timeliness · data gaps · evidence arrives after the decision

CONCEPT

10.2.6 Why political realities defeat evidence — Evidence answers 'what works'; politics answers 'for whom, when and at whose cost' — a different question. Where evidence recommends a policy with **concentrated losses and diffuse gains** (subsidy reform, user charges, land pooling), it loses reliably, and calling that irrational misdescribes it.

CRITIQUE

10.2.7 Tacit knowledge in policy — Polanyi — "we know more than we can tell." The field officer's judgement about which village will cooperate, the veteran's sense of when an order will be resisted: real knowledge, **not codifiable**, lost when tenure is short. It complements evidence; it cannot **substitute** for it, because it is **unverifiable and prone to bias**.

CONCEPT

10.2.8 State theories and policy formulation — Pluralist · Elitist · Marxist · relatively autonomous · Poulantzas · Neo-liberal · The theory you hold determines which reform you think possible.

CONCEPT

10.3 IMPLEMENTATION

10.3.1 Pressman and Wildavsky — Implementation (1973) · complexity of joint action · clearance points · collapses multiplicatively · 35% · great expectations dashed

THINKER · T0

10.3.2 Clearance points, Indian version — Union ministry → State department → district → block → panchayat with funds, guidelines, staff and approvals · Jal Jeevan Mission's · PFMS

LINKAGE · T0

10.3.3 Top-down and bottom-up — Top-down (Sabatier and Mazmanian) — start from the statute's objectives and ask why they were not met; fix by clearer goals and tighter control. Bottom-up (Lipsky, Hjern) — start from the street-level actor and ask what she actually faces; fix by discretion, resources and realistic norms.

CONCEPT · T0

10.3.4 Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy — effectively become the public policies they carry out · demand that always exceeds resources · coping routines · are · “The decisions of street-level bureaucrats... effectively become the public policies they carry out.”

QUOTE · T0

10.3.5 India's street-level bureaucrats, named — ASHA · Anganwadi worker · patwari · PDS dealer · constable · primary school teacher · electricity lineman · as them

EXAMPLE · T0

10.3.6 Sabatier's advocacy coalition framework — subsystem · advocacy coalitions · core beliefs · a decade or more · external shocks and policy-oriented learning

CONCEPT

10.3.7 The classic implementation gaps in India — Funds arriving late in the financial year; **functionaries** absent or answerable elsewhere; **guidelines** too rigid for local variation; **capacity** at the last mile; **information** not reaching the beneficiary; and **no consequence** for non-delivery.

CRITIQUE

10.3.8 What has actually improved implementation — Be specific and evidence-led: DBT removed intermediation — ₹3.48 lakh crore cumulative savings and subsidy share down to about 9%; PFMS made release traceable; Aadhaar-based authentication cut duplication; PRAGATI created apex-level unblocking; geo-tagged asset monitoring made physical verification cheap.

DATA · T0

10.3.9 The cost of that improvement — The honest counter. Authentication failure excludes the very poorest — the elderly, manual labourers with worn fingerprints, those without connectivity. Efficiency in disbursement is not the same as accuracy in entitlement, and exclusion errors are less visible than inclusion errors because the excluded do not appear in the data.

CRITIQUE · T0

10.4 MONITORING, EVALUATION AND REVIEW

10.4.1 Monitoring versus evaluation — Monitoring is continuous and asks whether the plan is being followed — inputs, outputs, timelines. Evaluation is periodic and asks whether it worked — outcomes, impact, attribution, and whether the theory behind the design was right. Monitoring cannot substitute for evaluation, and India does far more of it.

CONCEPT · T0

10.4.2 The evaluation types — Formative (during, to improve design) · summative (after, to judge worth) · process (was it implemented as intended) · impact (what changed because of it) · cost-benefit and cost-effectiveness and participatory

CONCEPT

10.4.3 The attribution problem — The hardest question in evaluation: would the outcome have occurred anyway? The answer requires a counterfactual — randomised assignment, difference-in-differences, regression discontinuity. Without one, a rising indicator proves correlation with a scheme, not its effect, however large the dashboard number.

CONCEPT

10.4.4 India's evaluation machinery — Development Monitoring and Evaluation Office (DMEO) · Programme Evaluation Organisation (1952) · Output–Outcome Monitoring Framework · CAG performance audits and social audit

INSTITUTION

10.4.5 Without evaluation, formulation is redundant — The argument: a policy system without evaluation cannot learn, so it repeats designs that failed and cannot defend those that worked. Argyris's single-loop learning at best. The corrective is a statutory evaluation requirement with published results and a sunset clause on schemes that fail it.

CRITIQUE

10.4.6 Policy analysis and its limits — Analysis is crippled when it omits alternatives — comparing a scheme only against doing nothing — and when it truncates outcomes, counting the intended effect and ignoring displacement, substitution and distributional consequences.

CRITIQUE

10.4.7 Policy analysis as legitimization — Analysis commissioned after a decision, with terms of reference that foreclose the answer, becomes a legitimization device — the appearance of rigour attached to a settled conclusion. The safeguard is independence of the evaluator and publication of the terms of reference.

CRITIQUE

10.4.8 Cost-benefit analysis — forces the alternatives to be compared in one unit · non-marketed goods (a life, a forest, a heritage site) · discount rate · who

CONCEPT

10.5 THE PLANNING MACHINERY IN INDIA

10.5.1 Planning before independence — M. Visvesvaraya's Planned Economy for India (1934) · National Planning Committee (1938) under Nehru · Bombay Plan (1944) · M.N. Roy's People's Plan · Gandhian Plan (S.N. Agarwal) · planning consensus before it had a state

COMMITTEE

10.5.2 The Planning Commission — Cabinet Resolution, 15 March 1950 — never a constitutional or statutory body · Prime Minister · Plan assistance · PEO

INSTITUTION · TO

10.5.3 The National Development Council — resolution (1952) — PM, all Chief Ministers, Union ministers and Planning Commission members · approved · federal legitimisation · ratified rather than shaped

INSTITUTION

10.5.4 The Gadgil formula — Plan assistance · 1969 · Gadgil-Mukherjee (1991) · population 60%, per capita income 25%, fiscal performance 7.5%, special problems 7.5% · non-statutory body · transfers · Finance Commission

SCHEME

10.5.5 Why the Planning Commission was criticised — No constitutional standing · one-size-fits-all · Plan-non-Plan · maintenance · duplication · liberalised economy

CRITIQUE

10.5.6 Indicative planning — The French model adopted from the Eighth Plan (1992). The state ceased directing and began signalling — projections, priorities and incentives to guide private investment rather than allocate it. The Plan became a statement of intent with the budget as its only enforcement.

CONCEPT · TO

10.5.7 The end of the Plan-non-Plan distinction — Rangarajan Committee (2011) recommended abolition; implemented from 2017-18. The distinction had produced a perverse incentive — build a school (Plan) and underfund its teachers and repairs (non-Plan). Expenditure is now classified as revenue and capital, which is the economically meaningful split.

COMMITTEE

10.5.8 The unified plan problem — State List · divergent capacities and priorities · different frequencies and electoral cycles differ · uniformity the Constitution deliberately denies

CRITIQUE

10.6 NITI AAYOG AND THE POST-PLAN ERA

10.6.1 NITI Aayog's composition — Cabinet Resolution, 1 January 2015. · PM as Chairperson · Vice-Chairperson · full-time and ex-officio members · special invitees · CEO · Governing Council · Regional Councils

INSTITUTION

10.6.2 What changed with NITI — allocation to advice · top-down to 'cooperative and competitive federalism' From five-year plans to strategy documents · Three-Year Action Agenda · Seven-Year Strategy · Fifteen-Year Vision · Viksit Bharat @2047

CONCEPT · TO

10.6.3 NITI's actual instruments — Indices · Fiscal Health Index · January 2025 · 2026 edition released 11 March 2026 · Aspirational Districts and Blocks · DMEQ · National Data and Analytics Platform

DATA

10.6.4 The National Data and Analytics Platform — A single interoperable portal for government datasets with standardised metadata and open access — its claim is the democratisation of data, letting States, researchers and citizens use the same evidence base as the Union. Its limits are data quality at source, update frequency and coverage of State data.

SCHEME

10.6.5 Why NITI's effectiveness is limited — It has no funds and therefore no leverage; its recommendations are not binding; the Finance Ministry controls transfers and the PMO sets priorities; the Governing Council meets infrequently; and an index without a consequence changes behaviour only where a State chooses to care about rank.

CRITIQUE · TO

10.6.6 The case that NITI works as designed — never meant · think tank plus federal convener · MPI · SDG index · Aspirational Districts (a genuinely new delivery model) · language of competitive federalism

CONCEPT

10.6.7 Centrally sponsored schemes — Chaturvedi Committee (2011) · Sub-Group of Chief Ministers (Shivraj Singh Chouhan, 2015) · core of the core, core and optional with 60:40 · 90:10 · crowd out State priorities

SCHEME · TO

10.6.8 Political interference in the development process — scheme naming and launch timing · beneficiary selection pressure · project location · transfer of the officer who resists · objective targeting criteria, published allocation formulas and social audit

CRITIQUE

10.7 DECENTRALISED PLANNING

10.7.1 The constitutional mandate — Article 243ZD · District Planning Committee · draft district development plan with four-fifths of members elected · Article 243ZE · Metropolitan Planning Committee

PROVISION

10.7.2 Why DPCs do not plan — constituted late or not at all · technical planning staff · funds they would plan for are tied · parastatals and mission societies · draft plan

CRITIQUE

10.7.3 Decentralised planning done properly — Kerala's People's Plan Campaign (1996) · 35-40% of the State Plan outlay · untied funds · Gram Sabha · volunteer resource persons · expert committees · money and technical capacity together

EXAMPLE

10.7.4 Decentralised planning and social justice — is · local politics reproduces local inequality · better protected by a rule made far away · earmarking and social audit

CRITIQUE

10.7.5 The planning-devolution gap — Signature argument. · 73rd and 74th Amendments · planning authorities · fiscal and administrative system · central · tied scheme funds · ratify

CRITIQUE · TO

10.7.6 What would fix it — Untied funds · 16th Finance
Commission local body grants · technical planning
support · activity mapping · making the DPC's plan a
statutory input

CRITIQUE

The tools of administrative improvement and the reforms they were built to serve. O&M and work study, network techniques, MIS, e-governance and digital public infrastructure — then why India reformed processes and not structures.

11.1 ORGANISATION AND METHODS, WORK STUDY

11.1.1 O&M and work study distinguished — Work study seeks efficiency in **method** — how a specific task is done. **Organisation and methods** seeks efficiency in **structure and procedure** — how work flows between posts and units. The first optimises a step; the second asks whether the step should exist.

CONCEPT · TO

11.1.2 The two halves of work study — **Method study** — recording and critically examining the existing method to develop an easier, more economical one (process charts, flow diagrams, the **questioning technique**: purpose, place, sequence, person, means). **Work measurement** — establishing the **standard time** for a qualified worker, through time study, activity sampling or synthesis.

CONCEPT

11.1.3 What work study delivers — **Staffing norms** grounded in measurement rather than precedent; **elimination of redundant steps**; **standardised procedure** that makes training and audit possible; and a **baseline** against which any later improvement can be proved. It is the only technique that produces a **defensible number** for how many staff a task needs.

CONCEPT

11.1.4 India's O&M machinery — O&M Division · Cabinet Secretariat (1954) · Appleby's · Department of Administrative Reforms (1964) · DARPG · Staff Inspection Unit (1964) · staffing norms

INSTITUTION

11.1.5 Government Process Re-engineering — should this process exist at all? · redesigns from the outcome backwards · 2nd ARC's 11th Report (Promoting e-Governance) · precede · automate an unnecessary procedure

CONCEPT · TO

11.1.6 GPR that worked — Faceless assessment and appeal · jurisdiction-based officer-taxpayer interface · Passport Seva · single visit · Self-attestation

EXAMPLE

11.1.7 The Special Campaign — SCDPM (DARPG), run annually — record weeding, space released, files closed, pending references disposed, scrap disposal revenue. It is **O&M in contemporary form**: unglamorous, measurable, and the kind of housekeeping that determines whether a department can find anything.

SCHEME

11.1.8 Where the technique reaches its limit — Work study can tell you the **standard time** for issuing a certificate. It cannot tell you whether the certificate should be **required**, whether the applicant should have to appear, or who should bear the cost of the visit. **Efficiency questions cannot answer purpose questions** — Taylor's original blind spot.

CRITIQUE

11.2 NETWORK TECHNIQUES

11.2.1 PERT and CPM — PERT (US Navy Polaris, 1958) — probabilistic · uncertain · optimistic, most likely and pessimistic · CPM (DuPont, 1957) — deterministic · repetitive

CONCEPT · TO

11.2.2 The critical path — The **longest path** through the network, and therefore the **shortest possible project duration**. Activities on it have **zero float** — delay any one and the whole project slips. Everything off it has **slack**, which is where resources can be borrowed from without cost.

CONCEPT · TO

11.2.3 Crashing and the time-cost trade-off — **Crashing** = shortening a **critical** activity by adding resources. CPM's value is that it shows **which** activity to crash for the least cost per day saved — the only rational basis for spending money to accelerate a project rather than spending it everywhere.

CONCEPT

11.2.4 What network techniques give an administrator — **defensible schedule** · **which delay actually matters** · **resource levelling** and **accountability by activity** · PM Gati Shakti's · PRAGATI's

LINKAGE

11.2.5 Why networks do not remove delay — A network **schedules activity**; it cannot resolve the **uncertainty** that causes delay — land acquisition, forest clearance, litigation, contractor default, fund release. It **makes the delay visible and attributable**, which is valuable, and is often mistaken for preventing it.

CRITIQUE

11.2.6 The efficacy of management aid tools — State the governing principle: a tool's value depends on **fit between the tool and the problem**. Use **CPM** for a defined project with known steps; **PERT** where durations are uncertain; **cost-benefit** for choosing between alternatives; **MIS** for continuous control. Applying the wrong one produces **precision without relevance**.

CONCEPT

11.2.7 The other aid tools worth naming — Gantt chart (bar schedule, no dependencies) · Management by Objectives (Drucker) · operations research · queueing theory · decision trees · simulation · balanced scorecard

CONCEPT

11.3 MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEMS

11.3.1 What an MIS is — **integrated system** · **information** · **right level**, in the right form, at the right time · **planning**, **control** and **decision-making** · **decision support**

CONCEPT · TO

11.3.2 The information pyramid — Transaction processing · MIS · decision support and executive information systems · operational detail to the top

CONCEPT

11.3.3 Why MIS implementations fail — upward reporting · level that acts · entered but not used · no process redesign · fear of exposure · Garbage in, gospel out.

CRITIQUE · T0

11.3.4 MIS's evolution beyond its traditional role — periodic reports to real-time dashboards from internal · integrated external · descriptive to predictive · specialist · public · data.gov.in · NDAP

CONCEPT

11.3.5 Indian MIS that carry real weight — PFMS · NREGASoft · CCTNS · e-Hospital and ABDM · UDISE+ · PRAGATI · National Judicial Data Grid

SCHEME

11.3.6 MIS and value creation — shortening the decision cycle · exposing exceptions · standardising definitions · making performance visible

CONCEPT

11.3.7 The dashboard trap — dashboard becomes the object · entry · service · third-party verification · outcome rather than output indicators and beneficiary-side data

CRITIQUE

11.4 E-GOVERNANCE

11.4.1 The four interaction types — G2C (citizen services — passports, DBT, land records), G2B (business — GeM, single-window clearance, GST), G2G (inter-government — e-Office, PFMS, treasury), G2E (employees — iGOT, e-HRMS). Sorting a question into one of these four is the fastest way to structure the answer.

CONCEPT · T0

11.4.2 The models of e-governance — Broadcasting (information dissemination) · critical flow · comparative analysis (benchmarking against best practice) · e-advocacy or mobilisation and lobbying (networked civil action) · interactive service

CONCEPT · T0

11.4.3 The e-advocacy model and democratisation — lowers the cost of collective action · MyGov · digitally connected are not representative · amplify already-heard voices and manufactured consensus

CONCEPT

11.4.4 The maturity stages — Presence (a website) → interaction (downloadable forms) → transaction (payment and delivery end-to-end) → transformation · engagement (co-production and open data) · all five stages simultaneously

CONCEPT

11.4.5 India's e-governance trajectory — NICNET (1987) → National e-Governance Plan (2006) · CSC · Digital India (2015) · India Stack and Digital Public Infrastructure · departmental computerisation to shared population-scale rails

SCHEME

11.4.6 Has e-governance debureaucratized? — Partly. · discretion at the interface · flattened information access · not · e-Office · relocated · designs the workflow and owns the data

CRITIQUE · T0

11.4.7 The disruptive decade — mobile-first · cloud (MeghRaj) · API-based interoperability · real-time payments and AI/ML · decision support

CONCEPT

11.4.8 The e-governance divide — Connectivity and device access · digital literacy · authentication failure · language · Bhashini · assisted access through CSCs · intermediary

CRITIQUE · T0

11.4.9 Cyber security as an administrative problem — behavioural, not technical · CERT-In · CISO · cyber crisis management plans · National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre · iGOT

CRITIQUE

11.4.10 Data protection and the administrator — Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 · Rules 2025 · Data Protection Board and significant data fiduciary · data fiduciary · Puttaswamy (2017)

PROVISION

11.5 DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE AND THE 2026 FRONTIER

11.5.1 What DPI means — Interoperable, open, population-scale digital rails on which both government and private services are built — identity, payments and data exchange as public goods rather than departmental assets. Its administrative significance is reuse: one rail, many services, no rebuilding.

CONCEPT · T0

11.5.2 The India Stack layers — Identity · 140 crore+ enrolments · Payments · 20 billion+ monthly transactions · 80%+ · Data empowerment · 45 crore+ users · Commerce · Language

DATA · T0

11.5.3 DPI's development claim — advanced development goals · raised public sector efficiency · unlocked private innovation (fintech built on UPI) · Dunleavy's reintegration and needs-based holism

LINKAGE

11.5.4 Aadhaar and inclusive governance — For — deduplication, portability of entitlement, DBT at scale, financial inclusion through JAM. Against — authentication failure and exclusion, function creep beyond the original purpose, and privacy. Puttaswamy (2018) upheld it for subsidies and taxation under a law, and struck down Section 57's private-party mandate.

CASE LAW · T0

11.5.5 GeM — price discovery, transparency and MSME participation · specification gaming · quality assurance · payment delays · seller verification and counterfeits and State adoption

SCHEME

11.5.6 AI in Indian administration — grievance routing on CPGRAMS · judicial translation (SUVAS) and transcription · crop-yield and flood forecasting · GST fraud analytics · faceless assessment allocation and Bhashini

EXAMPLE · T0

11.5.7 The administrative case against unexamined AI — The 2026 argument to have ready. **Opacity** — a citizen cannot be told why a claim was rejected, defeating the **reasoned order** requirement. **Bias** — trained on historical data, it reproduces historical exclusion. **Accountability** — **who is the officer** when the model decides? The answer must be that **AI advises and a named official decides**.

CRITIQUE · TO

11.5.8 The governance framework for AI — IndiaAI Mission; NITI's Responsible AI for All principles (safety, equality, inclusivity, privacy, transparency, accountability); DPDP Act obligations on the training data; **sectoral regulators** (RBI on model risk, SEBI on algo-trading). India's stated position is **pro-innovation regulation** rather than a single horizontal AI Act.

INSTITUTION

11.6 ADMINISTRATIVE REFORM — THEORY AND THE INDIAN RECORD

11.6.1 Caiden's definition — the artificial inducement of administrative transformation against resistance · artificial (deliberate, not evolutionary) · transformation (not adjustment) **and** against resistance · constitutive

THINKER · TO

11.6.2 The nature of resistance — **Interest-based** — the reform removes someone's discretion, rent or status. **Cognitive** — officials cannot see how the new way would work. **Cultural** — the change conflicts with the organisation's self-image. **Structural** — statutes, service rules and federal division make the change legally slow.

CONCEPT · TO

11.6.3 The inducements required — Political sponsorship at the highest level · a compelling crisis or trigger · compensation for the losers (redeployment, protected pay) · early visible wins · legal backing · a champion who remains in post

CONCEPT

11.6.4 The Indian reform commissions — Secretariat Reorganisation (N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar, 1949) · Gorwala (1951) · Appleby (1953, 1956) · Santhanam (1962-64) · ARC-I (1966-70, Morarji Desai then K. Hanumanthaiah) **with** 20 reports · 2nd ARC (2005-09, Veerappa Moily) **with** 15 reports

COMMITTEE

11.6.5 The 2nd ARC's fifteen reports — 1st RTI · 4th Ethics in Governance · 5th Public Order · 10th Refurbishing of Personnel Administration · 11th Promoting e-Governance · 12th Citizen Centric Administration · 13th Organisational Structure of Government of India · 15th State and District Administration

COMMITTEE · TO

11.6.6 The signature argument on Indian reform — India reformed processes, not structures. · RTI, DBT, UPI, GeM, PFMS, faceless assessment · re-engineering transactions · structural · three-level secretariat · executive agencies · Public Services Bill · Fiscal Council · multi-member CAG

CRITIQUE · TO

11.6.7 Why structural reform fails and process reform succeeds — technocratic · creates no identifiable loser at the top · redistributes authority · the discretion it most values

CRITIQUE · TO

11.6.8 Reform depends on political will — Political will is not a personal virtue · political cost of not reforming exceeds the cost of reforming · crisis, a court order, a fiscal constraint or an electoral incentive · GST, IBC, RTI, Aadhaar

CRITIQUE

11.6.9 Problems of implementation — The standing obstacles: **federal division** — most administrative subjects are with the States; **service rules and Article 311** making personnel change slow; **fiscal cost** of any restructuring; **no owner** once the commission dissolves; and **no implementation tracking** — India has no standing body reporting on which recommendations were accepted and acted on.

CRITIQUE

11.6.10 What a serious reform agenda would contain — (1) A Public Services Bill · (2) a three-level secretariat · desk officer system · (3) independent evaluation with sunset clauses · (4) a National Tribunals Commission · (5) fiscal empowerment of the third tier

CRITIQUE

Budget theory and the Indian budget. Monetary and fiscal policy, public debt, the forms of budget, the parliamentary process, accounts and audit, and the fiscal federalism the Finance Commission arbitrates.

12.1 MONETARY AND FISCAL POLICY

12.1.1 The two policies distinguished — Monetary policy · central bank's · money supply and the price of credit · Fiscal policy · government's · taxation, expenditure and borrowing · who
CONCEPT · TO

12.1.2 India's monetary framework — Flexible inflation targeting · RBI Act amendment, 2016 · 4% with a $\pm 2\%$ band · six-member Monetary Policy Committee (three RBI, three external) · Governor's casting vote
INSTITUTION

12.1.3 The three functions of fiscal policy — Musgrave's classification: **allocation** (supplying public goods the market will not), **distribution** (altering the pattern of income and wealth), and **stabilisation** (countering the cycle). — Musgrave is the frame that answer needs.
CONCEPT · TO

12.1.4 Fiscal policy's three failings — Inequity · indirect taxes · Intricacy · Obscurantism — off-budget borrowing, contingent liabilities and tax expenditures
CRITIQUE

12.1.5 Direct and indirect tax reform — Direct — the Income-tax Act, 2025 replacing the 1961 Act; faceless assessment; corporate rate cuts (2019); BEPS Pillar Two global minimum tax. Indirect — GST (2017) subsuming seventeen taxes and thirteen cesses. Direct tax reform matters more for equity, because indirect taxes cannot discriminate by ability to pay.
SCHEME

12.1.6 The tax-to-GDP problem — combined tax-to-GDP ratio · direct tax share · narrow base · Buoyancy · GST e-invoicing, TDS/TCS widening and analytics · agricultural income exemption · informal sector and exemptions and cesses
CRITIQUE

12.1.7 Neo-liberalism and taxation — expanded · larger formal economy · digitised transactions leaving an audit trail · new tax bases · international cooperation on evasion
CONCEPT

12.1.8 Budget 2026-27 — the figures to quote — Total expenditure ₹53.5 lakh crore; capital expenditure ₹12.2 lakh crore; fiscal deficit 4.3% of GDP; debt 55.6% of GDP; net tax receipts ₹28.7 lakh crore; Finance Commission grants to States ₹1.4 lakh crore. Always date the figure — an undated number reads as recall, a dated one as scholarship.
DATA · TO

12.1.9 FRBM and the fiscal rules — FRBM Act, 2003 · Medium Term Fiscal Policy Statement · N.K. Singh Review Committee (2017) · debt anchor of 60% of GDP (Centre 40, States 20) · independent Fiscal Council · never created
PROVISION · TO

12.2 PUBLIC DEBT

12.2.1 Public debt classified — Internal *versus* external · funded (long-term, with a sinking fund) *versus* unfunded (short-term) · productive · unproductive · productive-unproductive
CONCEPT

12.2.2 Does debt burden future generations? — No, for internal debt · transfer · Yes, in three real senses · interest payments pre-empt · distributional transfer · crowding out
CONCEPT · TO

12.2.3 When debt is justified — The golden rule — borrow for capital, not for revenue expenditure. Borrowing that finances an asset yielding a return above the interest rate **raises** future capacity; borrowing for salaries and subsidies transfers consumption from the future to the present. India's **capex share** is the relevant test.
CONCEPT

12.2.4 The constitutional provisions — Article 292 — the Union may borrow on the security of the Consolidated Fund within limits Parliament may fix (Parliament has **never** fixed them). Article 293 — States may borrow within India, but need the Union's consent while indebted to it, which is the Centre's principal lever over State finance.
PROVISION

12.2.5 The debt sustainability test — growth rate exceeds the effective interest rate · $g > r$ · growth slowdown · contingent liabilities from guarantees and off-budget borrowing by parastatals
CONCEPT

12.2.6 The 16th FC's fiscal path — Centre's fiscal deficit target 3.5% of GDP by 2030-31; States 3% of GSDP. It fixes the glide path the next five years of budgeting must follow, and it binds States as well as the Union.
DATA

12.3 TYPES AND FORMS OF BUDGET

12.3.1 Line-item budgeting — The traditional form: appropriation by object of expenditure — salaries, travel, supplies. Its virtues are **control and accountability**; you can see exactly what was sanctioned and audit against it. Its defect is that it tells you what was bought and nothing about what was achieved.
CONCEPT · TO

12.3.2 Performance budgeting — function, programme and activity · inputs to outputs · 1968-69 · ARC-I's · Hoover Commission (1949) · does · buys
CONCEPT · TO

12.3.3 Why performance budgeting under-delivered — It became a parallel document rather than the appropriation itself; outputs were measurable but outcomes were not; unit costs were rarely computed honestly; and it **never governed the allocation decision** — the line-item budget remained the one that was voted and audited.
CRITIQUE

12.3.4 PPBS — Planning-Programming-Budgeting System · McNamara (1961) · objectives → programmes → alternatives → costs over a multi-year horizon · 1971

CONCEPT

12.3.5 Zero-base budgeting — Peter Pyhrr at Texas Instruments; Jimmy Carter in Georgia and then federally. · rejustified from zero · decision units · decision packages · ranking · 1986-87

CONCEPT · T0

12.3.6 ZBB became the most incremental of approaches — workload is impossible · level of aggregation that hides choices · reproduce last year's order · rejustification of the base

CRITIQUE · T0

12.3.7 When ZBB actually works — periodic, selective · few programmes each year on a rotating cycle · sunset review · fiscal shock

CONCEPT

12.3.8 Outcome budgeting in India — 2005-06 · Output–Outcome Monitoring Framework · NITI Aayog · output indicators (what was produced) and outcome indicators (what changed) · surviving descendant

SCHEME · T0

12.3.9 Gender budgeting — not a separate budget for women · accountability device · Statement 13 · Part A (100% women-specific allocations) and Part B · 2005-06 with Gender Budget Cells

SCHEME · T0

12.3.10 The other budget classifications — Revenue and capital · surplus, balanced and deficit · cash versus accrual · plan and non-plan (abolished 2017-18) · revenue deficit · fiscal deficit · primary deficit (fiscal deficit minus interest) and effective revenue deficit

CONCEPT

12.4 THE BUDGET PROCESS IN INDIA

12.4.1 The constitutional foundation — Article 112 · Annual Financial Statement · Article 113 · President's recommendation · Article 114 · Appropriation Bill · Consolidated Fund · Article 266 · Article 267

PROVISION · T0

12.4.2 The stages in Parliament — Presentation (1 February since 2017) · general discussion · Standing Committee scrutiny · voting on Demands with cut motions · guillotine · Appropriation Bill · Finance Bill · 75 days

INSTITUTION

12.4.3 The three cut motions — Disapproval of policy cut — 'that the amount be reduced to ₹1', a challenge to the policy itself. **Economy cut** — a specified reduction, arguing waste. **Token cut** — 'reduced by ₹100', to ventilate a specific grievance. All three are devices for **discussion**, since none has passed in decades.

INSTITUTION

12.4.4 Vote on account and the other grants — Vote on account (Article 116) · Supplementary, additional and excess grants (Article 115) · PAC · Token grant · Vote of credit and exceptional grant

PROVISION

12.4.5 Charged versus voted expenditure — Charged on the Consolidated Fund · interest and debt charges · salaries of the President, Speaker, judges, CAG, UPSC Chairman and court decrees · independence and contractual obligation · beyond the vote

PROVISION · T0

12.4.6 The Finance Ministry's role — Department of Economic Affairs · Department of Expenditure · GFR 2017 · Department of Revenue · DIPAM · DFS · guardian of the purse and macro-policy authority

INSTITUTION

12.4.7 The recent budget process reforms — Advancement to 1 February (2017) · merger of the Railway Budget · abolition of the Plan–non-Plan · Treasury Single Account with PFMS

INSTITUTION

12.4.8 Wildavsky on budgeting — Budgeting is incremental, not comprehensive. · increment · cognitively impossible and politically explosive · Aaron Wildavsky, The Politics of the Budgetary Process (1964)

QUOTE · T0

12.4.9 V.O. Key's question — "On what basis shall it be decided to allocate X dollars to activity A instead of activity B?" — the lack of a budgetary theory (1940). Seventy years of PPBS, ZBB and outcome budgeting have been attempts to answer it, and none has, because the question is finally political, not technical.

QUOTE

12.5 THE BUDGET AS A POLITICAL INSTRUMENT

12.5.1 Why the budget is political, not technical — allocates scarce resources between competing claims · winner and a loser · statement of priorities in numbers · federal bargaining · signal to markets · electoral instrument

CONCEPT

12.5.2 The budget's socio-economic implications — direct-indirect tax mix · subsidies and transfers · capital expenditure · cesses and surcharges are not shareable with States

CONCEPT

12.5.3 Populism and public finance — welfare expenditure · unfunded, untargeted and unreviewed · free power, farm loan waivers, old pension restoration · permanent revenue liability · one-time political return

CRITIQUE

12.5.4 The safeguards against fiscal populism — FRBM targets · independent Fiscal Council · N.K. Singh, 2017 · medium-term expenditure frameworks · RBI's · Article 293's

INSTITUTION

12.5.5 The Niskanen question, revisited — Is the budget-maximising bureaucrat still real? **Not in the aggregate** — PFMS, TSA and outcome frameworks watch the money. **Yes in a modified form** — agencies maximise staff strength, jurisdiction and scheme count rather than budget, because those are the currencies that survived the fiscal controls.

LINKAGE

12.6 ACCOUNTS AND ACCOUNTING TECHNIQUES

12.6.1 The three funds — Consolidated Fund (Article 266(1)) · appropriation by law · Public Account (266(2)) · banker (provident funds, small savings) · Contingency Fund (267) · President's disposal

PROVISION · TO

12.6.2 The separation of accounts from audit — 1976 · CAG both kept the accounts and audited them · Controller General of Accounts · audits · Railways, Posts and Defence

INSTITUTION

12.6.3 Cash versus accrual accounting — Cash · when money moves · Accrual · when the obligation arises · liabilities, depreciation and the real cost of assets · 12th Finance Commission · move to accrual · GASAB

CONCEPT

12.6.4 Why the shift to accrual is slow — It requires an asset register that mostly does not exist, valuation of assets acquired decades ago, retraining of the entire accounting cadre, and — the real obstacle — it would disclose liabilities (pensions, guarantees, arrears) that cash accounting keeps invisible.

CRITIQUE

12.6.5 PFMS and the Treasury Single Account — Public Financial Management System · the beneficiary's account · float · Treasury Single Account · released is not the same as spent

SCHEME

12.6.6 Computerisation of treasuries — real-time expenditure data · ways-and-means surprises · bill-passing time measurable · March rush · what · why · execution · allocation

SCHEME

12.6.7 The internal control layer — General Financial Rules, 2017 · Delegation of Financial Powers Rules · internal audit · Financial Adviser · Integrated Financial Advice · precedes

INSTITUTION

12.7 AUDIT AND THE CAG

12.7.1 The CAG's constitutional position — Articles 148-151. · President · like a Supreme Court judge · salary and expenses charged · ineligible for further office · Ambedkar · most important officer

PROVISION · TO

12.7.2 The three kinds of audit — Regularity or compliance — was the expenditure within the sanction and the rules? Propriety — was it wise, faithful and economical, even if lawful? Performance — did the programme achieve economy, efficiency and effectiveness? The third is where the CAG's real influence now lies.

CONCEPT · TO

12.7.3 Propriety audit's canons — prima facie be more than the occasion demands · directly or indirectly to its own advantage · benefit of a particular person or section · allowances should not be a source of profit

CONCEPT

12.7.4 How CAG reports secure accountability — The chain: CAG audits → reports to the President or Governor (Article 151) → laid before the legislature → examined by PAC or COPU → Action Taken Notes from the ministry → further PAC report. Executive answerability to Parliament in finance runs through this chain and nowhere else.

INSTITUTION

12.7.5 Where the chain breaks — tabled late · PAC's · Action Taken Notes · recommendatory · surcharge or disallow and audit follows the money after it is gone

CRITIQUE · TO

12.7.6 The office under the public eye — Performance audits on spectrum, coal blocks and the Commonwealth Games put the CAG at the centre of public debate — and drew the counter-charge that presumptive-loss estimation strays from audit into policy evaluation. The same reports raised both its salience and its exposure.

CRITIQUE

12.7.7 'Auditing is not about finding faults' — The modern position: audit's purpose is assurance and improvement — confirming that accounts present a true picture, that controls work, and that lessons feed back into design. Constructive audit engages the auditee during the exercise; a purely adversarial audit produces defensive record-keeping, not better administration.

CONCEPT

12.7.8 The reform agenda for the CAG — multi-member CAG (2nd ARC and the Shunglu-era debate) · statutory audit board · audit of PPP concessionaires and of bodies substantially financed · timely tabling and capacity in data analytics

COMMITTEE

12.7.9 The audit of local bodies — Article 243J and 243Z · Technical Guidance and Supervision · Local body accounts are frequently years in arrears · Finance Commission grants · online publication of audited accounts

CRITIQUE

12.8 FISCAL FEDERALISM AND THE 16TH FINANCE COMMISSION

12.8.1 The Finance Commission's mandate — Article 280 · five years · distribution of net tax proceeds between Union and States (vertical) · allocation among States (horizontal) · principles of grants-in-aid under Article 275 · augment State funds to supplement the resources of panchayats and municipalities

PROVISION · TO

12.8.2 The 16th Finance Commission — Dr Arvind Panagariya · 1 February 2026 · 2026-31 · Devolution held at 41%. · income distance 42.5%, population (2011) 17.5%, demographic performance 10%, area 10%, forest and ecology 10%, contribution to GDP 10%.

DATA · TO

12.8.3 What is new in the 16th FC award — The examinable change: a new 10% weight for contribution to GDP — rewarding the larger producing States — and the dropping of tax effort as a criterion. It is a partial answer to southern States' long complaint that the formula penalised those that performed on demography and growth.

CONCEPT · TO

12.8.4 The local body grants — ₹7.91 lakh crore · rural ₹4.35 lakh crore, urban ₹3.56 lakh crore · disaster corpus of ₹2,04,401 crore · how much of it is untied

DATA

12.8.5 The cess and surcharge problem — Cesses and surcharges are not part of the divisible pool **under** Article 270 · effective · below the notified 41%

CRITIQUE · TO

12.8.6 The State Finance Commission — Article 243I and 243Y · State Finance Commission every five years · constituted late · reports are not tabled with an action-taken memorandum · frequently not accepted

CRITIQUE

12.8.7 Is the Finance Commission strengthening local bodies? — Yes · direct, formula-based, growing · audited accounts and own-revenue effort · No · tied · bypasses the State's own devolution failure · functionaries and taxation powers

CRITIQUE

12.8.8 GST and the federal balance — Article 279A · GST Council · one-third · two-thirds · three-fourths · power to tax goods and services independently · seat in a joint decision-making body

PROVISION · TO

12.8.9 How to judge the GST Council — best working instance of cooperative federalism · consensus · Follett's integration · lost fiscal autonomy · blocking third

LINKAGE

The administrative inheritance: Kautilya's statecraft, the Mughal mansabdari and revenue systems, and the British construction of the district, the civil service and the constitutional framework.

13.1 KAUTILYA'S ARTHASHASTRA

13.1.1 What the Arthashastra is — A treatise on statecraft, not a work of political philosophy — a manual of **administration, revenue, war, law and espionage** written for a working ruler. **Arthashastra** literally means the science of **artha**: material well-being, the livelihood of the people and the means of acquiring and protecting it.
CONCEPT · TO

13.1.2 The Saptanga theory — seven limbs (**prakritis**) · (1) **Swami** (ruler) · (2) **Amatya** (ministers and officials) · (3) **Janapada** (territory and people) · (4) **Durga** (fortified capital) · (5) **Kosha** (treasury) · (6) **Danda** (army and coercive force) · (7) **Mitra**
CONCEPT · TO

13.1.3 Kautilya's ethic of rule — happiness of his subjects · welfare · whatever pleases his subjects · **yogakshema** · “In the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare his welfare. He shall not consider as good only that which pleases him but treat as beneficial to him whatever pleases his subjects.”
QUOTE · TO

13.1.4 The administrative machinery — **Amatyas** selected by **upadha** — tests of integrity against religious, monetary, romantic and fear-based temptation. **Adhyakshas** as departmental superintendents (about **30 departments**); **Samaharta** for revenue; **Sannidhata** as treasurer; **Gopa** and **Sthanika** in local administration; the **Mahamatras** at the top.
INSTITUTION

13.1.5 Ethics in public service, Kautilya's version — realistic rather than moralistic · not to eat up at least a bit of the king's revenue **Hence** forty ways of embezzlement · rotation of officials · espionage and graded punishment · “just as it is impossible not to taste honey placed on the tongue, so it is impossible for a government servant not to eat up at least a bit of the king's revenue.”
QUOTE

13.1.6 The modern parallels — **Upadha** · integrity testing and vigilance · rotation of **adhyakshas** · transfer policy against entrenchment · espionage on officials · preventive vigilance and CVO reporting · **Samaharta's** · land record and revenue administration · **danda** · the state's legitimate monopoly of force
LINKAGE

13.1.7 Is it theory or manual? — theory · sama, dana, danda, bheda · dharma, vyavahara, charitra, rajasasana · operational instruction
CONCEPT

13.1.8 The honest critique — Its ethic is **instrumental** — the ruler's welfare duty is justified by the **stability it buys**, not by the subject's right. It is **authoritarian**, resting on surveillance and graded punishment, and it is **hierarchical** on varna.
CRITIQUE

13.2 MUGHAL ADMINISTRATION

13.2.1 The Mansabdari system — Akbar's · **zat** (personal rank, status and pay) and **sawar** (cavalry obligation) · paid in cash or through **jagir** (assignment of revenue, not land) · transferable · assignments were non-hereditary and resumed on death · service nobility
INSTITUTION · TO

13.2.2 The land revenue system — **Todar Mal's Zabti** or **Bandobast** — measurement (**paimaish**) · **polaj**, **parautei**, **chachar**, **banjar** · ten-year average of produce and prices (**dahsala**) · cash · one-third · survey-based and record-based
INSTITUTION · TO

13.2.3 The central departments — **Diwan** · **Mir Bakshi** · **Mir Saman** (imperial household and **karkhanas**) · **Sadr-us-Sudur** (religious endowments and charity) · **Qazi-ul-Quzat** (judiciary) · **subah**
INSTITUTION

13.2.4 The territorial hierarchy — **Subah** · **Subahdar** · **Diwan** · parallel revenue authority reporting separately to the centre · check on the governor · **Sarkar** · **Faujdar** (law and order) and **Amalguzar** (revenue) · **Pargana** with **Shiqdar**, **Amil**, **Qanungo** and **Patwari** · village
INSTITUTION

13.2.5 Was Mughal administration centralised? — Centralised in design — mansabdars appointed and transferred by the emperor, non-hereditary assignments, parallel reporting by the provincial **Diwan**, a uniform revenue method. **Decentralised in practice** — **zamindars** collected on the ground, the **village community** was untouched, and distance made **local autonomy** inevitable.
CRITIQUE · TO

13.2.6 The Mughal legacy in the district — **sarkar** · district · **faujdar's** · **amalguzar's** · fused in one officer · **Collector-cum-District Magistrate** · **patwari** and **qanungo**
LINKAGE

13.3 THE BRITISH LEGACY

13.3.1 How the trader became a magistrate — **Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa** (1765) · revenue · **nizamat** · dual government · **Warren Hastings** · The revenue collector acquired magisterial power because revenue collection required coercion.
INSTITUTION · TO

13.3.2 The Permanent Settlement and its alternatives — **Permanent Settlement** (**Cornwallis**, 1793) · **zamindar** · fixed in perpetuity · **Ryotwari** (**Munro**, **Read**) · directly with the cultivator · **Mahalwari** (**Holt Mackenzie**, **R.M. Bird**) · village community · agrarian structure
INSTITUTION

13.3.3 The Cornwallis reforms — Separation of revenue and judicial · abolition of the **Collector's** judicial powers (later restored in part) · **Europeanisation** · increased salaries · **Code of 1793** · rule-bound, written, hierarchical
INSTITUTION

13.3.4 The Indian Civil Service — Haileybury · Charter Act, 1853 · open competition · London only · 1922 · Allahabad · Satyendranath Tagore · 1864 · Lloyd George (1922) · the steel frame
INSTITUTION · TO

13.3.5 Nehru's verdict on the ICS — ICS · Indian · civil · service · Patel's · sine qua non · “The ICS is neither Indian, nor civil, nor a service.”
QUOTE

13.3.6 The constitutional milestones — Regulating Act 1773 · Pitt's India Act 1784 (Board of Control — dual government) · Charter Act 1833 · 1858 (Crown rule, Secretary of State) · Morley-Minto 1909 · Montagu-Chelmsford 1919 · dyarchy · Government of India Act 1935
PROVISION

13.3.7 Dyarchy under the 1919 Act — transferred · ministers responsible to the legislature and reserved · Governor with executive councillors · finance stayed reserved · without money
PROVISION

13.3.8 Why the 1935 Act matters most — structural template · federal division through three lists · provincial autonomy · Federal Court · RBI · Governor's discretionary powers and emergency provisions · two-thirds · Article 356 · Section 93
LINKAGE · TO

13.3.9 The colonial legacy's administrative residue — district as the unit of administration · generalist Collector · land revenue records · regulatory rather than developmental · secrecy · Official Secrets Act, 1923 and rank classification with a generalist elite service
CRITIQUE · TO

13.3.10 The balanced verdict on the legacy — It bequeathed institutional continuity, a professional civil service, a codified legal system, an audited treasury and an independent judiciary's foundations — assets most post-colonial states lacked. It also bequeathed a machinery designed for **extraction and order**, which had to be **redirected to development** without being rebuilt.
CONCEPT

The constitutional ground on which Indian administration stands. The Preamble and the Directive Principles as an administrative charter, the federal division, the Governor, and the live constitutional questions of the year.

14.1 THE PHILOSOPHICAL AND CONSTITUTIONAL BASE

14.1.1 The Preamble as an administrative mandate — Justice — social, economic and political; Liberty; Equality; Fraternity. · decision rules · Kesavananda (1973) · basic structure
CONCEPT

14.1.2 The DPSPs as the administrative charter — Article 37 · fundamental in the governance of the country · duty of the State to apply in making laws · Articles 38, 39, 39A, 41, 43, 46, 47, 48A, 50
PROVISION · T0

14.1.3 The Fundamental Rights–DPSP relationship — Champakam Dorairajan (1951) · Kesavananda (1973) · Minerva Mills (1980) · balance between them is itself basic structure
CASE LAW

14.1.4 Article 12 and who is 'the State' — State · local authorities and other authorities · Ajay Hasia (1981) · Zee Telefilms (2005) · It decides whether a body faces writ jurisdiction at all.
CASE LAW

14.1.5 Constitutional morality — Ambedkar, quoting Grote, warned that constitutional morality is "not a natural sentiment; it has to be cultivated". His companion warning is the one to quote: "however good a Constitution may be, it is sure to turn out bad because those who are called to work it happen to be a bad lot."
QUOTE

14.1.6 Who upholds constitutional values in practice — framework · institutions (EC, CAG, UPSC, courts) · civil society (RTI users, PILs, social audit) and citizens (voting, participation, dissent) · Riggs's formalism
LINKAGE

14.1.7 The parliamentary system's administrative implication — elected head is the real executive — Article 74 · 42nd and 44th Amendments · Shamsher Singh (1974) · ministerial responsibility · an anonymous, permanent civil service
CASE LAW

14.1.8 The statutory and constitutional bodies — Constitutional — EC, CAG, UPSC and SPSCs, Finance Commission, AG, NCSC, NCST, NCBC (102nd Amendment, 2018), Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities. Statutory — NHRC, CIC, CVC, Lokpal, NCW, NGT, TRAI. The distinction decides how the body may be abolished or altered.
INSTITUTION

14.2 THE FEDERAL DESIGN

14.2.1 India's federal character — Ambedkar · federal in structure and unitary in spirit · K.C. Wheare · quasi-federal · Granville Austin · cooperative federalism · single citizenship, integrated judiciary, All India Services, Article 3, emergency provisions, residuary powers with the Union
CONCEPT · T0

14.2.2 The legislative distribution — Seventh Schedule — Union List (97 entries) · State List (66) · Concurrent List (47) · Article 246 · Article 254 · Presidential assent · Article 248
PROVISION · T0

14.2.3 How the Union reaches State subjects — Article 249 · Article 250 (during Emergency) · Article 252 (two or more States request) · Article 253 (treaty implementation) · Article 256-257 (directions to States) · centrally sponsored schemes
PROVISION · T0

14.2.4 The pros and cons of Union spending on State subjects — For — national minimum standards · fiscal capacity · externalities · counter-cyclical · Against — matching contributions crowd out State priorities · one-size guidelines · implementing agencies
CRITIQUE

14.2.5 Administrative relations — Article 256 · Article 257 · means of communication of national importance and protection of railways · Article 258 · Article 355 · internal disturbance
PROVISION

14.2.6 Centre–State relations are undergoing drastic change — GST · cesses shrinking the divisible pool · direct benefit transfer bypassing States · centrally sponsored schemes · agency withdrawal of consent
CRITIQUE · T0

14.2.7 Cooperative federalism's instruments — Inter-State Council (Article 263) · 1990 · Sarkaria's · Zonal Councils · GST Council (279A) · NITI's Governing Council and National Development Council · actually meets and decides
INSTITUTION · T0

14.2.8 What blocks cooperative federalism — Divergent political interests · Financial constraints · about 60% of general government expenditure · asymmetric information · consultative without being decisional
CRITIQUE · T0

14.2.9 Competitive federalism — published indices — SDG India Index, Fiscal Health Index, Ease of Doing Business/BRAP, Composite Water Management · public choice applied to a federation · rank without resources changes only the willing
LINKAGE · T0

14.2.10 Asymmetric federalism — India's federation is not uniform. Article 371 and its variants for Maharashtra, Gujarat, Nagaland, Assam, Manipur, Andhra, Sikkim, Mizoram, Arunachal, Goa and Karnataka; the Fifth and Sixth Schedules for tribal areas; special category treatment in transfers; UTs with and without legislatures. Asymmetry is the device that held a plural federation together.
CONCEPT

14.3 THE GOVERNOR AND THE FEDERAL FLASHPOINTS

14.3.1 The Governor's constitutional position — President under Article 155 · during the President's pleasure (156) · 163 · except · discretion · Shamsher Singh (1974)
PROVISION · TO

14.3.2 Where the Governor has real discretion — Appointing a Chief Minister · dismissing a ministry that has lost confidence · recommending President's Rule (356) · reserving a bill for the President (200) · reporting on the State's administration · Article 371 · Sixth Schedule
PROVISION

14.3.3 The assent question — Article 200 · assent · withhold assent · return · must assent · reserve · The Article prescribes no time limit
PROVISION · TO

14.3.4 The 2025 Presidential Reference — live 2026 issue. · State of Tamil Nadu · Supreme Court's advisory opinion of November 2025 · judicially fixed timelines · Articles 200 and 201 · returning the question to political and cooperative-federal channels
CASE LAW · TO

14.3.5 Strained Governor-State relations — delayed assent · timing of floor tests · appointments as Chancellor of State universities · prosecution sanction · speeches and public commentary and reports to the Centre · appointed by, removable by, and dependent for its next post on the Union
CRITIQUE

14.3.6 The reform recommendations on the Governor — Sarkaria (1988) · eminent person from outside the State · consultation with the Chief Minister · five-year tenure · Punchhi (2010) · fixed tenure · impeachment-style removal by the State legislature · no Chancellorship of universities
COMMITTEE

14.3.7 Article 356 and its discipline — S.R. Bommai (1994) · floor of the House · justiciable · Assembly may only be dissolved after both Houses of Parliament approve · not available for a mere failure of law and order or corruption
CASE LAW · TO

14.3.8 The Sarkaria and Punchhi frame — Sarkaria (1983-88) — 247 recommendations · Inter-State Council (created 1990) · Article 200 · All India Services strengthened, not weakened · Punchhi (2007-10) · localised emergency · fixed tenure
COMMITTEE · TO

14.4 THE LIVE CONSTITUTIONAL DEBATES OF 2026

14.4.1 Simultaneous elections — 129th Constitution Amendment Bill · Joint Parliamentary Committee · Ram Nath Kovind Committee (2024) · 100 days · appointed date · unexpired term
PROVISION

14.4.2 The administrative argument on simultaneous elections — For · model code · security forces and teachers · expenditure · Against · curtailment or extension of assembly terms · accountability of a government to a mid-term verdict · ratification by half the States
CRITIQUE

14.4.3 The Election Commission's administrative role — Article 324 · plenary reservoir of power · Mohinder Singh Gill, 1978 · Model Code of Conduct · non-statutory administrative authority
PROVISION

14.4.4 Electoral roll revision — Special Intensive Revision · burden of proof · adequacy of notice · time for objections · remedy for wrongful deletion · procedural fairness in a mass administrative process
EXAMPLE

14.4.5 Appointment of Election Commissioners — Anoop Baranwal (2023) · PM, Leader of Opposition and the Chief Justice of India · CEC and Other ECs (Appointment) Act, 2023 · Union Cabinet Minister
CASE LAW

14.4.6 The collegium debate — Second Judges (1993) and Third Judges (1998) · 99th Amendment and NJAC Act · 2015 · judicial independence · Memorandum of Procedure · transparency and delay
CASE LAW

14.4.7 Judicial efficiency as an administrative problem — 4.76 crore cases pending (NJDG, 2026) · judge strength and vacancies · court infrastructure · e-Courts Phase III (₹7,210 crore) · National Judicial Data Grid · mediation under the Mediation Act, 2023 and government as the largest litigant · National Litigation Policy
DATA

14.4.8 Data protection and the constitutional turn — Puttaswamy (2017) · privacy · three-fold test · DPDP Act, 2023 with Rules 2025 · Section 44(3) · RTI Section 8(1)(j)
CASE LAW

14.4.9 Development and social justice — not in tension · Article 38(2) · land acquisition, forest diversion and urban renewal · RFCTLARR 2013 and FRA 2006 · consent and compensation
LINKAGE

The machinery at the top: the Prime Minister and Cabinet, the Cabinet Secretariat and the PMO, ministries and their field organisations, and the boards and commissions around them.

15.1 THE PRIME MINISTER AND THE CABINET

15.1.1 The constitutional basis of the Council — Article 74 · Prime Minister at the head · shall act · 42nd Amendment with one reconsideration · 44th · Article 75 · collectively responsible
PROVISION · TO

15.1.2 The three tiers of the Council — Cabinet Ministers (the inner body that decides) · Ministers of State (with or without independent charge) and Deputy Ministers · Cabinet is not mentioned in the original Constitution · Article 352's · 44th Amendment · 91st Amendment (2003) · 15% of the House
PROVISION

15.1.3 Did the 91st Amendment right-size the Council? — Yes at the margin — it ended jumbo ministries in several States and, with the anti-defection provision disqualifying a defector from ministerial office, removed the incentive to buy loyalty with berths. No in substance — the 15% cap is generous for large houses, and parliamentary secretaries were used to evade it until courts intervened.
CRITIQUE

15.1.4 Why the Indian PM is stronger than the British — A written Constitution names him (Article 74) · sole channel of communication · no elected upper chamber with real veto · no separate head-of-state convention constraining him · larger patronage in appointments · command of a federation's central transfers
CONCEPT · TO

15.1.5 The countervailing constraints — He is constrained by coalition arithmetic where it exists, judicial review far stronger than in Britain, federal resistance from opposition-ruled States, and the fact that most administrative subjects are on the State List. The British PM faces a unitary state; the Indian PM must negotiate one.
CRITIQUE

15.1.6 The Cabinet committees — Cabinet Committee on Security · on Economic Affairs · on Political Affairs · on Appointments (ACC) · on Parliamentary Affairs · on Investment and Growth · on Employment and Skill Development · ACC
INSTITUTION

15.1.7 The Transaction of Business Rules — Article 77(3) · Government of India (Transaction of Business) Rules, 1961 · which cases must go to the Cabinet · inter-ministerial consultation · Read with the Allocation of Business Rules, this is Gulick's POSDCORB in Indian statutory form.
LINKAGE

15.2 THE CABINET SECRETARIAT AND THE PMO

15.2.1 The Cabinet Secretariat — The Cabinet Secretary is the senior-most civil servant, head of the civil services, ex-officio chairman of the Committee of Secretaries, and secretary to the Cabinet. Its function is coordination, not policy origination: it circulates Cabinet Notes, records decisions, monitors implementation and resolves inter-ministerial disagreement.
INSTITUTION · TO

15.2.2 Its three wings — Civil (Cabinet coordination, the Rules of Business); Military (Military Affairs, and the Chief of Defence Staff's interface); Intelligence (the Directorate General of Security and R&AW, which report through the Cabinet Secretariat). It also houses the Performance Management Division that ran the RFD from 2009 to 2014.
INSTITUTION

15.2.3 The Cabinet Secretary as staff, not line — Gulick's · no command over any ministry · advisory, persuasive and derived from proximity to the PM · Committee of Secretaries
LINKAGE

15.2.4 The Prime Minister's Office — Not a constitutional or statutory body — an office of the PM's personal staff, headed by a Principal Secretary, with additional and joint secretaries, and no allocated subjects of its own. Its power is entirely derived: it is influential because the PM is, and to the degree the PM chooses.
INSTITUTION · TO

15.2.5 The PMO's growth — Nehru's small secretariat · clears files across ministries, drives flagship programmes, runs PRAGATI reviews, and holds the interface with States · presidentialisation · decline of the Planning Commission
CONCEPT

15.2.6 'The people's PMO, not the Prime Minister's PMO' — The critique is about accountability: an office with great influence and no departmental answerability — no Demand for Grants of substance, no Standing Committee, no minister answerable for its decisions in the House. The defence is that executive coordination at scale requires an apex staff, and its output is the PM's own responsibility.
CRITIQUE · TO

15.2.7 PRAGATI — Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation (2015) · PM-chaired, multi-modal, video-conference · directly with Union Secretaries and State Chief Secretaries · the apex leader personally uses the data · Mayo's
EXAMPLE · TO

15.2.8 The centralisation critique of PRAGATI — It compresses five layers of hierarchy into one meeting, which is its power and its problem: it delivers speed for the projects the apex looks at and leaves everything else on the ordinary chain, and it substitutes personal attention for institutional process — a solution that does not survive a change of occupant.
CRITIQUE

15.3 MINISTRIES, DEPARTMENTS AND FIELD ORGANISATIONS

15.3.1 The secretariat–executive distinction — The **Secretariat** frames policy, prepares legislation, allocates resources and evaluates; **executive agencies, attached and subordinate offices** implement. It is **Gulick's** policy-implementation split, adopted from the British model, and it is the reason a Secretary is not personally accountable for delivery in the field.
CONCEPT · T0

15.3.2 The office hierarchy — Secretary → Additional Secretary → Joint Secretary → Director → Deputy Secretary → Under Secretary → Section Officer → Assistant Section Officer. The **Joint Secretary** is the pivotal level — the first at which a file can effectively be settled and the first with a defined **charge** of subjects.
INSTITUTION

15.3.3 Attached versus subordinate offices — **Attached offices** provide **executive direction** and technical advice to the ministry on the implementation of its policies — the Directorate General of Health Services, the Central Water Commission. **Subordinate offices** are the **field agencies** that actually execute — customs houses, income tax circles, post offices.
INSTITUTION

15.3.4 The desk officer system — ARC-I (1968) · 2nd ARC's 13th Report · section with a hierarchy of clerks · desk manned by an officer · three · partially and reversibly
COMMITTEE · T0

15.3.5 The field organisations' role — local knowledge · adaptation to variation · speed of response · visible official · 11 agro-climatic zones and 2.55 lakh gram panchayats
LINKAGE

15.3.6 The boards — CBDT and CBIC · Railway Board · technical, quasi-judicial and continuous · collective deliberation · plural headship
INSTITUTION

15.3.7 Recruitment and appointment machinery at the top — Appointments Committee of the Cabinet · empanelment · 360-degree · Central Staffing Scheme · Public Enterprises Selection Board · UPSC
INSTITUTION

15.3.8 Coordination — the Union's chronic problem — Thompson's · mutual adjustment · committee · Committee of Secretaries · Group of Ministers · PRAGATI · PM Gati Shakti's · e-Office
LINKAGE

The tier that actually delivers — police, health, education, revenue and land are State subjects. The Governor's discretion, the Chief Secretary, the Secretariat-Directorate relationship, and the State's link to its local bodies.

16.1 THE POLITICAL EXECUTIVE IN THE STATE

16.1.1 The aid-and-advice provision — "There shall be a Council of Ministers with the **Chief Minister at the head** to **aid and advise** the Governor in the exercise of his functions, **except in so far as he is by or under this Constitution required to exercise any of his functions in his discretion.**" The whole federal argument sits in that exception.
PROVISION · TO

16.1.2 Why the exception is contested — Article 163(2) · whether a matter falls within his discretion · not questionable on the ground that he ought or ought not to have acted in his discretion · Shamsheer Singh (1974) · expressly or by necessary implication · self-certifying
CASE LAW

16.1.3 The Chief Minister's position — Article 164 — appointed by the Governor; ministers hold office during the Governor's pleasure; the Council is **collectively responsible to the Legislative Assembly**. In practice the CM's power exceeds the PM's within the State, because **transfers and postings of the entire State cadre** are effectively at his disposal.
PROVISION · TO

16.1.4 The Chief Secretary — The **administrative head** of the State — principal adviser to the CM, head of the State civil services, chairman of coordination committees, and the **crisis manager** in disaster and law-and-order emergencies. Like the Cabinet Secretary he is **staff, not line**: influence flows from **proximity to the Chief Minister**, not from command.
INSTITUTION · TO

16.1.5 The State Secretariat — Principal Secretary or Secretary · policy, legislation, budget, personnel and coordination · staffed largely by generalists · technical directorates
INSTITUTION

16.1.6 Coalition dynamics in the States — They vary with the **nature of leadership** (a dominant leader can hold a coalition that a consensual one cannot), the **character of the parties** (ideological versus regional-personal), and **conditions** — pre-poll alliances behave differently from post-poll arrangements. Administratively the effect is **departmental fiefdoms** and slower Cabinet decisions.
CONCEPT

16.2 SECRETARIAT AND DIRECTORATE

16.2.1 The division of function — Secretariat — policy formulation, legislation, budget, rules, personnel and control. Directorate — technical advice, execution, field supervision, and the **professional memory** of the department. Health, education, agriculture, PWD and police each have this **two-headed** structure.
CONCEPT · TO

16.2.2 Why the demarcation blurs — There is **no statutory allocation** between the two; the Secretariat drifts into **case work and transfers**, and the Directorate is drawn into **policy notes**. Both then do **each other's work badly** — the generalist decides technical questions and the technical head spends the day on files.
CRITIQUE · TO

16.2.3 The consequences of the blur — Delay — the same file is examined twice; **demoralisation** of the technical cadre, whose advice can be overturned without reasons; **diffused accountability** when a programme fails; and **loss of technical memory**, because the officer who decided is transferred and the one who knew was not asked.
CRITIQUE

16.2.4 The reform positions — Three, and they conflict. **Merge** the two at the top so one officer both advises and executes (the **integrated or Bihar pattern**). **Separate** them sharply, giving the Directorate statutory delegation. Or **shrink** the Secretariat to policy alone, as the **2nd ARC's 15th Report on State and District Administration** proposed.
CRITIQUE

16.2.5 The generalist-specialist question at State level — It bites harder here than at the Union, because State departments are **overwhelmingly technical** — irrigation, power, health, forests. The workable answer is **specialist headship of the Directorate with statutory delegation**, generalist headship of the Secretariat, and **domain-trained generalists** through Mission Karmayogi's competency framework.
LINKAGE

16.3 STATE-LEVEL MACHINERY AND STATE-LOCAL RELATIONS

16.3.1 The State Public Service Commission — Articles 315-323 apply to States as to the Union — appointment by the **Governor**, removal only by the **President** on a Supreme Court reference, expenses **charged** on the State's Consolidated Fund. Yet several SPSCs have faced **recruitment scandals**, **prolonged vacancies and delayed results** — insulation of tenure without insulation of process.
INSTITUTION

16.3.2 State-level regulatory and quasi-judicial bodies — State Electricity Regulatory Commissions · State Information Commissions · State Human Rights Commissions · Lokayuktas · State Consumer Commissions · State Election Commissions · vacancy
INSTITUTION

16.3.3 The State Finance Commission's place — Article 243I and 243Y — the constitutional bridge between the State and its local bodies, and the weakest link in Indian fiscal federalism. Late constitution, delayed reports, **no action-taken memorandum laid before the legislature**, and recommendations **routinely not accepted** — the third tier's fiscal fate is decided here and mostly by default.
CRITIQUE · TO

16.3.4 Parastatals and the bypass problem — The structural critique to write. **Water boards, housing boards, development authorities, Smart City SPVs, mission societies and DRDAs** carry out functions listed for local bodies in the **Eleventh and Twelfth Schedules**, and report to the State, not the elected local body. **Rhodes's hollowing out**, applied downward inside a federation.

LINKAGE · TO

16.3.5 Activity mapping — The technical fix that would matter most. For each of the **29 and 18 subjects**, specify which **activity** within it belongs to which **tier** — planning, execution, maintenance, supervision, financing — and attach the **funds and functionaries** to that assignment. **Kerala and Karnataka** did it; most States published a list of subjects and stopped.

CRITIQUE

16.3.6 The State's real administrative weight — States carry **roughly 60% of general government expenditure**, employ the overwhelming majority of public servants, and own the subjects that touch the citizen daily — **police, land, health, education, water, agriculture**. **Reform that does not reach the State does not reach the citizen.**

CONCEPT

The district: the unit of Indian administration since the Mughal sarkar. The Collector's four hats, the magisterial powers, the reform debate over what he should still hold, and the district as a delivery platform.

17.1 THE DISTRICT AND ITS OFFICER

17.1.1 Why the district endures — unit of Indian administration · sarkar · land, law and order, elections, disaster and welfare delivery · No reform has ever proposed abolishing it
CONCEPT · TO

17.1.2 The three hats, and the fourth — Collector · District Magistrate · Deputy Commissioner · fourth hat · Chairperson of the District Disaster Management Authority under Section 25 of the DM Act, 2005
INSTITUTION · TO

17.1.3 The magisterial powers — BNSS (in force 1 July 2024) · Section 144 CrPC · security proceedings · dispersal of unlawful assembly · requisition of armed force and executive magistracy · Article 50
PROVISION · TO

17.1.4 The Collector's revenue core — maintenance of land records (khatauni, jamabandi, mutation) · settlement operations · land acquisition · RFCTLARR Act, 2013 · recovery of public dues as arrears of land revenue · relief and remission · custody of the district treasury
INSTITUTION · TO

17.1.5 The coordinating role — District Development Coordination and Monitoring Committee (DISHA) · DDMA · district grievance forum · district-level bankers' committee · District Election Officer · District Census Officer and returning officer
INSTITUTION

17.1.6 The subdivision and below — Sub-Divisional Magistrate / Sub-Divisional Officer · Tehsildar / Mamlatdar · Kanungo and Patwari / Talathi / Village Accountant · Mughal-named
INSTITUTION

17.2 THE CHANGING ROLE AND THE REFORM DEBATE

17.2.1 Why the role must be redefined — panchayats and municipalities · parastatals and missions · regulatory bodies and courts · DBT and digital delivery
CRITIQUE · TO

17.2.2 The two reform positions — Divest · Zila Parishad · regulation, revenue, law and order and disaster · G.V.K. Rao · District Development Commissioner · Retain and reorient · single coordinating authority
CRITIQUE

17.2.3 The 2nd ARC's position — 15th Report, State and District Administration · strengthening the elected district government · regulatory, law-and-order, land and disaster · minimum tenure · activity map · District Council chaired by an elected head
COMMITTEE

17.2.4 Teamwork over hierarchy — multi-departmental and time-critical · Follett's law of the situation · Incident Response System · district team with pre-assigned incident roles
LINKAGE

17.2.5 The limit of the teamwork argument — statutory powers vest in a named officer · coercive decisions need a single accountable signature · law-and-order emergency · hierarchy for authority, teams for delivery
CRITIQUE

17.2.6 Tenure — the decisive variable — no incentive to begin anything that outlasts the posting · loss of local knowledge and the transfer as the enforcement mechanism · T.S.R. Subramanian (2013)
CRITIQUE · TO

17.2.7 District reorganisation — The administrative case for smaller districts is **span of control and access** — travel time to headquarters, population per officer. The critique is that the actual drivers are **politico-populist** — a new district as an electoral promise — and the costs are real: **new establishment, split cadres, divided records and thinner senior staffing across more units.**
CRITIQUE

17.2.8 The district training question — The district phase of IAS induction is where **field judgement** is formed — revenue cases decided, magistracy exercised, a subdivision independently run. The critique is that it has become **shorter, more ceremonial and less supervised**, so officers reach senior posts without having been **personally answerable for a decision** in the field.
LINKAGE

17.3 THE DISTRICT AS A DELIVERY PLATFORM

17.3.1 The Aspirational Districts Programme — 2018, 112 districts · delta ranking · improvement, not level · Converge, collaborate, compete · central prabhari officer
SCHEME · TO

17.3.2 Why the Aspirational model worked — a small number of measurable indicators · real-time data with public ranking · a senior officer with a personal stake and peer competition · Mark Moore's
LINKAGE

17.3.3 The Aspirational Blocks Programme — 2023, 500 blocks — the same method taken one tier down, on the finding that district averages conceal block-level deprivation. The open question: does delta ranking survive at a level with **no dedicated officer, no separate budget and far weaker data?**
SCHEME

17.3.4 The district disaster machinery — DDMA under Section 25, DM Act 2005 · District Magistrate · District Disaster Management Plan · Incident Response System · 2025 amendment
INSTITUTION

17.3.5 Digital delivery at district level — Common Service
Centres · e-District · SVAMITVA · 2.5 crore+ · land record
digitisation · geo-tagged · CPGRAMS · data node
SCHEME

17.3.6 The district's coordination deficit — The honest closing
critique. The Collector **chairs** many committees and
commands only the revenue establishment. Line department
officers answer to their **directorate**; mission societies to the
State; parastatals to their **board**. He carries **responsibility**
without authority, which is why the office's effectiveness
varies so sharply with the individual.
CRITIQUE · TO

The 74th Amendment gave cities constitutional status and left them fiscally hollow. Municipal finance, the planning functions the States kept, and the parastatals that deliver around the elected body.

18.1 THE 74TH AMENDMENT

18.1.1 The mandatory provisions — 1992, in force 1 June 1993 · Three types of municipality (243Q) — Nagar Panchayat · Municipal Council · Municipal Corporation · Wards Committees · reservation including one-third for women (243T) · five-year term (243U) · State Election Commission (243ZA) · State Finance Commission
PROVISION · TO

18.1.2 The Twelfth Schedule — Eighteen functions the legislature may devolve under Article 243W — urban planning, regulation of land use, roads and bridges, water supply, public health and sanitation, fire services, urban forestry, slum improvement, urban poverty alleviation, parks, burial grounds, and planning for economic development and social justice.
PROVISION · TO

18.1.3 The permissive defect, repeated — functional devolution is enabling, not mandatory · urban planning and land use · development authorities · sanitation and streetlights · master plan
CRITIQUE · TO

18.1.4 The Metropolitan Planning Committee — Article 243ZE · ten lakh with two-thirds of members elected · draft development plan · Most metropolitan areas either lack one or have one that does not plan.
CRITIQUE

18.1.5 The District Planning Committee's urban half — Article 243ZD · panchayat and municipal · spatial planning, shared water and physical resources, and infrastructure and environmental conservation · rural and urban as one planning problem
PROVISION

18.2 MUNICIPAL FINANCE

18.2.1 The comparative number to quote — RBI Report on Municipal Finances (November 2024) · 0.6-0.7% of GDP against Brazil's 7.4% and South Africa's 6%
DATA · TO

18.2.2 The composition of municipal revenue — Property tax · 0.09-0.11% of GDP · 15% of municipal revenue · own revenue is 60-65% · transfers 32-39% · central transfers are under 5% and municipal bonds are under 10% · own revenue that is large in share and tiny in absolute terms
DATA · TO

18.2.3 Why property tax under-performs — Outdated valuations · low coverage · exemptions · weak collection · political reluctance · GIS-based property mapping, unit-area assessment and periodic indexation
CRITIQUE

18.2.4 The other revenue instruments — User charges · advertisement and entertainment · development charges and betterment levies · Transferable Development Rights and land value capture · municipal bonds
SCHEME

18.2.5 The financial-autonomy critique — plan beyond one year · borrow (no creditworthiness) · maintain · refuse · Constitutional status without fiscal capacity produces responsibility without resources
CRITIQUE · TO

18.2.6 The 16th Finance Commission's urban grant — ₹7.91 lakh crore for 2026-31 · urban ₹3.56 lakh crore · how much is untied · online publication of audited accounts and property tax floor rates
DATA

18.3 METROPOLITAN AND CITY GOVERNANCE

18.3.1 The metropolitan governance problem — A metropolitan area is governed by overlapping authorities with no single accountable head — the municipal corporation, a development authority for planning, separate water and transport boards, a cantonment or two, a police commissionerate, and several State parastatals. Nobody is responsible for the city as a whole.
CRITIQUE · TO

18.3.2 Why cities matter fiscally — Urban India generates the larger share of national output and of tax revenue while its governments are the weakest tier fiscally. That mismatch is the argument: the places producing the wealth have the least control over the infrastructure their productivity depends on.
CONCEPT

18.3.3 The directly elected mayor debate — For · single accountable executive · five-year term · Against · funds, functions and functionaries · figurehead with a bigger office · one year, indirectly elected · Municipal Commissioner
CRITIQUE

18.3.4 Commissioner versus Mayor — Municipal Commissioner · State-appointed IAS officer · Mayor · elected head · upward to the State not downward from the electorate
CRITIQUE · TO

18.3.5 Ward Committees and Area Sabhas — Article 243S · Model Nagara Raj Bill (2006) · Area Sabhas · Kerala and West Bengal · covering several wards each
INSTITUTION

18.3.6 The urban missions — JNNURM (2005) · AMRUT and AMRUT 2.0 · Smart Cities Mission (2015) — 100 cities · SPVs · PMAY-Urban · Swachh Bharat Urban · NULM · PM SVANidhi · National Urban Digital Mission
SCHEME

18.3.7 The SPV critique of Smart Cities — Special Purpose Vehicles · State and municipal shareholding · CEO answerable to a board · bypassing the elected local body the 74th Amendment created · Rhodes's hollowing out
LINKAGE

18.3.8 The urban capacity deficit — critically short of qualified staff · no dedicated municipal cadre · Mission Karmayogi has onboarded 1.75 lakh ULB officials · numbers
CRITIQUE

18.3.9 What would actually strengthen cities — (1) Transfer urban planning and land use · (2) a directly elected mayor · (3) a professional municipal cadre · (4) property tax reform · (5) untied Finance Commission grants

CRITIQUE

Material belonging to neither paper alone: the theory-to-India interlinks, the year's dated evidence, the quotable lines, the drawable models, and the discipline's own vocabulary.

19.1 THE VOCABULARY OF THE DISCIPLINE

19.1.1 The discipline's own vocabulary — Administrative discretion · zone of indifference · goal displacement · bounded rationality · satisficing · formalism · overlapping · heterogeneity · agency capture · principal-agent problem · hollow state · network governance · co-production · street-level bureaucracy · policy entrepreneur · incrementalism · wicked problem · path dependence · trained incapacity · bureau-pathology · legitimization deficit · steering not rowing.

CONCEPT · T0

19.2 MODELS WORTH DRAWING

19.2.1 Riggs's prism — Fused (agraria) → Prismatic → Diffracted (industria) · formalism, overlapping, heterogeneity · inside · Forty-five seconds.

CONCEPT · T0

19.2.2 Simon's decision funnel — Intelligence → Design → Choice → Review with bounded rationality · satisficing · Cabinet Note

CONCEPT

19.2.3 Easton's systems model, drawn — conversion · demands and supports · withinputs · outputs · feedback · civil society → ministry → statute → district → CAG

CONCEPT · T0

19.2.4 Klitgaard's equation box — $C = M + D - A$ · two Indian interventions · e-auction and GeM · faceless assessment and DBT · RTI and social audit

CONCEPT · T0

19.2.5 The 3F devolution triangle — Functions · Funds and Functionaries · Devolution Index 2024 · 1% own revenue · staff report to line departments · one vertex

CONCEPT · T0

19.2.6 The accountability wheel — (1) legislative PAC questions (2) executive CVC hierarchy (3) judicial writs review (4) citizen RTI social audit (5) media Mark each spoke's weakness

CONCEPT

19.2.7 The policy cycle with Indian institutions — A circle — agenda-setting → formulation → adoption → implementation → evaluation — with the responsible Indian body at each node: media and civil society → ministry and NITI → Parliament → district and PRI → CAG and DMEO. It converts a generic model into a Paper II answer.

CONCEPT

19.2.8 The fiscal federalism flow — A downward chain: divisible pool → 41% vertical devolution → six horizontal criteria → State → State Finance Commission → local body, with a break marked at the SFC and cesses shown leaking out before the pool. Two annotations carry the entire critique.

CONCEPT

19.2.9 The district's four hats — Collector (revenue) · District Magistrate (law and order) · Deputy Commissioner (development) · Chairperson DDMA

CONCEPT

19.2.10 Moore's strategic triangle — public value · authorising environment · operational capacity · which vertex was missing

CONCEPT

19.3 THEORY CARRIED INTO INDIAN ADMINISTRATION

19.3.1 Devolution failure → Riggs — panchayats, RTI compliance, Citizen's Charters or SFCs · formalism · prescriptive and the descriptive · diagnosis

LINKAGE · T0

19.3.2 PSU performance → Evans — When writing on public enterprises or industrial policy, insert embedded autonomy: space and atomic energy had a bureaucracy autonomous enough to resist capture and embedded enough to know the sector; the licensing system had embeddedness without autonomy, and became capture.

LINKAGE · T0

19.3.3 Budget behaviour → Wildavsky — When writing on the Indian budget, ZBB or expenditure reform, insert incrementalism: the base is accepted and attention goes to the increment, because comprehensive review is cognitively impossible and politically explosive. It explains why every non-incremental technique became incremental.

LINKAGE · T0

19.3.4 Frontline delivery → Lipsky — When writing on MGNREGA, PDS, policing, ASHA or teachers, insert street-level bureaucracy: facing demand that always exceeds resources, frontline staff develop coping routines — rationing, creaming, routinising — and those routines are the policy the citizen experiences.

LINKAGE · T0

19.3.5 Scheme implementation → Pressman and Wildavsky — When writing on centrally sponsored schemes or convergence, insert the complexity of joint action: with many clearance points each requiring agreement, the probability of completion collapses multiplicatively — which is why PFMS and direct transfer shorten the chain rather than improve any link in it.

LINKAGE

19.3.6 Bureaucratic behaviour → Merton and Crozier — red tape, file culture or risk aversion · goal displacement · vicious circle · cannot correct its behaviour by learning from its errors

LINKAGE · T0

19.3.7 GST Council and disaster response → Follett — When writing on the GST Council, Inter-State Council, PRAGATI or the Incident Response System, insert integration and the law of the situation — both parties take their orders from the facts of the case rather than from each other's rank. It is the theory of consensus decision-making in a federation.

LINKAGE

19.3.8	Digital governance → Dunleavy and Weber — India Stack, DBT, faceless assessment or AI · Digital Era Governance · legal-rational authority automated · iron cage LINKAGE · T0
19.3.9	Elite capture → Selznick — Water User Associations, forest committees, the Community Development Programme or sarpanch pati · co-optation · changed by them · sub-goal formation LINKAGE
19.3.10	Regulators and parastatals → Rhodes — regulatory bodies, Smart City SPVs, mission societies or PPP · hollowing out of the state and governance without government · responsibility and no instrument LINKAGE
19.3.11	Written orders and transfers → Barnard — When writing on neutrality, the political-permanent interface or Conduct Rule 3(3)(iii), insert the zone of indifference: an arbitrary or unlawful command narrows it for everyone who watches, and the requirement to record oral instructions in writing is an institutional device for defending its boundary. LINKAGE
19.4	2026 — THE YEAR'S CHANGED FACTS
19.4.1	16th Finance Commission — Dr Arvind Panagariya · 1 February 2026 · 2026-31 · Devolution 41% · income distance 42.5, population (2011) 17.5, demographic performance 10, area 10, forest and ecology 10, contribution to GDP 10 · Local body grants ₹7.91 lakh crore · disaster corpus ₹2,04,401 crore DATA · T0
19.4.2	Budget 2026-27 — Total expenditure ₹53.5 lakh crore · capex ₹12.2 lakh crore · fiscal deficit 4.3% of GDP · debt 55.6% of GDP · net tax receipts ₹28.7 lakh crore · Finance Commission grants to States ₹1.4 lakh crore · 3.5% by 2030-31 · 3% of GSDP DATA · T0
19.4.3	The 8th Central Pay Commission — 3 November 2025 · Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai · 18 months · 50 lakh employees and 69 lakh pensioners · Implementation date not yet notified · terms and expected direction DATA · T0
19.4.4	VB-G RAM G replaces MGNREGA — Viksit Bharat–Gramin Rozgar Aur Aajeevika Mission · 21 December 2025 · 1 July 2026 · 125-day · 60:40 · 90:10 · 9% · 60 days · ₹95,692 crore DATA · T0
19.4.5	The Presidential Reference on assent — November 2025 — the Supreme Court's advisory opinion declined to impose judicially fixed timelines on the Governor or the President under Articles 200 and 201, unsettling the earlier Tamil Nadu approach. The single most examinable federal development of the year. CASE LAW · T0
19.4.6	The RTI-DPDP collision — Section 44(3) of the DPDP Act, 2023 · RTI Section 8(1)(j) · all personal information · public-interest override With DPDP Rules notified in 2025 CRITIQUE · T0

19.4.7	Corruption Perceptions Index 2025 — India 91st of 182, score 39/100 · 96th in 2024 · 42 · 16 February 2026 · process reform · grand or political DATA · T0
19.4.8	NITI's Fiscal Health Index — January 2025 — Odisha · 2026 edition released 11 March 2026 · public choice applied to a federation DATA · T0
19.4.9	The new criminal codes in force — Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita · Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam · 1 July 2024 · mandatory forensic visit · statutory timelines · zero and e-FIR and videographed search and seizure PROVISION · T0
19.4.10	Deregulation and Jan Vishwas — Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2023 · 183 provisions across 42 Acts · 2026 Act · Deregulation Commission · reforming process rather than structure PROVISION · T0
19.4.11	Simultaneous elections in Parliament — 129th Constitution Amendment Bill · Joint Parliamentary Committee · Ram Nath Kovind Committee (2024) · appointed date · 100 days · unexpired term PROVISION · T0
19.4.12	Digital scale in 2026 — Aadhaar 140 crore+ · UPI 20 billion+ · 80%+ · DigiLocker 45 crore+ · CSCs 5 lakh+ · SVAMITVA 2.5 crore+ · PM Gati Shakti 40+ ministries and 1,600+ data layers · e-Courts Phase III ₹7,210 crore DATA · T0
19.4.13	What to watch before the exam — 8th CPC's · JPC report · DPDP Rules · VB-G RAM G's · Census and delimitation · 106th Amendment · Devolution Index CONCEPT
19.5	LINES TO OPEN AND CLOSE WITH
19.5.1	Lord Acton on power — "Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely." The default opener for accountability, corruption and discretion questions — and better used as the premise for a structural argument than as a conclusion. QUOTE
19.5.2	Lord Denning on administrative power — "Properly exercised the new powers of the executive lead to the Welfare State; but abused they lead to the Totalitarian State." The single best line to open an administrative law, delegated legislation or discretion answer — it states the entire subject in one sentence. QUOTE · T0
19.5.3	Gandhi's talisman — "Recall the face of the poorest and the weakest man whom you may have seen, and ask yourself if the step you contemplate is going to be of any use to him." The decision rule for development, equity and welfare answers — and the Indian counterpart to Frederickson's social equity. QUOTE · T0

19.5.4 Lindblom on policy — "Policy is not made once and for all; it is made and re-made endlessly." Use to close any question on **policy formulation, review or reform** — it makes the case for **evaluation and iteration** without sounding like a recommendation list.

QUOTE

19.5.5 Kofi Annan on governance — "Good governance is perhaps the single most important factor in eradicating poverty and promoting development." A safe, authoritative close for **good governance, SDG and development administration** answers.

QUOTE

19.5.6 Bagehot on the Cabinet — **efficient secret · hyphen which joins, a buckle which fastens · parliamentary executive, collective responsibility and the political-permanent interface** · "a hyphen which joins, a buckle which fastens, the legislative part of the state to the executive part."

QUOTE

19.5.7 Laski on decentralisation — "We cannot realise the full benefit of democratic government unless we begin by the admission that all problems are not central problems, and that the results of problems not central in their incidence require decision at the place, and by the persons, where and by whom the incidence is most deeply felt."

QUOTE

19.5.8 Woodrow Wilson on the difficulty of administration — **obvious part of government · in action** · "It is getting to be harder to run a constitution than to frame one" · "the most obvious part of government; it is government in action"

QUOTE

19.5.9 Nehru on the public sector — The public enterprises were to be the "**temples of modern India**". Set it against the **New Public Sector Enterprise Policy, 2021** — four strategic sectors and a bare-minimum presence — and you have a **seventy-year arc in two sentences** for any PSU question.

QUOTE

19.5.10 Sen on famine and democracy — "No famine has ever taken place in the history of the world in a functioning democracy." Use it to argue that **accountability is not a luxury added to development but a condition of it** — the sharpest available close on RTI, social audit or press freedom.

QUOTE · T0